



सत्यमेव जयते
Government of Bharat



Every moment of whose life symbolises an unwavering commitment to service and national interest, and for whom public welfare is a lifelong mission, under the leadership of such **Seva-Vrati Narendra Modi ji**, Bharat is experiencing continuous progress, and the entire nation is saying....

12 *Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke* Saal

» Welfare of the Poor

- » Free monthly ration for 81+ crore people
- » 4+ crore PM Awas houses, 10.5+ crore Ujjwala LPG connections and 12+ crore toilets made life easier

» Women Empowerment

- » 32+ crore Jan Dhan accounts opened for women
- » Permanent commission for women in the armed forces
- » 3+ crore Lakhpati Didis
- » 10 crore rural women empowered through 91+ lakh Self Help Groups

» Nation Building

- » Metro network spanning 1,100+ km across 26 cities
- » 164 Vande Bharat trains running across the country
- » Major infrastructure projects built, including Atal Setu, Sudarshan Setu, Chenab Rail Bridge, Bogibeel Bridge and Pamban Sea Bridge
- » Number of airports increased from 74 to 164

» Youth Empowerment

- » Skill training for nearly 2 crore youth
- » ₹40 lakh crore MUDRA Loan
- » 2.2 lakh startups across the country
- » 10,000+ Atal Tinkering Labs promoting innovation

» Healthcare

- » Free treatment up to ₹5 lakh for senior citizens aged 70+
- » Ayushman Bharat coverage for 60+ crore people
- » Medicines at discounts of up to 90% through 19,000+ Jan Aushadhi Kendras nationwide

» Nation First

- » Record defence exports worth nearly ₹38,400 crore
- » Dream of a Naxal-free India becomes a reality, with a strong crackdown on terrorism
- » Freedom from the colonial mindset – Rajpath became Kartavya Path, and a new Naval Ensign inspired by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj

» Farmers' Welfare

- » ₹4.3 lakh crore disbursed under PM-KISAN
- » 4+ crore farmers received ₹2 lakh crore crop insurance coverage
- » Crops worth ₹26+ lakh crore procured at MSP
- » Kisan Credit Cards provided to 8 crore farmers

» Middle Class

- » Annual income up to ₹12.75 lakh tax-free
- » Affordable air travel for 1.6+ crore passengers under the UDAN Scheme
- » MBBS seats increased by 151% to nearly 1.3 lakh

» Virasat aur Vikas

- » Construction of the grand Ram Temple in Ayodhya
- » Transformation of Kashi Vishwanath Dham, Mahakal Mahalok and Kedarnath Dham



THE EPICENTRE IN SEA OFF MINDANAO

Deadly 7.8 magnitude quake in Philippines kills 35

DAVAO: An offshore earthquake with a magnitude of 7.8 hit the southern Philippines on Monday, killing at least 35 people, injuring more than 200 others mostly in ruined buildings and sending a 1-metre tsunami into nearby coasts.

Several mostly low-rise buildings collapsed or sustained heavy damages in the hard-hit city of General Santos. Tsunami damage was reported in at least one southern coastal village. Smaller waves were measured in Indonesia and Palau and as far away as southern Japan.

The quake also triggered a landslide in Glan, a municipality in the province of Sarangani, that killed 13 villagers, Rene Punzalan, a provincial disaster-mitigation official, told the DZBB radio network. Four other villagers died in Sarangani, he said.

The major earthquake was the strongest to hit the Philippines this year, Teresito Bacolcol, the director of the Philippine Institute of Volcanology and Seismology, said. He warned people to seek advice before returning to damaged buildings and houses, which could collapse due to aftershocks.

The United States, a treaty ally of the Philippines, said it was coordinating with Manila and was ready to support Philippine response efforts. France, Japan and New Zealand also



Rescuers inspect the damage after an earthquake in General Santos, Philippines on Monday

AP/PTI



School children react as a canopy roof, rear, collapsed, due to a powerful earthquake on Monday

AP/PTI

expressed support.

“Our pickup truck suddenly jerked and I thought we had a flat tire,” Rod Sosmeña, a regional director of the Office of Civil Defence, told The Associated Press from General Santos, where he was travelling when the quake struck at 7:37 am.

“The shaking was very strong and people dashed out of houses into the streets,” Sosmeña said.

More than 100 students in uniforms and a dozen teachers had gathered for a flag-raising ceremony in a coconut tree-ringed grade school compound in the rural town of Malita in

Davao Occidental province when the ground shook, turning the first day of school after a two-month summer break into chaos.

“Their excitement on the first day of school turned to trauma,” school principal Rosavel Cachuela told the AP.

Some of the young students screamed in panic and wept but most remained seated and still, preventing any injuries, Cachuela said, adding that a motorcycle was damaged when a shed crumbled to the ground.

At least four people remained missing in General Santos, a port city of more than 700,000 people and a regional

Highlights

- » The quake also triggered a landslide in Glan
- » The international airport in General Santos was temporarily shut
- » Search and rescue teams worked to find people who may have been trapped in a supermarket, a warehouse, a grade school

hub for the tuna export industry.

Search and rescue teams worked to find people who may have been trapped in a supermarket, a warehouse, a grade school, and other small buildings that either collapsed or were severely damaged, offi-

cials said.

The international airport in General Santos was temporarily shut due to the earthquake and 17 domestic flights were cancelled, the Civil Aviation Authority of the Philippines said.

The quake was centred

at sea off Mindanao, the second most populous island in the Philippine archipelago. According to Bacolcol, the quake occurred at a depth of 33 kilometres, about 32 kilometres southwest of Maasim town in Sarangani province.

Waves of 1 metre were monitored in the provinces of Sultan Kudarat and Sarangani. A 1.4-metre wave hit at one time in Kiamba town, Bacolcol said. The quake was also felt in Malaysia’s Sabah state on Borneo island. Sabah is just a boat ride away from southern Philippines. An 83-centimetre tsunami was measured by a gauge off Indonesia’s Sulawesi island,

and the PTWC said 30-centimetre waves were measured in Palau.

Waves up to 20 centimetres were detected on the remote Japanese island of Chichijima and the central Japanese town of Kushimoto, the Japan Meteorological Agency said.

The Philippines is often hit by earthquakes and volcanic eruptions due to its location on the Pacific “Ring of Fire,” an arc of seismic faults around the ocean. The archipelago is also battered by about 20 typhoons and tropical storms each year, making it one of the world’s most disaster-prone countries.

AGENCIES

Assessing damage, casualties

President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. ordered the cancellation of classes and directed disaster-response agencies to immediately get to work in quake-hit provinces, saying “the national government is moving and we will not leave Mindanao behind.” The Pacific Tsunami Warning Center said the threat of a tsunami largely passed about five hours after the quake.

Six shanties on stilts were damaged in a coastal village in Zamboanga del Sur province due to the quake and taller waves, officials said. Aside from the landslide in Sarangani, most of the other deaths were caused by collapsing buildings and falling debris, including in a damaged mosque, in the southern provinces of South Cotabato and Davao Occidental, and on Balut Island, according to Sosmeña and another disaster-mitigation official, Ednar Dayanghirang.

AGENCIES

Yemen’s Houthis threaten Israeli shipping in Red Sea

ADEN: Yemen’s Iran-aligned Houthis said on Monday that they would ban Israeli maritime navigation in the Red Sea, adding to challenges for global shipping through the Middle East during the Iran war.

The group said in a statement it had launched an attack on Israel and enacted a total ban on Israeli shipping in the Red Sea, warning of further escalation.

Any Houthi attacks on Red Sea shipping would worry energy markets more than three months into Iran’s closure of the Strait of Hormuz, with the war reigniting overnight.

The Red Sea, leading to the Suez canal, is a crucial shipping lane in its own right, and during the Iran war has become the main alternative outlet for millions of barrels per day of Middle East oil sent by pipeline

“THE RED SEA, LEADING TO THE SUEZ CANAL, IS A CRUCIAL SHIPPING LANE IN ITS OWN RIGHT”

bypassing the Gulf.

The Houthis disrupted shipping in 2023 to 2025 out of what they said was solidarity with the Palestinians, but had so far largely stayed out of the wider Middle East war that began with U.S.-Israeli attacks on Iran in February this year.

A Houthi source told Reuters that preventing Israeli ships from transiting the Red Sea was a first step, and that further escalation could lead it to stop the passage of any ships

bound for Israel as well as other measures. The announcement did not amount to a ban on all commercial shipping in the Red Sea and was instead “directed at vessels assessed by the Houthis as Israeli-affiliated”, British maritime risk management group Vanguard said on Monday in a note.

“Given the broad wording used, vessels operating in the region should maintain heightened vigilance and conduct enhanced affiliation screening.”

Shipping sources said the action could cause wider impact, because the Houthis have targeted ships in the past with no direct link with Israel.

“The announcement... will cause every ship to think carefully about the wisdom of making a transit,” one source said. “The Houthis don’t have a good record of determining which ships have ‘links’ to Israel, so it’s probably better to go around Africa, pay the fuel bill, and benefit from lower war risk insurance costs.”

Red Sea war risk insurance rates were unchanged on Monday at around 0.3% of the value of a ship, with little movement in recent weeks, an insurance industry source said.

AGENCIES

Pak’s human rights body raises alarm over violence in PoK

LAHORE: Pakistan’s human rights body on Monday said that it is “deeply alarmed” by the ongoing violence in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK), where 11 people, including four police officers, were killed and hundreds injured during violent clashes.

The Human Rights Commission of Pakistan (HRCP) also expressed serious concerns about the so-called regional government’s decision to proscribe the Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC) under anti-terrorism legislation.

The JAAC was outlawed on Friday by authorities, citing concerns over public order and security.

India maintains that Pakistan has been in illegal possession of Indian territory in the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh.

According to Commissioner Sardar Waheed Khan, at least seven civilians and four policemen were killed during Sunday’s clash between police and JAAC protesters in PoK’s Rawalakot.

Authorities have arrested over 100 people before and after the clashes. Clashes broke out after tensions flared over the death of a trader, who was allegedly shot during a confrontation with law enforcers on Friday night. Officials accused the demonstrators of attacking the Combined Military Hospital in Rawalakot on Sunday.

In a statement on Monday, the

Key Points

- » Around 11 people, including four police officers, were killed and hundreds injured during violent clashes in PoK
- » India maintains that Pakistan has been in illegal possession of Indian territory in the Union Territories of J&K and Ladakh
- » Authorities have arrested over 100 people before and after clashes

HRCP strongly condemned the use of excessive force and the deaths of civilians and law enforcers alike, as well as communication blackouts.

“While dialogue is essential, it cannot be meaningful amid the continued political disenfranchisement of the region’s people. The right to peaceful protest must be upheld, and grievances addressed transparently,” it said.

The commission urged both the federal and the so-called regional government “to avoid further escalation, respect people’s fundamental rights and commit to genuine, inclusive negotiations.” The HRCP has also announced sending a fact-finding mission as soon as possible to assess the situation.

AGENCIES

Armenian PM Nikol Pashinyan claims victory in election

YEREVAN: Armenian Prime Minister Nikol Pashinyan early Monday claimed victory in a general election seen as a test of Russia’s influence in the South Caucasus state, as preliminary results showed his governing Civil Contract party came first with 49.81 per cent of the vote.

Pashinyan and the governing Civil Contract party were looking for a strong mandate for a new geopolitical course for Armenia, including distancing the former Soviet republic from Moscow, seeking to join the Euro-



Armenian PM Nikol Pashinyan

pean Union and deepening cooperation with the West.

Casting his vote on Sunday, Pashinyan said that the country would continue strengthening its

independence, statehood, democracy and rule of law.

“The European Union is our main partner in democratic reform implementation, and we will continue that path,” he said. Pashinyan’s main opponent, Samvel Karapetyan, is a billionaire who made his fortune in Russia and is under house arrest for allegedly advocating for the government’s overthrow. Karapetyan, whose Strong Armenia bloc was the runner-up with 23.29 per cent of the vote, has rejected the charge as politically motivated.

AGENCIES

Ukrainian strikes hit oil sites in Russia & Crimea

KYIV: Ukrainian forces struck oil facilities in Russia and occupied Ukraine, Ukrainian and Russian officials said on Monday, as part of their campaign aimed at making Moscow pay an economic cost for the war.

Separately, Ukraine’s President Volodymyr Zelenskyy has confirmed that Roman Abramovich acted as a go-between for messages between Kyiv and Moscow.

Zelenskyy told Sky News that the former owner of Premier League team Chelsea traveled

to Kyiv with a message from Russian President Vladimir Putin. Zelenskyy said Abramovich brought the message that the Russians “want to understand what we are ready to do,” and had offered to take a reply to Putin.

AGENCIES

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
Regd Office: Plot No. 10, Patigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secundrabad-500003, Telangana India
CIN: U40107G1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)
HOD: C&I & IT, GATPL, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:
1. Tender Enquiry No. 163/GATPL/JMD/50007664 dated 05/06/2026
“Award of Non comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of UPS systems for entire plant at GVK Power Goindwal Sahib Ltd, Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran Punjab at GATPL”
or 2X270 MW Guru Amar Das Thermal Plant (GATPL), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab, as per details given in the tender specifications.
For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 05/06/2026 from 17:00 Hrs onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
GATP-56/26 PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2026-27/12132

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
The Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Const), Northern Railway, Shivaji Bridge, New Delhi for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-tender for the following work:-
1. Name of work and location: Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 25 KV AC single phase OHE for the work of “Y connection at Garhi Harsaru to avoid reversal at Garhi Harsaru (2.5 Km) of Northern Railway”.
2. Completion period of the work: 12 Months
3. Approx. Cost of work: Rs. 2,25,51,677/-
4. Bid Security to be deposited Rs.4,51,000/-
5. Date & Time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender: Tenders may be uploaded upto 15:00 hrs on 30.06.2026 date on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in. The bidders can participate in the e-tender, the tender will be opened at 15:00 hrs on 30.06.2026
6. Detailed Tender Notice & Tender Document. The detailed e-tender notice is available on Northern Railway web site i.e. www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in and tender document is available on www.ireps.gov.in
Above tenders document will be available for submission of offer on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 16.06.2026 to 30.06.2026.
All other terms and conditions in respect of above tenders are given in tender document.
The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.
Tender No. 17-Elect.Dy.CEE/C/CSB/TRD/169 Dated: 08.06.2026 1959/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: “UJJWAL”, Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40104UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com
Letter No: 484 Date: 08/06/2026
“e-Procurement”
Date Extension Notice No. 01
Due to unavoidable reasons, the date of submission and opening of the following tender invited by the Executive Engineer (Civil-SHP), UJVN Ltd., Dharchula is extended as follows.
Tender Notice Reference: NIT No.: 02/EE (Civil-SHP)/Dharchula/2026-27.
Last date & Time for submission of Tender on the Portal: up to 17:00 hrs. of 15.06.2026
Last Date & Time of Receipt of relevant document in Office : up to 11:00 hrs. of 16.06.2026
Date & Time of Opening of Tender on the portal: at 15:00 hrs. of 17.06.2026
For the eligibility and other detailed information, the e-procurement portal “<http://uktenders.gov.in>” keep watching continuously.
“AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY”

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
For & on behalf of President of India, Divisional Railway Manager (Electrical), Chakradharpur, South Eastern Railway invites E-Tenders for the under mentioned works. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.
SI.No.-1. E-Tender Notice No.: RSO-SANFILLG-CKP-DPS-8. Date: 05.06.2026. Name of work: Supply, unloading, storing and filling of river sand in electrical and diesel locos at CKP & DPS (Chakradharpur & Dangoaposi) station round the clock for 1096 days [Sand will be screened and dried by the contractor. Specification of treated sand will be M-916-51 (Car and locomotive sand). Tender Value: ₹ 1,18,57,791.62. E.M.D.: ₹ 2,37,200. SI.No.-2. E-Tender Notice No.: RSO-HV-BNDM-ROU-9. Date: 05.06.2026. Name of work: Hiring of four (04) nos. of Non-AC road vehicles (Tata Sumo/Bolero/ Scorpio or similar) for transportation of Crew and Train Manager with their belongings from Bondamunda (02 vehicles) and Rourkela (02 vehicles) lobby to any station and back when and where required round the clock for two years. Tender Value: ₹ 1,25,99,434.24. E.M.D.: ₹ 2,52,000. Cost of Tender Form: Nil (for SI.No. 1 & 2). Place of opening of e-tender: Office of the Sr. DEE (OP)/Chakradharpur, South Eastern Railway (for SI.No. 1 & 2). Date and time of closing of tender: 15.00 hrs. of 29.06.2026 (for SI.No. 1 & 2). Date and time of opening of tender: 15.30 hrs. of 29.06.2026 (for SI.No. 1 & 2). Tender can be viewed at website <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. The tenderer/bidder must have Class-III digital signature certificate & must be registered under IREPS portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. (PR-288)

Xi Jinping pledges ‘unwavering’ support to Kim Jong Un

BEIJING: China’s President Xi Jinping, on a rare visit to long-term ally North Korea, on Monday pledged Beijing’s “unwavering” support to its leader Kim Jong Un.

Xi’s comments during his two-day visit came in the backdrop of Kim deepening ties with Russia in recent years, much to China’s unease.

This is the Chinese president’s first trip to North Korea since 2019 and also his first foreign visit this year.

“No matter how the international situation changes, the firm stance of the Chinese [Communist] Party and government in highly valuing the traditional friendship between China and the DPRK [Democratic People’s Republic of Korea] will not change,” Xi told Kim, China’s state-run Xinhua news agency reported.

“The unwavering support for the socialist cause of the DPRK led by Comrade General Secretary Kim Jong-un will not change; and the firm determination to safeguard the common interests and favourable strategic environment of both China and the DPRK will not change,” Xi said.



This is the Chinese president’s first trip to North Korea since 2019 and also his first foreign visit this year

‘No matter how the global situation changes, the firm stance of the Chinese Party in friendship between both countries will not change

Xi did not mention denuclearisation in his talks with Kim.

Beijing opposes nuclear

weapons on the Korean Peninsula and supports denuclearisation, while North Korea, which has conducted multiple nuclear tests since 2006, publicly declares itself a nuclear-armed state.

Xi also called for stronger exchanges at all levels in areas such as foreign policy, law enforcement and the military and urged the two sides to step up their strategic coordination and collaboration to “firmly safeguard their own sovereignty, security and development”.

AGENCIES

World Briefs

POPE MEETS WITH 6 CLERGY ABUSE SURVIVORS IN SPAIN

MADRID: Pope Leo XIV met Monday with six survivors of clergy sexual abuse in Madrid and vowed to consider their suggestions for how the Catholic Church can improve its response to the crisis, the Vatican said. The meeting, which followed in the tradition of popes meeting with abuse survivors during their foreign trips, lasted about an hour and took place at the Vatican embassy in Madrid, the Vatican said in a statement. Spain’s Catholic hierarchy has only recently begun reckoning with its legacy of abuse and cover-up after long dismissing the severity of the scandal that came to light thanks to reporting by the newspaper El País.

US PILOTS DIE AFTER PLANE CRASHES IN DOMINICAN REPUBLIC

SANTO DOMINGO: A pilot and co-pilot from the United States have died in a fiery plane crash as they attempted an emergency landing in the Dominican Republic, authorities said. The incident occurred Sunday near the southern coastal town of La Romana, according to a statement by the Dominican Institute of Civil Aviation, which identified the pilot and co-pilot as US citizens. It wasn’t immediately known what caused the crash. No passengers were aboard. MLB All-Star former catcher Yadier Molina said on social media that the plane was bound for Texas to pick him up, along with family and friends. “My condolences to the pilots and their family!” he wrote. Molina and his group were headed to Puerto Rico. Officials said the plane had departed from Puerto Rico and landed in the Dominican Republic to refuel before heading to Texas.

CITY: Pg 5

DDMA meet: L-G eyes ex-Agniveers for fire dept



NATION: Pg 7

President Murmu confers Gallantry Awards



FILM: Pg 14

'I don't want to compromise'



DELHI DRAMA UNFOLDS

TMC MPs defy leadership, meet Union Min, BJP watches closely

Rebel group says around 20 Lok Sabha MPs have broken ranks

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Even as Trinamool Congress chief and former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and her nephew Lok Sabha MP Abhishek Banerjee were attending the INDIA bloc meeting here on Monday, the party appears to be under severe strain as the crisis within the party seems to be deepening further.

Defying the leadership of Mamata Banerjee, several Trinamool Congress MPs went ahead and met Union Minister Bhopendra Yadav at his residence at 9, Motilal Nehru Marg, barely a couple of kilometers away from the Constitution Club where opposition INDIA bloc meeting was in progress. The rebel Trinamool Congress MPs meeting with Bhopendra Yadav assumes an added significance as it took place in the presence of Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari.



The big political drama began in the afternoon when Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, a long-time colleague and confidant of Mamata Banerjee, claimed that nearly 20 Lok Sabha members had flouted the party's chain of command and were prepared to pursue a well-thought-out legal strategy.

The exact number of MPs is not known, though. Neither of the TMC's Lok Sabha MPs

who were at Union Minister Yadav's residence spoke to the media. They came in through the front gate and exited from the back gate.

According to sources, Lok Sabha members - Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar (Barasat), Prasun Banerjee (Howrah), Satadbi Roy (Birbhum), Asit Mal, Bapi Halder (Mathurapur), June Malia (Medinipur), Jagadish Basunia (Cooch

TAKEAWAYS

» Meeting held during INDIA bloc session; Suvendu Adhikari present

» Exact number of dissident MPs remains unclear

» Around 12 TMC Lok Sabha MPs attend Yadav residence meeting

» Three more MPs reportedly back rebels from behind scenes

» Rebels reportedly exploring legal route to avoid anti-defection law

» Group claims Kakoli sent NDA-support letter to Speaker Om Birla

» Lok Sabha sources say no such letter received by Speaker's office

» Dissidents oppose Kakoli's removal as TMC Lok Sabha chief whip

Behar), Kalipada Soren (Jhargram), Arup Chakraborty (Bankura), Partha Bhowmick (Barrackpore), Sharmila Sarkar (Bardhaman Purba) and Dev Adhikari (Ghatal) were present in the meeting. Those who have reportedly pledged support from behind the scenes - although not physically present at the meeting, three MPs have already held discussions with the

BJP leadership - are Rachana Banerjee (Hooghly), currently on a family vacation abroad; Yusuf Pathan (Baharampur) and Shatrughan Sinha (Asansol).

The new group of dissident Trinamool Lok Sabha members asserted that their leader, Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, had sent a letter endorsing the NDA to Speaker Om Birla.

Continued on P6

INDIA BLOC MEETING STRESS ON UNITY

Opposition leaders seek Pradhan's resignation, to write to CJI on SIR

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Putting up a united show of strength to take on the ruling BJP, the opposition INDIA bloc parties on Monday unanimously decided to demand Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over the NEET-CBSE row and write to the Chief Justice of India on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise and "vote loot".

Addressing a media briefing after the meeting, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said the INDIA bloc also decided to hold more frequent meetings, continue coordination in Parliament and ask the Central government to convene an all-party meeting to discuss people-centric issues.

"On April 17, 2026, we demonstrated our unity and solidarity in the Lok Sabha in a very decisive manner when we all came together firmly to defeat the Modi government's malicious bills on delimitation. Now we must strengthen that same spirit even further and move forward, so that



Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge addresses the media after the INDIA bloc meeting at the Constitution Club of India, in New Delhi PTI

FIVE KEY ISSUES

» Pradhan resignation over NEET-CBSE row

» CJI petition on SIR, alleged "vote loot"

» Joint push on jobs, inflation, social justice issues

» Stronger INDIA bloc coordination, bi-monthly meetings

» Demand for all-party meet on economy and national concerns

AAP, DMK confirm exit from INDIA bloc

NEW DELHI: The absence of the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and the DMK from the INDIA bloc meeting in New Delhi on Monday highlighted growing strains within the opposition alliance, with both parties publicly stating that they were no longer part of the grouping.

AAP Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh said the party had already made its position clear and therefore had no reason to attend the meeting. "We have clarified several

Continued on P6

Ujjwala LPG subsidy limited to four cylinders

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Centre has reduced the number of subsidised LPG cylinders available annually under the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) from nine to four, saying the revised limit is in line with the average consumption of beneficiary households.

Addressing a press briefing on Monday, Petroleum and Natural Gas Ministry Additional Secretary Praveen Mal Khanooja said the new entitlement broadly reflects the average annual usage among PMUY consumers. The scheme, launched in May 2016, provides deposit-free LPG connections to adult women from poor households. Beneficiaries were originally eligible for 12 subsidised 14.2-kg cylinders each year. The quota was reduced to nine cylinders last year and has now been cut to four.

The government introduced a direct benefit transfer subsidy of Rs 200 per 14.2-kg cylinder in May 2022 to make cooking gas more affordable. The subsidy, available for up to 12 refills a year, was increased to Rs 300 per

Continued on P6

CLOSER LOOK

» Centre reduces annual subsidised LPG cylinder quota under PMUY from nine to four

» Government says revised quota reflects average annual consumption of Ujjwala households

India witnessed many transformations in last 12 years, says PM Modi

'Direct benefit transfers, housing and healthcare schemes drove change'

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday said the welfare of the poor has remained at the centre of the government's policies over the past 12 years, as he highlighted a series of flagship schemes on the completion of two years of his third term in office.

In a post on X carrying the hashtag #12YearsOfGaribKalyan, Modi said India has undergone significant changes since 2014, with efforts focused on improving the lives of the poor and marginalised sections of society. He cited programmes such as Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT), Swachh Bharat Mission, PM Awas Yojana and Ayushman Bharat as key initiatives aimed at providing dignity and opportunities to citizens.

"Over the last 12 years, India has witnessed many transformations and at the core of these changes is the welfare of the poor and downtrodden," the Prime Minister said.

Modi said the government's approach has been guided by the principle of "Antyodaya", which seeks to ensure that the benefits of development reach those who had remained excluded for decades. According to him, technology has played an important role in improving service delivery and enhancing the quality of life of beneficiaries.

He said digital platforms and the DBT system have enabled welfare assistance to reach people directly and



OVER THE LAST 12 YEARS, INDIA HAS WITNESSED MANY TRANSFORMATIONS AND AT THE CORE OF THESE CHANGES IS THE WELFARE OF THE POOR AND DOWNTRODDEN

transparently. "This has reduced leakages, improved efficiency and strengthened trust in governance," he said.

The Prime Minister added that the push for welfare measures has evolved into a broader effort to empower citizens and contribute to the vision of a developed India, or "Viksit Bharat". Monday marked two years since the completion of Modi's third consecutive year in office after he was sworn in as Prime Minister on June 9, 2024, following the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance's victory in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. He first took office on May 26, 2014, and began his second term on May 30, 2019.

Israel and Iran trade strikes, threatening to drag region back into full-scale war

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: Israel and Iran traded fire Monday in their first attacks since the US struck a ceasefire with Tehran two months ago. The Iranian military said hours later that it was halting offensive operations as the renewed hostilities threatened to drag the Middle East back into a full-scale war.

The US told Iran there would be no more attacks by Israel if Iran halted its missile strikes, and that Israel has agreed to halt attacks for now, according to a regional official who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak to the media.

The White House and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's office did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Since the US and Israel began striking Iran on Feb 28, the war has shaken the global economy, driven energy prices up around the world and made many basics, including food, more expensive. Officials have been unable to turn the April ceasefire into a deal to permanently end the conflict.

During the truce, Iran has maintained its stranglehold on the Strait of Hormuz - a crucial passage for the world's oil and natural gas whose closure was the primary reason global fuel prices skyrocketed.

Continued on P6

The White House and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's office did not immediately respond to a request for comment

NOW HAS 190 NUCLEAR WARHEADS: SIPRI

India 5th largest military spender in 2025

MPOST BUREAU

STOCKHOLM/NEW DELHI: India's military expenditure rose sharply in 2025 and its nuclear arsenal expanded modestly, according to the latest yearbook released by the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI), which also warned that the world is entering a period of renewed nuclear competition marked by rising geopolitical tensions, weakening arms control mechanisms and growing reliance on nuclear weapons. The report places India as the world's fifth-largest military spender with defence expenditure of USD 92.1 billion in 2025 and estimates that the country now possesses



around 190 nuclear warheads, up from 180 previously. SIPRI said India continued to modernise

HIGHLIGHTS

» Defence expenditure rose 8.9% year-on-year

» SIPRI says India slightly expanded its nuclear stockpile and continued developing new delivery systems

» Nuclear modernisation increasingly focused on long-range capabilities targeting China, while Pakistan remains a key security concern

» India advancing MIRV technology, canisterised missiles and sea-based deterrent capabilities

» SIPRI says India may occasionally deploy nuclear warheads aboard ballistic missile submarines during peacetime patrols

its strategic forces while focusing increasingly on long-range capabilities aimed at strength-

ening deterrence against China, even as its long-standing rivalry with Pakistan remains central to security planning.

The SIPRI Yearbook 2026, released on Monday, said India's military spending increased by 8.9 per cent from the previous year. Only the United States, China, Russia and Germany spent more on defence during 2025.

According to the report, the United States remained the world's largest military spender with expenditure of USD 954 billion, accounting for 33 per cent of total global military spending despite a 7.5 per cent decline from 2024. China ranked second with spending of USD 336 billion, followed by Russia at USD 190 billion. India's expenditure of USD 92.1 billion placed it fifth globally.

Continued on P6



Flames erupt in Vizag steel plant after molten iron spilt while being moved in a bucket by a crane, in Visakhapatnam PTI

CENTRED 32 KM OFF SARANGANI COAST

Strong 7.8 earthquake kills 35, triggers tsunami in Philippines

DAVAO (PHILIPPINES): A powerful 7.8-magnitude earthquake struck off the southern Philippines on Monday, killing at least 35 people, injuring more than 200 and triggering a tsunami that sent waves of up to one metre onto nearby coastlines.

The quake, the strongest to hit the country this year, struck at 7:37 a.m. and was centred in the sea off Mindanao at a depth of 33 km, about 32 km southwest of Maasin town in Sarangani Province. Authorities said 17 people died in Sarangani, including 13 killed in a landslide in Glan. Most other fatalities were caused by collapsing



buildings and falling debris in South Cotabato, Davao Occidental and Balut Island.

General Santos, a city of more than 700,000 people, suffered extensive damage, with several low-rise buildings collapsing or sustaining heavy damage. At least four people

remained missing as rescuers searched damaged structures, including a supermarket, warehouse and school.

"The shaking was very strong and people dashed out of houses into the streets," regional disaster official Rod Sosmeña said.

See P2

Several Indian workers killed in road accident in Dubai

DUBAI: Several Indian workers were killed on Monday when a minibus collided with a truck that had stopped in the middle of a road in Dubai, the authorities said.

"Deeply saddened by the tragic road accident in Dubai that claimed the lives of several Indian workers," the Indian Consulate in Dubai said in a post on X.

The mission said that it is working closely with local authorities to provide all possible assistance and support.

Brigadier Juma Salem bin Suwaidan, Director of the General Department of Traffic at Dubai Police, said that preliminary investigations showed the truck had stopped suddenly in the middle of the Emirates Road due to a technical fault.

"The bus driver, who allegedly failed to pay attention and keep a safe distance, then rammed into the truck from behind," he said in a statement.

"The accident resulted in seven fatalities and nine injuries, including five serious and four moderate injuries. All injured were transported to the hospital for treatment," he added.

The officials from the Indian mission visited the hospital and met the injured Indians.

"Our heartfelt condolences and prayers are with the grieving families during this difficult time," the mission said.

Brigadier Juma Salem said that experts from the Traffic

Continued on P6

INDIA ON LADAKH STANDOFF

What went wrong in hotel blaze: Tea break, unattended fryer...

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A tea break, an unattended oil fryer left burning, and a cook who quietly walked away without alerting anyone as flames began to spread — these lapses have now emerged as critical links in a chain of failures leading to the Malviya Nagar hotel fire that claimed 22 lives.

Investigations have revealed that a nearly 30-minute delay before the first emergency call was made allowed the fire to intensify unchecked, turning what began as a routine kitchen oversight into a devastating tragedy that may have been prevented with timely action.

According to the police, the fire at Flourish Stays B&B in Malviya Nagar's Hauz Rani area on June 3 began after an oil fryer was inadvertently left switched on while the cook prepared tea for himself.

As the oil in the fryer reached its auto-ignition temperature, it ignited suddenly, setting the ceiling ablaze and triggering a rapidly-spreading fire that quickly engulfed the building. The blaze spread faster, fuelled further by highly inflammable materials such as cartons stored within the premises.

While the probe deepened, hotel owner Lavkesh Bajaj's close associate and accountant Jay Mishra (34) surrendered before a Delhi court on Monday and was sent to two days' police custody. Investigators believe Mishra played a key role in the day-to-day management of the establishment and are examining his involvement in the hotel's operations, finances,



licensing and compliance with safety regulations.

Police are also preparing to seek technical assistance from IIT-Delhi to scientifically examine how the blaze spread so rapidly through the building.

Officials said the institute may be asked to conduct a structural and fire-propagation study, including possible 3D mapping of the gutted premises, to help reconstruct the sequence of events and identify factors that trapped occupants inside.

According to investigators, three staff members were present in the building when the fire started on June 4 — cook Keshav Negi, a helper sleeping on the top floor, and manager Rupesh alias Rakesh.

During questioning, Negi allegedly told police that he switched on a fryer containing oil and then prepared tea for himself. While drinking tea, he forgot that the fryer was still running. After it overheated, it burst into flames that spread to the ceiling before engulfing nearby combustible material.

Police said Negi initially attempted to extinguish the

flames but fled when the fire grew beyond his control.

Investigators allege that he failed to warn guests, inform neighbours or call emergency services despite having sufficient time to do so.

"The gap between the first signs of fire and the first call to police was around half an hour. This period is being closely examined because timely evacuation and alerting authorities could have reduced the scale of the tragedy," a source said.

The helper sleeping on the top floor escaped by jumping from the terrace, while manager Rupesh allegedly fled from the reception area on the ground floor. Police are still searching for him.

Investigators believe the failure of staff members to immediately raise an alarm may have contributed to the high death toll. A Nigerian national undergoing treatment succumbed to injuries on Saturday, taking the number of deaths to 22. The deceased was identified as Okale, who had suffered severe burn injuries and was undergoing treatment at Safdarjung Hospital.

WITH PTI INPUTS

Owner's aide Jay Mishra surrenders before court

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Jay Mishra, an accused in the south Delhi hotel fire that killed 22 people, on Monday surrendered before a court here and was sent to police custody for two days, officials said. A close associate and accountant of hotel owner Lavkesh Bajaj, Mishra surrendered before the Judicial Magistrate Bhanu Pratap Singh and was formally arrested by the Delhi police.

According to police, Mishra had been booked earlier too, in 2024, in connection with the absence of a security apparatus in the hotel. The FIR was registered under section 223 (Causes danger to human life, health, or safety) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Police also said that key hotel documents were in the name of Mishra.

The police, while seeking the custody of the hotel owner last week, contended before the court that Bajaj's custody was needed to trace, locate and apprehend Mishra and Rakesh, the hotel manager, as their roles had come under scrutiny in the preliminary probe.

Several other individuals connected with the establishment have also been detained and are being questioned as part of the ongoing investigation into the fire at Flourish Stays Bed and Breakfast in Malviya Nagar's Hauz Rani area on June 4.

According to police sources, Mishra has known Bajaj for

nearly a decade and worked as a frontman for several of his business interests while also handling financial and accounting matters.

Investigators believe he played a key role in the day-to-day functioning of the hotel and are examining the extent of his involvement in its management, licensing, finances and operational decisions.

Multiple police teams were formed to conduct raids in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar to trace him.

Police had earlier questioned hotel owner Bajaj, who is in custody, regarding the property's ownership structure, finances, safety compliance and operational practices. During questioning, Bajaj allegedly told investigators that he had delegated the hotel's operations to Mishra. Officers are scrutinising documents, financial records and other business transactions to determine who was responsible for the hotel's functioning and whether mandatory safety norms were ignored.

The investigation has already led to the arrest of the hotel's 65-year-old cook, Keshav Negi, who was produced before a court and remanded to police custody. According to investigators, Negi was preparing food when the fire broke out. The blaze claimed 22 lives, including that of a 16-year-old girl, and 12 foreign nationals from countries such as Kyrgyzstan, Nigeria, Bangladesh, Iraq, Congo, Mozambique and Liberia.

DU prof death: CCTV reveals masked family's movements

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The family of three who allegedly killed a DU assistant professor here were found climbing the stairs of the apartment building covered in face masks, fresh CCTV footage with the police shows.

The footage shows the couple from Burdwan, West Bengal and their 13-year-old son going towards the flat of Shivaji College assistant professor, Debosmita Paul, shortly before she was killed, police said on Monday.

Another CCTV footage, alleged to be after the murder, shows that they had changed their clothes and the mother and son had removed their face masks.

Paul, an assistant professor at Shivaji College, was found dead in her sixth-floor flat at Satyam Apartments in east Delhi's Vasundhara Enclave on June 3.

Delhi Police has apprehended the couple and their son in connection with the murder, which investigators say stemmed from a long-running property dispute in West Bengal.

According to the new footage, the family can be seen climbing the staircase of the apartment building together. The man, identified as Ram-

prashad Das, is seen carrying a red bag while all three are wearing face masks in an apparent attempt to conceal their identities.

In another CCTV clip, the trio is seen exiting a lift inside the residential complex. However, this time only the father is seen wearing a mask, while the woman and the minor boy appear without face coverings.

The footage also shows the child removing his mask while moving through the premises, investigators said.

The two CCTV clips also show a change of clothing by the husband and wife.

In the first footage, Ramprashad Das (42) is seen wearing a white shirt, while in the second, he appears in a red shirt. Similarly, Banashree Das (36) is seen wearing a black-and-white salwar kameez in the staircase clip, but is later captured in a red salwar kameez in the lift footage.

Police are examining the footage as part of their effort to reconstruct the family's movements before and after the killing.

Investigators said the accused family had been residing in Paul's ancestral property in Burdwan, West Bengal, since 2023. The property had been allotted to the victim through

a family settlement and she had repeatedly asked the family to vacate the premises.

According to police, Paul had recently issued a final warning to the family to vacate the property, following which they allegedly conspired to kill her, nearly 1,400 km away from home, in Delhi on June 3.

The accused, who were known to the victim, allegedly gained entry into the apartment without resistance and murdered her inside the flat. Police said they carried the murder weapon with them and later took several steps to evade detection.

After the murder, the family allegedly fled in a taxi and later an autorickshaw -- to Anand Vihar and then New Delhi Railway Station. They then boarded the Poorva Express back to Burdwan.

Following an extensive investigation involving scrutiny of footage of nearly 200 visitors and raids across four states, police tracked the suspects to Burdwan and apprehended the trio on June 7.

Police have recovered the deceased's mobile phone, a razor allegedly used in the crime, clothes, a backpack, a cap and travel-related documents. Further investigation is underway.

Man held for using AI-morphed images to extort women online

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested a 30-year-old man for allegedly using AI-generated morphed images to blackmail young women and extort money through social media platforms, an official said on Monday.

According to police, the accused, identified as Sourav, a resident of Bhalaswa Dairy in north Delhi, was apprehended on June 4. He was previously involved in two cases related to extortion, sexual harassment and stalking.

Police said he would target young women on social media by posing as a job provider. After gaining their trust and obtaining their resumes, he allegedly persuaded them to participate in video verification calls.

Screenshots from these calls were then manipulated using AI-based tools to create obscene images, which were used to threaten victims and extort money.

The case came to light after a 19-year-old woman from Malkaganj lodged a complaint on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP), alleging that she had been blackmailed by an unknown person using manipulated photographs. According to police, the complainant received a message from the accused containing a morphed image of her. He allegedly instructed her to communicate through a social media account operating under the name "Lakshay Garg" and demanded Rs 30,000 in exchange for deleting the image.

MP05T

YEIDA clears key projs



DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: The Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) on Monday approved a series of industrial and infrastructure-related proposals at its 90th board meeting, while reporting a 43 per cent increase in its cash reserves and reviewing progress of key projects linked to the upcoming Noida International Airport.

YEIDA reported a significant rise in capital receipts, which reached around Rs 745 crore as of May 31, 2026, compared with Rs 522 crore during the corresponding period last year, marking an increase of nearly 43 per cent.

To ensure long-term upkeep of civic infrastructure, the board approved the creation of a dedicated corpus fund for the maintenance of roads, sewer networks, power supply systems, drinking water facilities and parks. A separate account will be opened with the State Bank of India, and revenues generated through lease rent, transfer charges, FAR fees and other sources will be deposited into the fund.

Final approval also granted to lease deed formats for major

industrial projects, including India Chip Pvt Ltd, the HCL-Foxconn joint venture, and Escorts Kubota Limited.

Under the Uttar Pradesh government's one-trillion-dollar economy vision, YEIDA had been assigned an investment target of Rs 30,000 crore under GBC 5.0. Officials said investment proposals worth Rs 30 crore have been received, supporting the establishment of 136 industrial units.

The authority also reviewed progress on farmer related initiatives. "Since 2014-15 YEIDA has distributed Rs 3,050 crore as additional compensation to farmers, including those affected by the Jaypee Infratech area. Under the 7 per cent abadi plot scheme, the process has begun for 11,211 farmers, with reservation letters issued to 7,035 beneficiaries and 4,176 plots planned across various sectors," said officials.

The board also approved establishment of a Traffic Parkcum-Training Centre in collaboration with Honda India Foundation and decided to undertake internal development works in several residential sectors through the Engineering Procurement and Construction (EPC) mode.



Rain, winds damage three aircraft at IGIA

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Three Air India Airbus A320 aircraft parked at Terminal 2 of Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport sustained damage on Sunday after strong winds and heavy rain caused ground support equipment and foreign object debris (FOD) to strike the aircraft, prompting aviation authorities to launch an investigation.

According to the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), the incident occurred at around 4:30 p.m. on June 7 during adverse weather conditions that affected operations at the airport.

The aircraft were parked at Terminal 2 when two pieces of ground equipment, positioned at adjacent stands and nearby areas, were displaced by powerful winds and collided with two different aircraft, causing damage at multiple locations.

A third aircraft suffered damage to its right-hand sliding window after being hit by foreign object debris carried by the strong gusts.

Airport operator Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL) confirmed that all three aircraft were immediately withdrawn from service for detailed inspection and maintenance.

The operator stated that the displaced ground equipment belonged to Air India Engi-

neering and IndiGo and moved from their designated positions due to the sudden deterioration in weather conditions.

DIAL also said that no weather warning had been issued by Air Traffic Control regarding the abrupt change in weather that led to the incident. Air India declined to comment officially on the matter.

However, an airline source indicated that the severe weather impacted aircraft belonging to other operators as well. The source added that while two of the three damaged Air India aircraft are expected to return to service shortly after repairs and inspections, the third aircraft may require more extensive maintenance before resuming operations.

The incident has once again highlighted the vulnerability of parked aircraft and ground equipment during sudden weather events at major airports.

Aviation experts note that strong winds can pose significant risks to aircraft on the ground if equipment is not adequately secured.

The DGCA has grounded all three aircraft pending inspection and has initiated a formal investigation to determine the circumstances leading to the damage and assess whether additional safety measures are required to prevent similar incidents in the future.

MCD action against 26 violators

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Monday demolished or partially razed 26 properties and sealed 42 others in a citywide crackdown against illegal structures, officials said.

In addition, the Delhi government's Revenue department inspected 86 properties, taking the total inspection to 452 properties since June 5.

The crackdown comes in the wake of a series of tragedies in the city, owing mainly to lapses in civic structures, flouting of fire safety norms, and corruption. The gravest of them all occurred on June 3, when a blaze ripped through a five-storey hotel, killing 22 people, including a 16-year-old girl and foreign nationals from Nigeria, Kyrgyzstan, Bangladesh, Iraq, Congo, Mozambique and Liberia.

The MCD, acting on directions of Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, has come down heavily against building bylaws violations, carrying out

demolition action against 123 properties and sealing 170 properties since June 1, officials said.

According to official data, the civic body has issued 106 unauthorised construction show cause notices, 60 sealing show cause notices and 42 demolition orders in the last eight days, taking total enforcement actions to 208.

In South Delhi, MCD carried out nine major enforcement actions in areas including Adchini, Said-ul-Azaib, Freedom Fighter Colony, Savitri Nagar, Khirki Extension and Chhattarpur Pahari.

Since June 1, a total of 56 properties have been targeted by the MCD for demolition and sealing across Said-ul-Azaib, Hauz Rani, Khirki Extension, Savitri Nagar, Begumpur, Chhattarpur, Sainik Farms, Khanpur and Gautam Nagar, officials said.

The civic body also said a survey is underway to identify illegal commercial and residential constructions across all zones, warning that strict action will continue under the Master Plan-2021, Unified Building

Bye-Laws-2016, and the DMC Act-1957.

Separately, in a major safety enforcement exercise, authorities inspected 452 sites across the national capital over a four-day drive to check fire safety compliance, emergency preparedness and adherence to building norms.

Officials said 366 sites were inspected between June 5 and June 7, while 86 more properties were sealed on Monday, leading to multiple show cause and closure notices against non-compliant establishments.

The inspections revealed widespread lapses, particularly in budget hotels, guest houses, banquet halls and commercial establishments, where deficiencies in fire safety systems and emergency protocols were found. In Central Delhi's Karol Bagh area, prominent establishments were found operating without basic lifesaving measures.

Lapses ranged from missing emergency exit plans and contact numbers to non-functional fire alarms and water pipelines.

DELHI POLICE PUTS AI-DRIVEN SYSTEM IN PLACE

Clearer paths for lifesavers

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Striving for faster movement of ambulances and fire tenders through Delhi roads, the traffic police is implementing an AI-based traffic management and route-mapping system to ensure quicker movement of emergency vehicles during crises, officials said on Monday. The initiative comes in the wake of several emergencies, especially a recent hotel fire in Malviya Nagar in which 22 people were killed. Some locals had alleged that traffic congestion delayed the arrival of fire tenders at the spot. "Traffic teams monitor live footage of thousands of CCTV cameras. Besides that, our AI-based traffic management system will give us a clear picture of high traffic zones. In any emergency, in the high traffic zones, our systems will alert fire ten-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The initiative comes in the wake of several emergencies, especially a recent hotel fire in Malviya Nagar in which 22 people were killed
- » Some locals had alleged that traffic congestion

delayed the arrival of fire tenders at the spot

» Traffic teams monitor live footage of thousands of CCTV cameras. Besides that, our AI-based traffic management system will give us a clear picture of high traffic zones

ders and ambulances to take the shortest and fastest routes," a senior police officer said.

He further said that officials from the traffic police and fire departments have explored multiple measures to create traffic-free corridors for emergency vehicles and ensure they reach affected locations in the shortest possible time. "The objective is to ensure that fire tenders and ambulances are able to move

swiftly, even during peak traffic hours. Technology can immediately identify the fastest available route and help emergency vehicles avoid congestion," the officer said. He also said that in situations like where ambulance and fire tenders are stuck, additional traffic police will be deployed to clear the roads immediately so help can reach on time. The officer said authorities are analysing traffic volumes

across different parts of the city and studying congestion patterns during various times of the day to develop location-specific emergency response plans.

"Traffic conditions differ significantly across Delhi. By identifying peak congestion periods and vulnerable stretches, we can provide advance route recommendations and ensure that emergency responders always have access to the fastest possible corridor," the officer said.

The mechanism may also include coordinated monitoring between police and fire department control rooms, dynamic route advisories and rapid deployment of traffic personnel whenever a major emergency is reported. "Every minute saved during an emergency can make a critical difference in protecting lives and property," the officer said.

Four injured as bus hits family

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 50-year-old woman and three of her family members sustained injuries after being hit by a Delhi Cluster Bus while crossing Rohtak Road near the Multan Nagar red light in West Delhi on Sunday evening.

The police were alerted about the accident through a PCR call received at the Paschim Vihar East Police Station.

According to the police, the incident occurred at around 6 pm when the victims were reportedly crossing the road and were struck by a bus allegedly being driven in a rash and negligent manner.

The bus, operating on Route No. 954 from Raighat towards Sultanpuri, approached the crossing at

high speed and allegedly failed to respect the right of way of pedestrians.

The impact caused Nir-mala Devi (50) and her accompanying family members, including two minors, to fall onto the road and suffer injuries. The injured victims were initially rushed to Sri Balaji Hospital for treatment. Nir-mala Devi was later shifted to another hospital for further medical care.

The remaining family members, identified as Nisha (23) wife of Arvind and a resident of JJ Colony, Madipur, along with two minor children, sustained minor injuries.

Police said all three were being sent to Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital for medical examination and treatment.

MORE COOL ZONES SOON

The bamboo break



AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: As temperatures continue to soar across the national capital, the Delhi Government has introduced innovative bamboo-based cooling zones that combine natural ventilation, mist cooling systems and sustainable design to provide respite to outdoor workers and vulnerable citizens.

According to the Chief Minister's Office, the initiative has been launched under the Delhi Government's Heat Action Plan to protect residents from heatwave conditions. The Outer North District Administration, in collaboration with SEEDS NGO, has established bamboo cooling zones in Bawana and Alipur, both of which are currently operational and serving the public.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the government plans to expand the initiative to other parts of the city. "Such eco-friendly cooling zones, which provide relief to the public, will also be set up in other areas of Delhi," she said.

Officials said three additional cooling zones are under development, including one being built in front of the Deputy Commissioner's office. The project is aimed at creating environmentally friendly, sustainable and climate-resilient public facilities while protecting vulnerable sections of society from extreme heat.

The cooling zones have

HIGHLIGHTS

- » According to the Chief Minister's Office, the initiative has been launched under the Delhi govt's Heat Action Plan to protect residents from heatwave conditions
- » CM said the govt plans to expand the initiative to other parts of the city
- » Such eco-friendly cooling zones, which provide relief to the public, will also be set up in other areas of Delhi: Gupta

been designed primarily for construction workers, daily wage labourers, rickshaw pullers, drivers, street vendors and others who spend long hours outdoors. Constructed largely from bamboo, the structures have a minimal environmental footprint and rely on natural cooling techniques rather than energy-intensive systems.

The facilities feature vetiver grass screens and mist-based cooling systems that help lower surrounding temperatures. Special arrangements for natural ventilation, including strategically designed exhaust vents and airflow channels, ensure continuous air circulation within the structures. Officials said the design minimises heat absorption while maximising comfort for visitors.

Apart from cooling facilities, the centres also provide chilled drinking water, Oral Rehydration Solution (ORS) packets, fire extinguishers and Information, Education and Communication (IEC) material on heatwave awareness and prevention. Seating and resting arrangements have also been made for visitors.

Highlighting the response from the public, Chief Minister Gupta said, "The cooling zones have received an extremely positive response from the public. For workers, drivers and other hardworking citizens, they are emerging as dependable spaces where people can take temporary rest from the heat and fatigue of the day."

She added that the initiative represents more than just immediate heat relief. "The initiative not only provides immediate relief but also marks an important step towards developing innovation-driven solutions to address future climate challenges," the Chief Minister said, reaffirming the government's commitment to protecting vulnerable communities through climate-friendly measures.

Appealing to residents amid the ongoing heatwave, Gupta urged people to stay hydrated, avoid prolonged exposure to direct sunlight during afternoon hours and make full use of the cooling zones and other public relief facilities. "The safety, health and well-being of citizens remain the Delhi Government's highest priority," she said.

DDMA meet: L-G eyes ex-Agniveers for fire dept

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Amid growing concerns over fire safety following a series of major fire incidents in the Capital, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sarfaraz Khan on Monday asked officials to explore the induction of ex-Agniveers to address manpower shortages in the Fire Department, while simultaneously ordering stricter enforcement against illegal constructions and fire safety violations across the city.

Chairing a meeting of the Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA), attended by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Home Minister Ashish Sood and PWD Minister Parvash Verma, the L-G reviewed Delhi's fire safety preparedness, heatwave response measures and monsoon flood management plans.

Highlighting the need to strengthen emergency response capabilities, Sandhu suggested



that ex-Agniveers could be utilised to fill operational vacancies in the Delhi Fire Services. The proposal was discussed as part of a broader plan to enhance the department's workforce and improve its readiness to deal with emergencies. The meeting also reviewed plans to increase the number of fire stations across Delhi to reduce response times during emergencies.

The L-G stressed that the Capital's vulnerabilities should

be viewed as opportunities to improve preparedness. "The challenges faced by the Capital in terms of disaster vulnerability should be treated as opportunities to learn, prepare and stay resilient," he said.

Reviewing the ongoing crackdown on illegal buildings and misuse of licenses, Sandhu made it clear that enforcement agencies must strike a balance between strict action and public convenience. "While safety rules

must be followed, enforcement should never become an excuse for the harassment of ordinary residents," he said. However, he directed authorities to immediately stop "ongoing blatant and brazen non-compliant illegal construction in the city and unauthorised plotting of land."

During the meeting, officials informed the L-G about the progress of enforcement drives being conducted by special teams comprising District Magistrates, Deputy Commissioners of Police, MCD officials and Delhi Fire Services personnel. These teams have been directed to submit regular Action Taken Reports (ATRs) for monitoring.

Expressing displeasure over the functioning of the Fire Department, Sandhu was informed that no notices had yet been issued by Delhi Fire Services during the ongoing enforcement campaign. He directed the Principal Director of Delhi Fire Services to take

immediate action and submit reports to the offices of the L-G, Chief Minister and Home Minister. The DDMA also accepted Home Minister Ashish Sood's proposal for stricter implementation of Section 32 of the Delhi Fire Services Act, 2007, which allows fire prevention and safety measures to be applied to all multi-storey buildings, irrespective of whether they require a fire safety certificate. The L-G further warned that "any negligence, lack of diligence, or failure to perform will directly impact an officer's Annual Confidential Report (ACR) grading."

Reviewing monsoon preparedness, Sandhu called for strict implementation of desilting works and directed officials to ensure "absolute zero tolerance for waterlogging and flooding" during the rainy season. He added, "Administrative learning must never stop," urging departments to remain open to practical solutions and best practices from all available sources.

Delhi govt to develop 'road management system': CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is developing a Road Asset Management System in collaboration with expert bodies to maintain city roads better, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Monday.

The government has entered into a Memorandum of Agreement with the Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) and the School of Planning and Architecture (SPA) for the task.

"To address challenges such as increasing traffic, air pollution and waterlogging, road maintenance will now move beyond traditional methods and be carried out through a scientific and data-driven system," Gupta said, according to a statement. Given the challenges posed by rapid urbanisation, rising traffic loads, for the first time, Delhi is developing a Road Asset Management System (RAMS) to plan and maintain roads using scientific and data-based approaches, she said.

“To address challenges such as increasing traffic, air pollution and waterlogging, road maintenance will now move beyond traditional methods



"The system will create a digital record of roads, facilitate regular condition assessments and enable maintenance and repair planning based on priority," the chief minister said.

A key objective of the agreement with the two institutes is to move Delhi towards becoming a model for dust-free roads. "Scientific green belts will

be developed along roadsides, local plant species will be promoted, rainwater harvesting and stormwater drainage systems will be strengthened, and sustainable landscaping practices will be adopted to make roads greener, cleaner and more environmentally friendly," the statement quoted Gupta as saying.

Under the initiative, waterlogging will be tackled with road slopes and a redesigned stormwater drainage system.

Under the MoA, CSIR-CRRI will provide technical support in the areas of road engineering, pavement technology, road safety and asset management, while SPA will offer expert guidance on urban design, streetscape planning, public space development, urban landscaping and green infrastructure. Delhi PWD Minister Parvash Sahib Singh said that the agreement marks an important step towards developing the capital's road infrastructure in a modern, scientific and future-ready manner.

City Briefs

INMATE HANGS SELF IN FARIDABAD JAIL HOSPITAL; BROTHER ALLEGES TORTURE

FARIDABAD: A 25-year-old inmate was found hanging in a bathroom of the Neemka jail hospital here, prison authorities said on Monday. Ghazipur native Hritik, alias Rankit Bhadana, had been incarcerated for the past 11 months on various criminal charges, they said. His brother, Rajesh, alleged torture inside. Rajesh said Jail Deputy Superintendent Sajid Khan frequently assaulted Hritik and drove him to suicide. Khan dismissed the allegations, stating that all inmates are treated equally. According to jail sources, Hritik had at least 16 criminal cases registered against him, including those of assault and attempted murder. He had been unwell for the past few days and was admitted to the jail hospital.

MAN COMMITS SUICIDE AS FAMILY DISCOVERS LIVE-IN RELATIONSHIP

GURUGRAM: A 19-year-old man allegedly committed suicide by jumping from the fourth floor of a house in Bhangrola village here after his family discovered he was in a live-in relationship, police said on Monday. The deceased was identified as Vishal, a resident of a village in Agra. He was living in a rented accommodation in Bhangrola village and worked for a private company in Manesar, they said. According to preliminary investigations, Vishal was in a live-in relationship with a young woman. The couple had rented the accommodation after introducing themselves to the landlord as husband and wife, police said. Investigators said family members of both individuals had recently come to know about the relationship.

GOVT TO UNDERTAKE REVENUE AUDIT OF CONCESSIONAIRES IN NARELA, BAWANA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government will undertake an audit of the Narela and Bawana industrial areas for the period 2011-12 to 2025-26, to identify if there were any irregularities and its financial impact, officials said on Monday. Both industrial areas were set up under a public private partnership model by the government agency Delhi State Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation for redevelopment, operation, and maintenance of industrial infrastructure in the city. Under the concession agreement, special purpose vehicles were incorporated and appointed as concessionaires by the DSIIIDC. The concessionaires were entrusted with designing, financing, redeveloping, constructing, operating, and maintaining infrastructure facilities such as roads, drainage, water supply, wastewater systems, solid waste management, parking, horticulture and street lighting within the industrial areas in Narela and Bawana.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Traffic Police and the MCD have decided to implement a coordinated action plan to tackle unauthorised parking and encroachments on public roads, an official said on Monday.

The decision was taken during a virtual coordination meeting chaired by Joint Commissioner of Police (Traffic) Sanjay Tyagi, attended by zonal deputy commissioners of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), senior traffic police officers, assistant commissioners of police and traffic inspectors, Delhi Traffic Police said in a statement.

The coordinated drive is expected to be rolled out across various parts of Delhi in the

TAKEAWAYS

- » The coordinated drive is expected to be rolled out across various parts of Delhi in the coming weeks, says officer
- » 'Unauthorised parking and illegal occupation

of public spaces have emerged as major factors contributing to traffic congestion, road safety concerns and disruptions to the smooth movement of vehicles and pedestrians across the national capital'

coming weeks, the officer said. According to the statement, unauthorised parking and illegal occupation of public spaces have emerged as major factors contributing to traffic congestion, road safety concerns and disruptions to the smooth movement of vehicles and pedestrians across the national capital.

During the meeting, participants reviewed challenges

faced by both agencies in enforcing traffic and municipal regulations. Officials observed that encroachments and illegal parking not only hamper traffic management efforts but also affect accessibility, public convenience and the overall appearance of the city.

"It was unanimously decided that all departments concerned and field formations would work in close coordi-

nation to identify and remove encroachments and take strict action against unauthorised parking," read the statement.

The action plan will include regular joint inspections by traffic police and MCD officials, intensified enforcement drives, improved inter-departmental coordination and continuous monitoring of vulnerable locations.

The agencies also agreed to strengthen information-sharing mechanisms and ensure timely intervention at congestion-prone stretches where illegal parking and encroachments frequently obstruct traffic flow.

Police said the initiative aims to facilitate smoother and safer movement on city roads while improving road discipline and public convenience.

MAXIMUM TEMPERATURE AT 43.4 DEG C

Intense heat grips Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The national capital sizzled under intense heat on Monday, with the Ridge area station recording a maximum temperature of 43.4 degrees Celsius, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The Safdarjung, which serves as the base station for the city, logged 42.2 degrees, two notches above normal. Palam recorded 41.8 degrees, while Lodi Road and Ayanagar settled at 42.6 and 41.6 degrees, respectively.

The national capital had witnessed a warm morning earlier, with the minimum temperature settling at 29.2 degrees Celsius, 1.6 degrees above the season's average.

Delhi witnessed a little relief from the rain, but not at all stations. The 24-hour cumulative rainfall till 8.30 am showed only Palam and Ayanagar receiving some light showers, 3.8 mm and 4.7 mm respectively, but



no station recorded any rain between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, according to IMD data.

The city has recorded a marginal rise in temperature in the last few days. On Sunday, Delhi recorded a maximum of 41.6 degrees Celsius, and 40 degrees Celsius on Saturday.

According to IMD, the maximum temperature is set to see a gradual rise till June 10, with temperatures going up to 43 degrees and then see a drop in temperatures after that due to another thunderstorm activity from June 11.

The air quality was recorded

in the 'moderate' category at 4 pm, with an Air Quality Index (AQI) reading of 151. Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) data showed.

According to the CPCB, an AQI between zero and 50 is considered 'good', 51 to 100 'satisfactory', 101 to 200 'moderate', 201 to 300 'poor', 301 to 400 'very poor', and 401 to 500 'severe'.

The maximum temperature for Tuesday is likely to settle around 43 degrees Celsius, according to the IMD, with strong surface winds predicted during the daytime.

NDMC vice chairperson inspects redev works at KHAN MARKET

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) Vice Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal on Monday inspected ongoing redevelopment works at Khan Market and reviewed civic infrastructure projects in the area, officials said.

During the visit, Chahal assessed work being carried out to upgrade the middle lane of Khan Market, which includes improved drainage, pavement strengthening and flooring upgrades. Estimated to cost about Rs 1.21 crore, the project is aimed at replacing worn-out interlocking tiles and improving pedestrian movement in the busy commercial stretch, the official statement read.

"The redevelopment plan includes a new drainage network, sewer connection chambers, water supply lines, electrical utility ducts, granite stone flooring, interlocking pavers and installation of stainless-steel dustbins," according

During the visit, Chahal assessed work being carried out to upgrade the middle lane of Khan Market, which includes improved drainage, pavement strengthening and flooring upgrades

to the statement. The NDMC vice chairperson noted that several components of the work, including drainage lines, silt collection chambers, water pipelines, sewer inspection chambers and electrical feeder pillar chambers, have already been completed in phases to reduce inconvenience to shoppers and visitors.

Chahal also pointed out challenges in the execution due to dense underground utilities, including electrical cables

and other services beneath the narrow lane, along with continuous footfall and commercial activity that limit large-scale excavation.

He said the civic council is coordinating with concerned agencies to explore temporary overhead electricity arrangements, relocation of feeder pillars and shifting of underground cables wherever feasible to speed up the work while maintaining safety and continuity of services. Chahal later visited Lok Nayak Bhawan and directed officials to take up repair and maintenance work without delay, according to the statement.

He also inspected the Enforcement Department (ED) store at the Safdarjung Airport where a fire incident had recently taken place. He directed officials to expedite auction and disposal of stored material and to strengthen safety measures to avoid such incidents in future, the officials said.

ALL 24 INDIAN CREW MEMBERS SAFE

US-blacklisted tanker MT Marivex attacked off Oman

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: All 24 Indian crew members of a Palau-flagged tanker that caught fire after it was attacked by the US Navy off the coast of Oman on Monday were rescued with the help of Omani authorities.

The vessel, MT Marivex, was blacklisted and sanctioned by the Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC), the financial intelligence and enforcement agency of the US Treasury Department, people familiar with the matter said.

The OFAC acts against vessels involved in violating US sanctions on the sale of Iranian and Russian oil.

The vessel caught fire after it was attacked by the US Navy off the coast of Oman.

MT Marivex is not

Highlights

- » The OFAC acts against vessels involved in violating US sanctions on the sale of Iranian and Russian oil
- » The vessel caught fire after it was attacked by the US Navy off the coast of Oman
- » MT Marivex is not Indian-owned and over the last few days, it made four attempts to evade the US blockade of Iranian ports, the people said
- » The Indian embassy in Oman thanked the local authorities for rescuing the Indian crew members of the vessel
- » The incident came amid renewed hostilities between Iran and Israel

Indian-owned and over the last few days, it made four attempts to evade the US blockade of Iranian ports, the people said.

On three occasions, the vessel turned away after repeated warnings by the US Navy, they said.

"All 24 crew members who happen to be Indian nationals are safe. They have been rescued with

the help of Omani authorities," one of the people cited above said.

The vessel made another attempt to run past the blockade by using Omani territorial waters and it had switched off its signal devices to go undetected, the people said.

This pattern makes it clear that its intention was not above board, they said,

adding the ship was in an "unladen state when it was disabled". The Indian embassy in Oman thanked the local authorities for rescuing the Indian crew members of the vessel.

"We are thankful to the Omani authorities for their swift response and rescue of all the 24 crew members of Indian nationality, onboard MT Marivex, and ensuring their safety," it said in a social media post.

The incident came amid renewed hostilities between Iran and Israel.

Israel carried out air strikes in western and central Iran after Iran fired missiles at northern Israel.

"India deeply regrets the renewed attacks in West Asia. These developments are a matter of utmost concern to the international community," the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

Opposition leaders seek Pradhan's resignation...

Continued from Page 1

We can confront the many political, economic, social, and foreign policy challenges facing the country due to the Modi government's misgovernance," Congress chief said.

The Opposition bloc meeting comes nearly a month after polls in four states. The BJP formed governments in Assam and Bengal. The Congress emerged victorious in Kerala. In Tamil Nadu, superstar Vijay was the big winner.

At the meeting, top leaders of several opposition parties called for the need to safeguard democratic values and address people-centric issues such as unemployment, price rise, "atrocities" against oppressed sections, and sought an all-party meeting to discuss them along with the "precarious" economic situation in the country. They also decided to meet after every two months to ensure opposition unity, with the next meeting scheduled in Hyderabad for August.

The BJP has called the INDIA bloc "a figment of imagination" that lacked conviction on the ground, claiming that there was an implosion within the opposition alliance with disagreements involving the Congress, DMK, Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) and the Left parties.

Leaders of 22 opposition parties and Independent MP Kapil Sibal were part of the deliberations that lasted for more than two-and-a-

half hours at the Constitution Club, amid a BJP surge in the run-up to the next Assembly elections cycle and the 2029 Lok Sabha polls.

The DMK, a key INDIA bloc constituent, did not attend the meeting, while the AAP had already distanced itself from the grouping. Despite speculation, Tamil Nadu's ruling party TVK did not attend the opposition meeting.

The meeting was held in the backdrop of differences emerging among some of the INDIA bloc partners, including the Left and the Congress, over the charge made during the recent Kerala polls that the Left had a political understanding with the BJP.

John Brittas of the CPI-M and D Raja of the CPI raised the issue with the Congress during the meeting.

Trinamool Congress' Mamata Banerjee raised the issue of alleged "political retribution" during and after the recent West Bengal polls.

The deliberations began with a call to forge unity and rework the opposition strategy to take on the BJP while ironing out the differences within after the defeat of regional outfits Trinamool Congress and DMK in the recent Assembly polls in West Bengal and Tamil Nadu, respectively.

Flanked by Rahul Gandhi, Akhilesh Yadav, Mamata Banerjee and other senior leaders of the grouping, Kharge told mediapersons, "We are going to raise many people-centric

issues, which all the parties have unanimously agreed to."

The Congress veteran also said that all the opposition leaders aired their views freely at the meeting, which Shiv Sena-UBT's Uddhav Thackeray and JMM's Hemant Soren joined virtually.

Among those who attended the meeting were Sonia Gandhi, Rahul Gandhi and Kharge from the Congress, Mamata Banerjee and Abhishek Banerjee from the Trinamool Congress, Akhilesh Yadav from the Samajwadi Party, Tejashwi Yadav from the RJD, Omar Abdullah from the National Conference and Mehbooba Mufti from the PDP, along with Left leaders.

NCP (SP) leader Supriya Sule, CPI(M)'s Brittas, CPI's Raja and leaders of some smaller parties were also part of the deliberations.

Kharge urged the opposition leaders to strengthen unity to confront the political, economic, social and foreign policy challenges facing the country due to the Modi government's "misgovernance".

He claimed that the assault on the Constitution continued while the probe agencies were persistently being used as tools to "harass", "intimidate", and "bully" political opponents. He also pointed to the "complete mismanagement" of the examination system, dashing the hopes and aspirations of lakhs of youth.

According to sources, Rahul

Gandhi told the meeting that he was 100 per cent sure that elections are "robbed" in the country. The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha also stressed unity, and said one must bring everyone together with love and affection.

The issue of aligning with the youth-led political movement Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) also cropped up during the discussions, with Akhilesh Yadav and Omar Abdullah calling for associating with the outfit, and Mamata Banerjee speaking about supporting civil society movements.

Akhilesh Yadav, who spoke about "vote chori" and said the Bengal polls were "robbed", appealed to the Congress to show a big heart and back the strongest regional parties.

Uddhav Thackeray lauded Banerjee for having fought the polls like a "lioness".

RJD's Tejashwi Yadav said the bloc's strategy must focus on the 2029 Lok Sabha polls and urged everyone to hit the streets.

Omar Abdullah urged all the opposition parties to look ahead at the 2029 general elections, stressing that Congress is the glue that holds the INDIA bloc together.

The last official meeting of the INDIA bloc was held in Delhi on June 1, 2024, after the Lok Sabha polls. The bloc, which came into existence three years ago, originally comprised more than 25 parties.

From Page 1

TMC MP

However, the Millennium Post was informed by Lok Sabha authorities that Birla is not in the Capital and that no such letters have been delivered to his office.

On the other hand, political analysts assert that this method follows a political pattern that is quite well-known in the state assembly. While 58 Trinamool MLAs created their own bloc in the West Bengal state assembly some time back, now the same pattern has been brought to the Lok Sabha.

Although this new parliamentary bloc will not have a single designated leader, Barasat MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar will continue to function as its Chief Whip.

According to sources, all the dissident Trinamool Congress Lok Sabha members condemned and discussed the way Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar was removed and replaced by Kalyan Banerjee in the post of Chief Whip of TMC in the Lok Sabha during the meeting at Bhupender Yadav's residence.

TMC's Lok Sabha member Kirti Azad took on BJP leadership on social media and posted a letter to the Lok Sabha Speaker, Om Birla, dated May 20, and mentioned, "Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar is claiming that she is the chief whip and because of that, she has written to the honourable Speaker of the Lok Sabha claiming to be the chief whip. Her removal and appointment of Kalyan Banerjee as the chief whip were already informed to the Hon'ble Speaker last month by our Hon'ble chairperson, Mamata Banerjee. The question is how long the BJP will keep hoodwinking the people?"

Insiders said that before joining the BJP, the MPs are reportedly negotiating specific guarantees about their political future in addition to their plans to leave the Trinamool Congress. BJP MP Nishikant Dubey also reportedly attended the meeting at the home of Union Minister Yadav who is also BJP's West Bengal observer.

This apart, political experts feel that if the rebel MPs opt for switching allegiance to BJP directly, these members would have run the risk of being disqualified on the grounds of defection. Instead of defecting to another party, they may form a separate group within the Lok Sabha that seems to follow a legal route by which they can avoid the provisions of the anti-defection law.

TMC Lok Sabha member from Krishnanagar constituency, Mahua Moitra, made a scathing attack on the rebel bloc and said, "MPs won in 2024 on the TMC ticket. Mandate was NOT for NDA. All the greedy, self-serving traitors with yellow-stained pants can please join BJP now- resign your seats & contest on BJP ticket. Let's see what big heroes you are."

Sources also said that in the

meeting with senior BJP leaders, the dissident MPs apparently expressed concern over losing their state-assured security once they leave the Trinamool Congress and also face potential political backlash once they return to their home state. Therefore, they have asked for central security at high levels, with some even requesting an equal or higher level of security.

Political analysts claim that the BJP has handled the matter skillfully to bring about more pressure on the Trinamool Congress leadership, which is already facing trouble within the party after the party's defeat in the recently held state assembly elections.

AAP, DMK confirm

times that AAP is no longer part of the INDIA alliance. Therefore, the question of attending its meeting does not arise," he told reporters. Singh also said the parties attending the meeting should first spell out the agenda and issues under discussion. Referring to reports of differences within the alliance, he claimed such narratives were often promoted by BJP supporters and should not be given undue importance.

AAP chief spokesperson Priyanka Kakkar also ruled out any future alliance with the Congress, alleging that the party had contested the Delhi Assembly elections primarily to weaken AAP.

In Chennai, DMK spokesperson T K S Elangovan said his party, too, was no longer part of the INDIA bloc, blaming the Congress for the split. He said several parties had already distanced themselves from the alliance and the DMK had taken a similar decision.

Elangovan described the Congress joining the C Joseph Vijay-led TVK government in Tamil Nadu after the elections as a "betrayal" that had hurt DMK workers. He said the party would take future political decisions independently through its own committees. At the same time, he said a "strong, secular, and anti-BJP alliance" could emerge in the future and that the DMK would assess whether there was common ground with other opposition parties.

CPI state secretary M Veerapandian, however, urged the DMK to remain within the INDIA bloc and called for strengthening opposition unity at the national level.

Eight killed

transported in a bucket attached to a crane. The metal was reportedly at a temperature of around 1,600 degrees Celsius.

Officials said six injured workers were shifted to two private hospitals in the city, with some reported to be in critical condition. Health authorities informed Andhra Pradesh Health Minister Satya Kumar Yadav that the bodies of four deceased workers had been

brought to the steel plant's general hospital.

Preliminary accounts pointed to a malfunction involving a ladle carrying molten steel. A trade union leader said the equipment failure caused a large quantity of liquid metal to spill, leading to an intense blaze that engulfed workers nearby. Another eyewitness said the accident occurred during operations linked to NTC-3 Heat F, when molten steel leaked while being lifted, sparking the fire.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed grief over the tragedy and announced financial assistance from the Prime Minister's National Relief Fund. "Saddened by the mishap at the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant. Condolences to those who have lost their loved ones. Praying that the injured recover at the earliest," he said in a post on X. He announced an ex gratia of Rs 2 lakh for the next of kin of each deceased worker and Rs 50,000 for those injured.

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu said he was deeply shocked by the accident. He spoke to steel plant authorities and directed district officials to coordinate rescue and relief efforts. "I am distressed to learn that several workers have lost their lives in this accident," Naidu said, adding that all departments had been instructed to assist those affected.

Ujjwala LPG subsidy

cylinder in October 2023. A proportionate benefit is also provided for 5-kg cylinders.

The decision comes amid rising LPG prices. Cooking gas prices were increased by Rs 29 per cylinder on June 7, taking the retail price of a 14.2-kg cylinder in Delhi to Rs 942 after cumulative hikes of Rs 89 over the past three months. After the Rs 300 subsidy, PMUY beneficiaries pay Rs 642 per cylinder.

Khanooja said beneficiaries effectively receive support of about Rs 1,000 per cylinder when compared with the government's estimated supply cost of around Rs 1,600. He noted that the cost of supplying domestic LPG has risen sharply following higher international prices linked to tensions and conflict in West Asia. India's LPG import costs are tied to the Saudi Contract Price benchmark, which has risen about 46 per cent since February due to supply disruptions linked to the Strait of Hormuz.

According to the official, the government has provided Rs 52,000 crore in LPG subsidies since 2022. Despite recent price revisions, oil marketing companies continue to incur losses of around Rs 700 on every 14.2-kg LPG cylinder sold. He also said companies are facing under-recoveries of about Rs 6 per litre on petrol and Rs 30 per litre on diesel, with cumulative losses estimated at Rs 600-700 crore. Petrol and diesel prices were raised by about Rs 7.50 per litre in four instalments last

month, while CNG prices have increased by Rs 6 per kg.

Israel and Iran

Israel has continued to strike Hezbollah, Iran's ally in Lebanon, and pushed deeper into that country. And on Monday, Yemen's Houthi rebels, another Iranian ally, fired at Israel and warned they would target Israel-affiliated ships in the Red Sea.

With little apparent progress in peace talks, Israel and Iran exchanging fire, and the Houthis joining the fight, the risk of the war fully erupting again appeared higher than at any point since the ceasefire.

In the wake of the new attacks, US President Donald Trump wrote online: "Israel and Iran must immediately stop shooting."

Shortly after, the Iranian military's joint command issued its statement. It said that if Israel or its supporters carried out any further "aggression and hostile acts", including in southern Lebanon, then "much more severe and crushing measures than before will follow."

Earlier, two regional officials said concerted diplomatic efforts were underway Monday to salvage the ceasefire.

Officials from Egypt, Saudi Arabia, Turkey, Pakistan and Qatar have urged the Trump administration to pressure Israel to rein in its strikes on Iran and Beirut. They have also urged Iranian officials to stop attacks on Israel, they said. Both officials spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak to reporters.

Trump said talks were ongoing for a ceasefire between Israel and Iran, though he gave no details.

Iran launched waves of attacks on Israel on Monday, and Israel launched strikes on central and western Iran. It was their first exchange of fire since the ceasefire.

Iranian state television reported the sound of explosions in Tehran and other cities. Iran closed the airspace around Tehran's Imam Khomeini International Airport after the Israeli attack.

The semiofficial Fars and Mehr news agencies said Israeli strikes hit a petrochemical factory in the city of Mahshahr. They did not elaborate on any damage. The Israeli military confirmed the strike on the plant, saying it targeted sites that produce materials for ballistic missiles. Israel said it also targeted truck-based missile launchers.

Israel said its strikes were in response to an Iranian missile attack. Tehran warned Sunday that it would retaliate after Israel struck Beirut's southern suburbs without warning. When Israel struck back, Iran fired again.

Explosions could be heard in central Israel as air defences sought to intercept incoming Iranian fire. Iran's paramilitary Revolutionary Guard said it had targeted two military bases in Israel.

Iran blamed the United States for the escalation. "No one believes that the

Israeli regime would take any action without coordination with the United States," Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei told journalists in Tehran.

The White House did not immediately respond to messages about Israel's strikes.

Trump and Netanyahu launched the war in a closely coordinated attack, with Israeli officials proudly boasting of unprecedented "shoulder to shoulder" cooperation throughout the conflict, which reached 100 days on Monday.

But since the first strikes, the two men have moved in opposite directions, with tensions sometimes spilling out into the open. Netanyahu appears to have openly defied Trump with the strike Sunday in Beirut and subsequent attacks in Iran. Trump has voiced his displeasure with Israel, including belittling Netanyahu by declaring to the Financial Times that "I call all the shots."

The differences between the two appear to be rooted in each leader's domestic considerations. Netanyahu faces elections this fall and is under public pressure to strike back against ongoing Hezbollah attacks on northern Israel. He also is wary of appearing too subservient to Trump.

The US president, meanwhile, also faces elections — for Congress in November — and is eager to wrap up a war that has jolted the global economy and raised prices for consumers.

India 5th largest

SIPRI estimated that global military expenditure reached a record USD 2.9 trillion in 2025, marking the eleventh consecutive annual increase and accounting for 2.5 per cent of global GDP. The 15 largest military spenders together accounted for 80 per cent of worldwide military expenditure, amounting to USD 2.304 trillion.

The report also highlighted the deteriorating global security environment. SIPRI said several regional flashpoints remain at risk of escalating into larger interstate conflicts and referred to the military confrontation between India and Pakistan in May 2025 as an "unusually severe military crisis".

The institute noted that India and Pakistan exchanged intense cross-border fire between May 7 and May 10, 2025. It also pointed to the growing role of cyber warfare, saying the two countries integrated cyber operations into armed conflict openly for the first time during the crisis.

SIPRI said the brief conflict saw India strike Pakistani air and missile bases believed to have nuclear-related functions. Despite the intensity of the confrontation, both countries took measures to prevent escalation into a broader conflict.

The report estimates that India's nuclear stockpile stood at approximately 190 warheads as of January 2026, compared

with Pakistan's estimated 170 warheads. SIPRI said India "once again slightly expanded its nuclear arsenal in 2025 and continued development of new types of nuclear delivery systems".

India's nuclear modernisation programme is increasingly focused on developing long-range weapons capable of reaching targets across China. While Pakistan continues to influence strategic planning, China's growing military and nuclear capabilities are playing a larger role in shaping India's force development.

SIPRI noted that India is strengthening all three components of its nuclear triad, comprising land-based, air-based and sea-based nuclear delivery systems. The report highlighted progress in technologies such as Multiple Independently Targetable Re-entry Vehicles (MIRVs), which allow a single ballistic missile to carry multiple warheads capable of striking different targets.

The institute also pointed to advances in canisterised missile systems that improve survivability, mobility and launch readiness. India's missile inventory includes the Prithvi-II and Agni-I short-range missiles, Agni-II and Agni-III medium-range systems, and the longer-range Agni-IV and Agni-V missiles. The newer Agni-P missile is viewed as a more accurate and survivable platform, while development of future long-range systems is believed to be continuing.

A significant aspect of India's nuclear modernisation is the strengthening of its sea-based deterrent. SIPRI said India may now occasionally deploy a limited number of nuclear warheads aboard ballistic missile submarines during peacetime patrols.

India's nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarines, led by INS Arihant, are intended to provide assured second-strike capability. These vessels carry submarine-launched ballistic missiles such as the K-15 and K-4, while future systems including the K-5 missile remain under development.

The report said a survivable sea-based deterrent is becoming increasingly important as missile capabilities in both China and Pakistan continue to evolve.

Pakistan, meanwhile, continued to develop new delivery systems and accumulate fissile material during 2025. SIPRI said these developments suggest Pakistan's nuclear arsenal could expand further over the coming decade.

The institute observed that while India has concentrated on building survivable long-range deterrent capabilities and strengthening its second-strike posture, Pakistan has invested heavily in tactical nuclear weapons and shorter-range systems intended to offset India's conventional military advantages.

Globally, SIPRI estimated that the nine nuclear-armed states, namely the United States, Russia, the United Kingdom, France, China, India, Pakistan, North Korea and Israel, possessed approximately 12,187

nuclear weapons at the start of 2026. Of these, around 9,745 were held in military stockpiles and considered potentially available for operational use.

The report said about 4,012 warheads were already deployed with missiles and aircraft, while between 2,100 and 2,200 remained on high operational alert.

Although the overall number of nuclear weapons worldwide continues to decline, SIPRI said this trend is largely the result of the United States and Russia dismantling retired warheads. At the same time, most nuclear-armed states are modernising or expanding their arsenals, raising concerns that global stockpiles could begin increasing again in the coming years.

SIPRI Director Karim Haggag warned that greater dependence on nuclear weapons in national security strategies could increase the risk of miscalculation. "Influential voices, including some world leaders, are advocating nuclear weapons as a guarantee against attack by a hostile state. But making national defence and security strategies dependent, or more dependent, on nuclear weapons could significantly increase nuclear risks," he said.

Haggag added that advances in weapons technology, the erosion of arms control frameworks and rising geopolitical tensions were increasing the dangers associated with nuclear weapons. He also noted that the conflict between nuclear-armed India and Pakistan had challenged traditional assumptions about nuclear deterrence.

The report further warned that transparency surrounding nuclear arsenals is declining, while diplomatic channels for crisis management are weakening. SIPRI researcher Matt Korda said reduced transparency and deteriorating communication mechanisms were making nuclear crises more unpredictable.

The yearbook also noted a broader shift in international conflict management over the past two decades, with approaches increasingly moving away from a liberal model of peacemaking towards what it described as a more power-based and transactional framework. While the number of countries experiencing armed conflict fell slightly from 50 in 2024 to 49 in 2025, SIPRI said large-scale violence continued across several regions, underscoring the increasingly volatile global security landscape.

Several Indian workers killed

Accident Investigation Section were dispatched to the scene to inspect and gather precise evidence to determine the exact causes of the crash.

"Traffic patrols regulated traffic flow, secured the site, and facilitated the access of rescue vehicles. Work teams also removed the damaged truck and bus to restore normal traffic flow," he said.

AGENCIES

'NEED TO REDUCE FRICTION WITHIN ALLIANCE'

No infighting, Congress as anchor: Inside details from INDIA Bloc meet

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The meeting of INDIA Bloc held on Monday after nearly two years focused on setting aside mutual bitterness, aligning with civil society movements, and acknowledging the Congress as the Opposition alliance's anchor.

Sources said the most emphatic assertion for avoiding criticism of each other came from Trinamool Congress supremo and former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee - a marked departure from her previous efforts to carve out a space for herself independent of the Congress.

Even after the 2024 Lok Sabha poll results, Banerjee had, at various points, questioned the Congress's ability to lead the Opposition alliance. The TMC earlier never missed any opportunity to underline its status as a non-electoral



Opposition leaders during the India Bloc meeting, in New Delhi

ally of the Congress, unlike the DMK.

Ever since suffering a poll drubbing in West Bengal, the TMC chief, grappling with a virtual split in the party, has adopted a reconciliatory tone and become the biggest proponent of the need for an active Opposition alliance.

Sources said that before the meeting formally began, Banerjee had a nearly 10-min-

ute-long conversation with Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi.

In his intervention, Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi also argued that mutual trust and solidarity among Opposition parties would be essential if they were to successfully challenge the ruling establishment.

"It is clear that the Congress and INDIA are on one side and

Highlights

» Sources said the most emphatic assertion for avoiding criticism of each other came from TMC supremo

» 'It is clear that the Congress and INDIA are on one side and on the other side is the BJP-RSS'

PTI

Conference leader Omar Abdullah is learnt to have endorsed the youth-led political movement Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) more directly. "Let's associate with them, they must be doing something right," Abdullah said, according to sources.

Abdullah also categorically asserted that the constituents of the Bloc need to acknowledge that the Congress is the "glue" that holds the alliance together.

He underlined that the Opposition had already achieved something significant by preventing the BJP from getting a majority on its own in the 2024 general elections and urged them to build on that achievement rather than dwell on recent setbacks.

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, seated next to Rahul Gandhi, also stressed on the need to reduce friction within the alliance.

'Drama of gathbandhan, won't make any difference', says BJP

Sambit Patra accuses INDIA Bloc leaders of 'hypocrisy'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The BJP on Monday took a swipe at the Opposition INDIA Bloc over its meeting, saying those who have been turned "completely inactive" by the people are trying to become active somehow but it will not make any difference.

BJP national spokesperson Sambit Patra also accused the INDIA Bloc leaders of "hypocrisy" and said those who were attacking and criticising each other till recently are now doing "drama of gathbandhan's meeting".

"People are watching everything. No matter how many meetings 'INDI gathbandhan (alliance)' holds, they will not yield any result. Such meetings will have no impact," the BJP MP told reporters at the party headquarters here.

"None of these political parties have any presence on the ground... People have completely rendered them inactive,

Takeaways

» 'No matter how many meetings INDI gathbandhan holds, they will not yield any result'

» 'None of these political parties have any presence on the ground'

yet they are somehow trying to become active," Patra added.

Leaders of the Opposition INDIA Bloc met here at the Constitution Club on Monday and stressed the need for unity among its constituents to safeguard "democratic values".

The meeting deliberated on a host of issues and decided to write to the Chief Justice of India on the SIR exercise and "vote loot" besides demanding immediate resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the NEET-CBSE row.

Addressing a press conference after the meeting, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge

said the Opposition leaders also demanded that the Union government convene an all-party meeting to discuss the "precarious economic situation" in the country, unemployment, price rise, farmers' issues and people-centric matters.

Taking a dig at the Opposition parties, Patra said, "Earlier, such meetings (of INDIA Bloc) used to be held in a stadium. They were seen holding each other's hands at a stadium in Bangalore. Their meeting has now shifted to a room at the Constitution Club."

"During elections, (former West Bengal chief minister) Mamata Banerjee said the Congress is losing its credibility. Rahul Gandhi said that the BJP has entered West Bengal due to the bad activities of Banerjee's party.

"And today, they were sitting together. Sonia Gandhi and Mamata Banerjee were hugging each other as if they were sisters separated at the Kumbh Mela," the BJP leader said.

Cong accuses BJP of denying RS nomination to ex-PM Deve Gowda

OUR CORRESPONDENT

BENGALURU: The ruling Congress in Karnataka on Monday took a dig at the BJP, accusing the party of denying a Rajya Sabha nomination to JD (S) patriarch and former Prime Minister H D Deve Gowda from the state for a subsequent term.

The grand old party also claimed that the BJP insulted the people of Karnataka by denying Gowda the Rajya Sabha nomination.

Late on Sunday, the BJP announced Prof M Nagaraja as its Rajya Sabha candidate from Karnataka, where the party can win one of the four seats going to polls on June 18, based on its current strength in



HD Deve Gowda with DK Shivakumar

the Assembly.

The polls were necessary because four MPs, including Gowda are retiring later this month. The JD (S), an ally of the BJP was reportedly hoping the latter would re-nominate its supremo to the Rajya Sabha.

"Yesterday in the dead of the night, BJP has denied a

Rajya Sabha nomination to former Prime Minister, H D Deve Gowda, deciding to choose its state Vice President Incharge of District Building Construction, M Nagaraja over Ex PM," senior party leader and Congress in-charge of Karnataka, Randeep Singh Surjewala posted on 'X'.

"The constant humiliation heaped upon JD (S) by BJP and its leadership and its repeated acceptance by H D Kumaraswamy merely for sticking to a ministerial chair at any cost is highly astonishing and eye-opening. Furthermore, accepting this insult is an absolute extreme," he said.

Kumaraswamy is the son of Deve Gowda and union minister for Heavy Industries.

President Murmu confers Gallantry Awards

NEW DELHI: President Droupadi Murmu on Monday conferred seven Kirti Chakras (including two posthumously), 15 Vir Chakras (including three posthumously) and 29 Shaurya Chakras (including one posthumously) during Phase-I of the Defence Investiture Ceremony 2026 held at Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi.

The gallantry awards were presented to personnel of the Defence Forces, Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs), and State/Union Territory Police in recognition of their exceptional courage, indomitable bravery, and complete disregard for personal safety while performing their duties.

Among the recipients of the Shaurya Chakra were Inspector Laxman Kewat and Inspector Rameshwar Prasad Deshmukh of the Ministry of



Home Affairs, Lieutenant Colonel Neetesh Bharti Shukla of 19 Sikh, Major Aditya Pratap Singh of the Rajputana Rifles attached to 44 Assam Rifles, Major Ashish Kumar of 7 Para (Special Forces), and several other Army, Navy, Air Force, CRPF, and Assam Rifles personnel who displayed

extraordinary valour during operations conducted between April 2024 and January 2026.

The Vir Chakra was awarded to 15 personnel for acts of gallantry, many of whom participated in operations on May 7, 2025. The awardees included Colonel Koshank Lamba, Group Captain Ranjeet

Singh Sidhu, Group Captain Manish Arora, Group Captain Animesh Patni, Group Captain Kunal Kalra, Group Captain Joy Chandra, Lieutenant Colonel Sushil Bisht, Squadron Leader Sarthak Kumar, Squadron Leader Siddhant Singh, Squadron Leader Rizwan Malik, Flight Lieutenant Aarshveer Singh Thakur, and Naib Subedar Satish Kumar.

The Kirti Chakra, India's second-highest peacetime gallantry award, was conferred upon Lance Naik Meenatchi Sundaram A of the Regiment of Artillery attached to 34 Rashtriya Rifles, Naib Subedar Doleshwar Subba of 2 Para (Special Forces), Major Arshdeep Singh of 1 Assam Rifles, Air Commodore Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair, and Captain Lalrinawma Sailo of 4 Para (Special Forces).

MPOST

Animal rights groups question SC dog relocation order, announce protest on June 13

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Animal rights activists on Monday raised concerns over the recent Supreme Court directions on the relocation of stray dogs from public spaces, alleging that it could weaken safeguards against cruelty to animals.

Addressing a press conference organised by the Conference for Human Rights (India) here, the activists said the focus should be on strengthening sterilisation and vaccination programmes rather than removing dogs from their habitats.

They argued that the present situation was the result of years of inadequate implementation of animal birth control and anti-rabies measures by civic authorities.

The activists also announced a protest at Jantar Mantar on June 13 to voice their concerns over the court's directions and their implementation.

Speaking at the event, advocate Nanita Sharma said certain provisions of the order granted protection to officials implementing the directions but did not clearly specify mechanisms to determine whether actions were carried out in "good faith" or with "mala fide intent".

She questioned who would monitor the implementation process and ensure that relocated animals were not subjected to cruelty.

The crisis should not be viewed as a "dog menace", but as a consequence of administrative failures, including inadequate sterilisation and vaccination efforts, Sharma said, stressing the need for compassion towards animals.

Anu Pandey, a professor at the University of Delhi, said educational institutions had long coexisted with community dogs and that students often played a key role in feeding, vaccinating and sterilising them.

Garib Kalyan top priority of Modi government, says Amit Shah

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Monday said that welfare of the poor remains the highest priority of the Narendra Modi-led government and highlighted the achievements of various flagship schemes over the last 12 years.

Under the Garib Kalyan programmes, access to banking has reached millions, thanks to efforts highlighted by Shah on X.

Financial stability now touches more households, shaped through targeted support mechanisms. From food aid to housing, each measure contributes differently. Take



PMGKAY: it feeds families during uncertain times. Shelter finds its way into policy via PMAY, altering urban and rural landscapes alike. Banking inclusion rises as accounts emerge under PMJDY, quietly expanding reach. Small enterprises gain ground where credit flows through PMMY. Even street vendors find footing because of PM SVANidhi's structure. Lives shift when sys-

tems align with need, slowly but steadily.

"Garib Kalyan is the top-most priority of the Modi government. In 12 years of Garib Kalyan, the government has connected crores of citizens to banking facilities, financial security and self-employment opportunities through welfare schemes like the Ann Yojana, PM Awas, Jan-Dhan, Mudra Loan and PM SVANidhi," Shah said.

It was also mentioned how efforts have shaped access for low-income groups to essential services. Mainstream inclusion followed investments in foundational systems. Benefits arrived via steady upgrades in housing, healthcare, and welfare support.

Resolve of 'Viksit Bharat' a national pledge, everyone must cooperate: Birla

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Monday stated that the resolve of 'Viksit Bharat' (Developed India) is a national pledge that requires the active cooperation of every citizen and institution in the country.

He emphasised that to realise this vision, it is imperative that our policies, schemes, programmes and budgetary provisions bring transformative changes to the life of the last person in society.

He noted that we must accelerate social change, strengthen moral values, and guide society in a progressive direction. In this regard, he



Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla at the inauguration of the 2nd Annual Conference of the Zone-II, Commonwealth Parliamentary Association (CPA), in Chandigarh

MPOST highlighted that legislators have a pivotal role to play, as they are the most effective drivers of grassroots change through localised policies and public welfare initiatives.

Physical relationship among consenting unmarried adults no ground to show poor character, says SC

'There is no law which prohibits two consenting unmarried adults to have relationship of their choice'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has held that physical relationship between two consenting unmarried adults cannot be a ground to draw an adverse impression about the character of the person in that relationship.

A bench of Justices Manmohan and Manoj Misra made the observation while directing the Telangana State Level Police Recruitment Board to appoint a candidate whose selection as a police constable was set aside due to his involvement in a criminal case arising from a failed romantic relationship. "Physical relationship between two consenting unmarried adults cannot and should not by itself be a ground to draw an adverse impression about the character of the person in that relationship. There is no law which prohibits two consenting unmarried adults to have a relationship of their choice," the bench said.

The top court allowed the appeal filed by the candidate



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

and upheld a Telangana High Court single judge's order directing reconsideration of his appointment to the post of Stipendiary Cadet Trainee Police Constable.

Telangana State Level Police Recruitment Board had cancelled his appointment on the ground that a rape on promise of marriage case registered against him in 2014 reflected moral turpitude.

The case arose from a relationship with a neighbour and was compounded before a Lok Adalat in 2015 after both par-

ties reached a settlement. No charge under Section 376 IPC was ever pressed.

Referring to the case, the top court said the appellant and the victim were neighbours and in a relationship for about four years.

"Not every relationship culminates in marriage. Therefore, merely because the relationship did not culminate in marriage is no ground to believe that one party has cheated the other.

"Had it been a case of use of force or extension of threat to force a compromise, the respondent would have been justified

Key Points

- » Bench made the observation while directing the Telangana State Level Police Recruitment Board to appoint a candidate whose selection was set aside due to his involvement in a criminal case
- » The apex court said in criminal jurisprudence, unless the charge is proved in a court of law there shall be a presumption of innocence
- » 'Not every relationship culminates in marriage. Therefore, merely because the relationship did not culminate in marriage is no ground to believe that one party has cheated the other'
- » The case arose from a relationship with a neighbour and was compounded before a Lok Adalat in 2015

in taking a call on the suitability of the appellant for appointment in a disciplined force. However, here there is no material to conclude that the compromise was foisted upon the victim," the bench said.

The apex court said in criminal jurisprudence, unless the charge is proved in a court of law there shall be a presumption of innocence.

"In the instant case, the offence alleged was one of cheating. One of the ingredients of the offence of cheating is false representation/decep-

tion. Whether prosecutrix was deceived into entering a relationship, the prosecutrix alone could have disclosed.

"The public at large cannot tell whether she was deceived by the appellant. In such circumstances, when the prosecutrix chose not to pursue and had led no evidence, rather had expressed her consent to compound the case, there was no occasion for the respondents to read in between lines and draw an adverse inference regarding the character of the appellant," the bench said.

Nation Briefs

AICC SECRETARY SURAJ HEGDE DIES

BENGALURU: AICC secretary and Karnataka government's Guarantee Committee vice chairman Suraj Hegde died late last night here, party sources said on Monday. He was aged about 55 years and died at a private hospital due to cardiac arrest, sources said. Hegde, who was the former in-charge of the Indian Youth Congress, was the grandson of former Chief Minister Devaraj Urs. Chief Minister D K Shivakumar condoled the death of Hegde. "I am deeply shocked to learn of the sudden demise of my dear colleague Suraj Hegde, who served as AICC functionary, KPCC Vice-President, and Vice-Chairman of the State Guarantee Committee," Shivakumar posted on 'X'.

BJP EYES SWEEP IN GUJARAT RS POLLS AS CONGRESS FACES WIPEOUT

AHMEDABAD: All four BJP candidates on Monday filed their nomination papers for the upcoming Rajya Sabha elections from Gujarat, and with Congress not contesting, their victory looks certain as of now. With the term of Shaktisinh Gohil ending later this month, the Congress will not have any representative from Gujarat in the upper house of the Parliament. The four Rajya Sabha seats from Gujarat are falling vacant as the six-year terms of sitting MPs Rambhai Mokariya, Narhari Amin, and Ramlaben Bara (all from BJP), and Shaktisinh Gohil of Congress are ending on June 21. Gohil is the lone Congress member from Gujarat in the Rajya Sabha.

‘SYSTEM REMAINED UNDER MONITORING BY CYBERSECURITY TEAMS’

Over 1.6L candidates applied for post-result services: CBSE



MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) on Monday said its post-result services portal was fully functional during the notified application period and more than 1.6 lakh candidates successfully submitted requests for over 3.8 lakh answer books.

In a statement on X, the board said the application window for verification and re-evaluation was fully functional throughout the notified period, June 2-7, under the supervision of government technical agencies and teams from the IITs.

"During the above application period, more than 1.6 lakh candidates successfully submitted requests pertaining to over 3.8 lakh answer books, reflecting the extensive utilisation of the services by the candidates," the CBSE said.

The board said the system remained under monitoring by cybersecurity teams throughout the operational period to prevent malicious traffic and cyber threats.

It also said CBSE teams provided support to students through its helpdesk and grievance redressal channels. The clarification came amid certain media reports and social media posts regarding the functioning of the Post-Result Services Portal.

Addressing concerns raised by some students and parents, CBSE said the message "Roll Number Not Found" was displayed only when a candidate had not successfully applied

SC agrees to hear Saudi-based student's plea over result delay

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to examine a plea filed by a student from Saudi Arabia seeking directions to the CBSE to declare his Class 12 improvement examination result.

A bench comprising Justices Manmohan and Vijay Bishnoi issued notice to the CBSE and its regional officer on the plea filed by the student.

"This is about the career of a child, he will miss all his admissions...Whatever it is, burn the midnight oil," the bench remarked orally while directing the counsel for CBSE to seek instruction in the matter.

The top court was hearing a plea filed by Pransu Jigarkumar Patel against the CBSE's failure to declare his result despite an assessment scheme framed for students whose examinations in several Gulf countries were cancelled.

The plea contended that the non-declaration of his result has jeopardised his higher education prospects and deprived him of admission opportunities. Patel claimed that his representations sent to the CBSE on May 17, May 21 and May 30 seeking a resolution of the issue went unanswered.

during the first phase of the post-result services process -- the Answer Books Photocopy Application Window.

"CBSE has taken note of certain media reports and social media posts regarding the functioning of the Post-Result Services Portal. To clarify doubts of some of these students and parents, it is informed that the message 'Roll Number Not Found' is displayed when a candidate had not successfully applied

during the first phase of the Post-Result Services process, namely the Answer Books Photocopy Application Window," the board said.

"As clearly outlined earlier, only those candidates who had applied for their scanned answer books during the preceding stage (Answer Books Photocopy) were eligible to avail the subsequent stage of Verification of Issues Observed and Re-evaluation of Answers," the board said.

Yamuna cleanup: Shah chairs high-level meeting, calls for inter-state coordination

Officials told to maintain continuous monitoring of key pollution indicators

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Monday chaired a high-level review meeting on the rejuvenation of the Yamuna River, stressing that coordinated efforts by Delhi, Haryana and Uttar Pradesh are crucial for restoring the river's health.

The meeting was attended by Union Urban Affairs minister Manohar Lal, Jal Shakti minister C.R. Patil, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, and senior officials of the concerned departments.

During the review, Shah said that cleaning the Yamuna is a key commitment of the Narendra Modi government and can only be achieved through close cooperation among all



Home minister speaks during the meeting. Union ministers Manohar Lal and C.R. Patil, and Delhi CM Rekha Gupta also seen in the picture

stakeholders. He emphasised that isolated efforts by individual agencies or states would not be sufficient and that a comprehensive, integrated strategy involving all three states is essential for long-term success.

Shah underlined the importance of maintaining uninterrupted environmental flow in the Yamuna. He said that meaningful progress in

river restoration can be measured only when the river maintains the prescribed environmental flow levels throughout its course.

As part of the rejuvenation plan, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and the National Dairy Development Board will soon sign a Memorandum of Understanding aimed at addressing pollution caused

by dairies and gaushalas. Under the proposed arrangement, cattle waste that currently finds its way into drains and eventually the river will be processed for productive use. The initiative is expected to promote the generation of biogas and the production of organic fertilisers, creating a sustainable model for waste management while reducing pollution.

Reviewing the desilting operations, Shah noted that significant progress has been achieved in clearing accumulated silt and waste from drains flowing into the river. Officials informed the meeting that nearly 97 per cent of the targeted desilting work has been completed and the removal of the entire 28.57 lakh metric tonnes of material is expected to be finished before June 15.

Hooda slams govt over fertiliser price hike

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister and Leader of Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Monday slammed the government over the recent increase in fertiliser and fuel prices, alleging that the move would further burden farmers already struggling with inflation.

Hooda said the government's decision to raise the prices of Urea and SSP by Rs 200 each, along with an increase of Rs 200 to Rs 550 in

NPK fertilisers, would significantly raise cultivation costs. He added that the rising prices of agricultural machinery and spare parts were compounding farmers' difficulties.

"Farmers are already facing the impact of soaring inflation. The increase in fertilizer prices has added to their distress and threatens the agricultural sector," he said.

Targeting the BJP government, he alleged that despite its promise to double farm-

ers' income, it had instead increased input costs. According to Hooda, the rise in Minimum Support Prices (MSP) has failed to keep pace with inflation, while farmers' debt burdens have continued to grow.

The Congress leader also criticised the recent hike in LPG prices, claiming that domestic cylinder rates have increased by Rs 89 in the past three months, while commercial cylinders have become costlier by over Rs 1,500.

UP STF guns down 'wanted criminal'

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: A wanted criminal carrying a cumulative reward of Rs 2 lakh on his arrest was killed in an encounter with the Uttar Pradesh Special Task Force (STF) in Ayodhya late Sunday night, police said.

The deceased, identified as Bhanu Pratap Singh alias Bablu Singh, 38, was a resident of Vidhanapar village in Gorakhpur's Belghat area and was wanted in multiple cases of murder, robbery and extortion.

According to police, the STF received information that Bhanu Pratap was fleeing on a motorcycle with an associate. Acting on the tip-off, an STF team intercepted the duo near Emi Ghat in Maharajganj police station area at around 11 pm. Police said the accused opened indiscriminate fire at the STF team with a sten gun when officers attempted to stop him. The STF retaliated, during which Bhanu Pratap sustained bullet injuries. His accomplice managed to escape under the cover of darkness.

Inspector J.P. Rai of the STF informed the Maharajganj police about the encounter and sought assistance. Local police teams rushed to the spot and found that the STF had already neutralised one of the accused.

Police said an ambulance was called, but did not arrive in time. STF personnel then transported the injured accused to the Community Health Centre at Pura Bazar. After initial treatment, doctors referred him to the Government Medical College in Darshannagar, where he died during treatment.

Police described Bhanu Pratap as a hardcore criminal with 41 cases against him.

Somnath pilgrimage: CM Saini flags off train from Kurukshetra

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday flagged off a special train carrying more than 1,100 devotees from Kurukshetra to the Somnath Temple in Gujarat, describing pilgrimages as an important means of strengthening social harmony and preserving India's cultural heritage.

Addressing a gathering on the occasion, Saini said such spiritual journeys help connect younger generations with their roots, values and civilisational legacy while providing pilgrims with renewed energy, inspiration and spiritual awakening. He also honoured saints and spiritual leaders with ceremonial shawls.

'The pilgrimage reflects the govt's commitment to the elderly's welfare

The Chief Minister said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership since 2014 has given a new direction to the country's development and highlighted efforts undertaken for the preservation and promotion of India's religious and cultural heritage. He cited the inauguration of the Ram Mandir, redevelopment of Kashi Vishwanath Dham, the Char Dham Project and the PRASAD Scheme as key initiatives reconnecting the nation with its civilisational roots.

Saini said the Somnath pil-

grimage, undertaken by senior citizens under the Mukhya Mantri Tirth Yatra Yojana, reflected the government's commitment to the welfare of the elderly. He noted that thousands of senior citizens have already visited major pilgrimage centres under the scheme.

Describing Somnath Temple as the first among the 12 Jyotirlingas, Saini said its history symbolises India's resilience and unwavering faith. Despite repeated attacks and destruction, the temple was rebuilt time and again, becoming a symbol of cultural renaissance after Independence. He recalled that Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel had viewed its reconstruction as a vital step towards restoring India's cultural identity.

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Monday said the state has not witnessed a single paper leak incident since his government came to power in 2022, even as 93 exam papers were leaked in the country since 2017.

Speaking at an event where he handed over appointment letters to 355 employees newly recruited to different government departments, Mann asserted that his administration conducted exams in a transparent manner and gave jobs on merit.

Highlighting the state government's vision for empowerment of youth, Mann said opportunities were being created to encourage young people to stay, grow and succeed in Punjab. He said reverse migra-



tion has begun in the state, a pathway has been created for regularisation of 65,000 contractual employees, and major investments have been made in skill development through 25 new ITIs and the upgradation of 13 existing institutes.

Drawing parallels between the recruitment process adopted by his government and the situation elsewhere in the country, Mann said, "Our Central government could not con-

The CM handed over appointment letters to 355 employees newly recruited to different govt depts

duct a NEET exam. Since 2017, question papers of around 93 examinations have been leaked across the country. Such incidents involving major examinations, including NEET, have disappointed and demoralised lakhs of youths."

However, he said, not a single such incident took place in Punjab since his government came to power in 2022. Meritorious students are getting opportunities because an hon-

est government is working in the state, he said.

Mann said his administration has so far provided 67,037 government jobs completely on merit and every appointment was made without corruption, nepotism or favouritism.

Mann said Punjab has witnessed a remarkable transformation in the education sector.

"When our government assumed office, Punjab was ranked 27th in the country in school education. Today, according to NITI Aayog, Punjab is the number one state in school education, surpassing states like Kerala. This was made possible by our investment in strengthening government schools and the creation of world-class educational infrastructure," he said.

Cross-border drug racket: ED conducts raids in 3 states

AIZAWL: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Monday conducted simultaneous searches across Mizoram, Tripura and West Bengal in connection with a cross-border narcotics trafficking and money laundering investigation.

The raids were carried out under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002, following a case registered by the NCB's Agartala Zonal Unit after the seizure of a large quantity of drugs in Tripura on August 21, 2025. The seizure included methamphetamine tablets and 40 grams of heroin. According to the ED, investigations have revealed an organised cross-border drug trafficking network allegedly involved in smuggling methamphetamine from Myanmar into India through the Champhai-Zokhawthar corridor in Mizoram. The contraband was then transported through a network of intermediaries and distributed to destinations in Tripura and other regions.

During the searches, investigators identified locations situated close to international borders, including a site barely 200 metres from the Bangladesh border in Tripura and another around 500 metres from the Myanmar border in Mizoram, indicating the strategic use of border areas for trafficking operations. The ED said its probe has uncovered a sophisticated money laundering network used to conceal proceeds generated from the narcotics trade. So far, it has traced proceeds of crime exceeding Rs 142 crore.

Court rejects Hemant Soren's discharge plea in money laundering case

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI/RANCHI: A special court under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) in Ranchi has rejected Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren's plea seeking discharge in a money laundering case linked to an alleged land scam, paving the way for

trial proceedings to continue.

Special PMLA Judge Yogesh Kumar held that the Enforcement Directorate (ED) had placed sufficient material on record to establish a prima facie case against Soren. The court clarified that the current stage was not meant to determine guilt or innocence but only to assess whether enough evi-



dence existed to proceed with the trial.

The ED's investigation cen-

tres on an 8.86-acre land parcel in Ranchi's Bariatu area. According to the court order, documents recovered during the probe, including land-related and administrative records, indicated repeated links between the property and Soren. The court observed that these materials were sufficient to warrant further examination

during trial.

Rejecting arguments seeking discharge, the court said issues relating to the credibility of witnesses and admissibility of evidence could only be tested during the trial and not at the preliminary stage. It noted that the prosecution's version is to be taken at face value while deciding whether charges

should proceed.

The ED has relied on statements of several individuals, including caretaker Santosh Munda and Abhishek Prasad alias Pintu, who allegedly provided details regarding the use and management of the property. Witnesses reportedly stated that Soren and his wife frequently visited the land.

J&K: NHAI proposes parallel 2-lane tube to SPM Tunnel at Rs 2,516 crore

8.8-km tunnel aims at boosting all-weather connectivity on NH-44

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: The National Highways Authority of India (NHA) has proposed the construction of a new two-lane tube tunnel parallel to the existing Syama Prasad Mookerjee (SPM) Tunnel, formerly known as the Chenani-Nashri Tunnel, on National Highway-44 in Jammu & Kashmir. The project is expected to significantly enhance traffic capacity on one of the country's most strategically important mountain corridors.

According to a senior official, the proposed project, estimated at Rs 2,515.72 crore, will be implemented under the Design, Build, Finance, Operate and Transfer (DBFOT) model. The scope includes the construction of an 8.826-km-long two-lane tunnel tube along with 0.532 km of approach roads, taking the total project length to 9.358 km. The concessionaire will also be responsible for the operation and maintenance of the existing tunnel and connected stretches of the

KEY POINTS

- » The existing SPM Tunnel, inaugurated in April 2017, is a 9.28-km all-weather tunnel linking Chenani in Udhampur district with Nashri in Ramban district
- » Officials said the proposed parallel tunnel forms part of the Centre's broader infrastructure push in Jammu & Kashmir
- » Improved road infrastructure is expected to boost tourism, trade and logistics



while supporting the region's long-term economic growth

Udhampur-Ramban and Ramban-Marog sections of NH-44.

The existing SPM Tunnel, inaugurated in April 2017, is a 9.28-km all-weather tunnel linking Chenani in Udhampur district with Nashri in Ramban district. At the time of its commissioning, it was India's longest road tunnel and the first in the country to feature a fully integrated tunnel control system. By bypassing the avalanche-prone and weather-sensitive stretches of Patnitop, Kud and Batote, the tunnel reduced travel time between Jammu and Srinagar by nearly three to four hours and ensured improved

year-round connectivity.

The tunnel also carries significant historical and political symbolism. In October 2019, Union Road Transport and Highways minister Nitin Gadkari announced the renaming in honour of Syama Prasad Mookerjee. Union minister Jitendra Singh had then pointed out that Mookerjee's final journey to Srinagar in 1953, following his arrest at Madhopur, passed through the same route now traversed by the tunnel. Mookerjee died more than a month later while still under detention. The renaming came shortly after the abrogation of

Article 370 and was viewed as a tribute to his long-standing advocacy for the complete integration of Jammu & Kashmir with the Indian Union.

Officials said the proposed parallel tunnel forms part of the Centre's broader infrastructure push in Jammu & Kashmir aimed at improving all-weather connectivity, facilitating freight movement and strengthening the Union Territory's integration with the national economy. Improved road infrastructure is expected to boost tourism, trade and logistics while supporting the region's long-term economic growth.

Jal Jeevan Mission: Rural tap water coverage reaches 81.8%, says govt

Budgetary allocations increased by 488% between 2020-21 & 2026-27

NEW DELHI: Rural tap water coverage in the country has risen from 3.23 crore households in August 2019 to 15.84 crore households by May 2026, covering 81.87 per cent of the country's 19.35 crore rural households, according to a government document released on Monday.

The document, issued as part of the BJP-led central government marking 12 years in office, said the increase was achieved under the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), launched in 2019 to provide potable water through functional household tap connections to every rural household.

According to the document, budgetary allocations for the mission increased by 488 per cent between 2020-21 and 2026-27 to Rs 67,670 crore.

The government said that 2.77 lakh villages have achieved 100 per cent tap water coverage under the Har Ghar Jal campaign.

Household tap water coverage in aspirational districts increased from 23.62 lakh in August 2019 to 2.20 crore by May 2026, while 1.11 crore



households in aspirational blocks had tap water connections by the same date.

The number of schools with tap water connectivity increased from 29,711 in August 2019 to 9.23 lakh by May 2026, while coverage in anganwadi centres, it went up from 15,464 to 9.66 lakh during the period.

Tap water connectivity in gram panchayats and community health centres reached 3.93 lakh institutions, covering 77.27 per cent of such facilities, the document said.

According to the document, improved access to clean drinking water has reduced waterborne diseases, strengthened sanitation and supported better educational outcomes, particularly for children and

'2.77 lakh villages have achieved 100 per cent tap water coverage under the Har Ghar Jal campaign'

adolescent girls. The document also highlighted the progress of the Swachh Bharat Mission (Grameen), launched in October 2014 to address inadequate sanitation facilities in rural India, where around 550 million people lacked access to such facilities at the time.

According to the government, budgetary allocations for the mission increased by 83 per cent from Rs 3,929 crore in 2014-15 to Rs 7,192 crore in 2026-27. Over 12.11 crore individual household toilets have been constructed under the programme so far. During Phase I of the mission, sanitation coverage increased from 39 per cent in 2014 to 100 per cent in 2019, following which India was declared Open Defecation Free (ODF).



EDITORIAL

MORALITY VERSUS LEGALITY

The Supreme Court's recent ruling that a consensual physical relationship between two unmarried adults cannot, by itself, be treated as evidence of poor character is far more significant than the appointment of a single police constable in Telangana. At its core, the judgment is a reaffirmation of a principle that should be self-evident in a constitutional democracy: the State has no business acting as a moral guardian over the private choices of consenting adults. In a country where personal relationships are frequently subjected to social scrutiny, familial pressure and institutional prejudice, the ruling serves as a timely reminder that morality and legality are not always the same thing, and that public authorities must be careful not to confuse the two. The case arose from a failed romantic relationship that led to a criminal complaint and eventually became an obstacle to the appellant's appointment as a police constable. The Telangana State Level Police Recruitment Board concluded that the mere existence of the case reflected moral turpitude and rendered the candidate unsuitable for service in a disciplined force. The Supreme Court, however, looked beyond the simplistic assumptions that often accompany such cases. The bench noted that the relationship between the two individuals had lasted several years, that the matter had been settled through a legally recognised process, and that no charge of rape had ultimately been pursued. Most importantly, the Court rejected the notion that the failure of a relationship to culminate in marriage automatically implies deception, exploitation or criminality.

That observation deserves careful attention because it addresses a deeply entrenched social mindset. In many parts of India, romantic relationships continue to be viewed through the narrow lens of marriage. Relationships that do not end in matrimony are often judged as failures, while those involved—particularly women—are subjected to moral scrutiny. Men, meanwhile, are frequently presumed guilty of wrongdoing simply because a relationship has ended badly. Such assumptions ignore the complexity of human relationships. People fall in love, grow apart, discover incompatibilities or choose different paths. Not every relationship succeeds, and not every failed relationship is evidence of fraud or bad faith. The Supreme Court has recognised this reality and refused to allow institutions to substitute social prejudice for legal reasoning. The judgment also carries important implications for the growing misuse and misunderstanding surrounding cases involving promises of marriage. Courts across the country have repeatedly distinguished between a false promise made solely to obtain consent and a genuine relationship that later breaks down. The distinction is crucial. If every failed relationship were to be interpreted as proof that one partner deceived the other, the criminal justice system would be transformed into an instrument for settling personal grievances rather than addressing genuine crimes. The law exists to punish coercion, fraud and exploitation, not to criminalise the emotional complexities of adult relationships. By emphasising the absence of evidence showing deception or force, the Supreme Court has reinforced this essential principle.

Equally significant is the Court's insistence on the presumption of innocence. In recent years, public institutions, employers and even sections of society have increasingly adopted a "guilty until proven innocent" approach when dealing with criminal allegations. The mere registration of a case is often treated as sufficient proof of wrongdoing. Careers are damaged, reputations destroyed and opportunities denied long before a court determines the facts. The Supreme Court's ruling challenges this tendency. The bench observed that when the complainant herself chose not to pursue the case and no evidence was led to establish deception, authorities could not simply speculate about what might have happened and draw adverse conclusions about the appellant's character. Such speculation has no place in a system governed by the rule of law. This aspect of the judgment is particularly relevant in public recruitment. Government agencies frequently invoke vague notions such as "character," "conduct" and "moral turpitude" while assessing candidates. While integrity is undoubtedly important, especially in uniformed services, these standards cannot become vehicles for arbitrary decision-making. The danger lies in allowing subjective moral beliefs to determine who is fit for public employment. If authorities are permitted to treat consensual relationships as indicators of poor character, where does such reasoning end? Would a divorce become evidence of moral weakness? Would choosing not to marry be viewed as a character flaw? Constitutional governance requires objective standards, not personal moral judgments masquerading as administrative discretion.

The judgment is also consistent with the Supreme Court's broader jurisprudence on privacy, autonomy and individual liberty. Over the past decade, the Court has repeatedly affirmed that adults have the right to choose their partners, their relationships and their way of life without undue interference from the State. Whether in decisions concerning privacy, live-in relationships, interfaith marriages or sexual orientation, the judiciary has increasingly recognised personal autonomy as an essential component of constitutional freedom. The latest ruling fits squarely within that framework. By declaring that there is no law prohibiting relationships between consenting unmarried adults, the Court has reiterated that constitutional rights do not depend on social approval. Yet the need for such a judgment also reveals how far Indian society still has to travel. Despite legal progress, moral policing remains pervasive. Couples are harassed in public spaces. Families often exercise control over the personal choices of adult children. Educational institutions and employers sometimes impose restrictions that have little basis in law. Even within official systems, there remains a tendency to evaluate individuals through the prism of conventional social norms rather than constitutional principles. The Telangana case is a reminder that these attitudes continue to influence decision-making in subtle but significant ways.

The ruling should not be misunderstood as trivialising genuine crimes against women. Cases involving coercion, threats, manipulation or false promises made with dishonest intent must continue to be investigated and prosecuted rigorously. Women who experience exploitation deserve legal protection and access to justice. The Court has not weakened those safeguards. Instead, it has drawn a necessary distinction between criminal conduct and consensual adult relationships. Protecting women's rights and respecting individual liberty are not contradictory goals. A mature legal system must be capable of doing both. At a broader level, the judgment reflects the ongoing evolution of Indian society. The country is changing rapidly. Urbanisation, education, economic independence and digital connectivity have transformed how people meet, interact and form relationships. Social attitudes, however, have not always kept pace with these changes. Institutions often find themselves caught between constitutional values and traditional expectations. The Supreme Court's intervention serves as a reminder that public authorities are bound by the Constitution, not by prevailing social prejudices.

Ultimately, this case is about more than one recruit seeking a job. It is about the relationship between the individual and the State. A democracy committed to liberty cannot allow public institutions to punish citizens for lawful personal choices. Nor can it permit assumptions about morality to override evidence, due process and the presumption of innocence. By refusing to equate a failed relationship with moral turpitude, the Supreme Court has upheld a principle that lies at the heart of constitutional governance: adults are entitled to make their own choices, and those choices cannot become grounds for discrimination unless they violate the law. In an era when personal lives are increasingly scrutinised and judged, the Court's message is both simple and profound. Consenting adults have the right to choose their relationships. The State's role is to protect that freedom, not police it. That distinction is vital for a modern democracy—and one that India would do well to remember.

BHARAT KI SOCH



NAVANEETH KRISHNAN S

THE WRITER IS A SENIOR RESEARCH FELLOW AT BHARAT KI SOCH

Chemical-intensive farming must give way to integrated organic systems rooted in biological control, mulching, composting, pollinator protection, and microclimate conservation

Saving the Queen of Spices

Rising temperatures, declining humidity and growing chemical dependence are threatening cardamom cultivation in the Western Ghats, prompting a return to ecological farming principles

Cardamom has always belonged to the rainforest ecology of the Western Ghats. Long before plantation agriculture transformed the hills of Kerala and Tamil Nadu, the spice grew naturally beneath dense evergreen canopies where moisture, shade, forest humus, insects, birds, fungi, and microorganisms together sustained a delicate ecological balance. In its earliest phase, cardamom was not even a plantation crop. Until the nineteenth century, much of the world's supply came from wild and semi-wild forest landscapes where people harvested it with minimal disturbance to nature.

This older system was fundamentally different from present cultivation practices. Traditional cardamom cultivation functioned as an agroecological system rooted in the rainforest itself. Farmers depended on existing forest cover rather than clearing it. Partial clearing of the undergrowth allowed access to the plants, but the towering evergreen trees remained intact. Shade trees were not obstacles to production. They were essential partners that protected humidity, regulated temperature, enriched soil fertility through leaf litter, and maintained water retention in fragile mountain ecosystems.

Today, however, large parts of the cardamom hills are witnessing ecological stress due to intensive plantation practices. Modern commercial cultivation often involves repeated shade lopping to increase sunlight exposure for higher yields. This directly alters the fragile microclimate that once kept plantation temperatures three to five degrees centigrade lower than outside areas. When the evergreen canopy is heavily reduced, plantations become hotter and drier, humidity declines sharply, and the natural ecological balance weakens. In many plantations, this has severely altered forest structure. Native evergreen species such as *Cullenia Exarillata* and *Palaquium Ellipticum* are rapidly disappearing; only a few tree species such as *Vernonia Arborea*, *Artocarpus Heterophyllum*, and *Toona Ciliata* now dominate large sections of shade cover. Epiphytes and moisture-dependent organisms that once thrived in these forests are vanishing. Continuous disturbance has weakened the rainforest's natural ability to regulate temperature, conserve water, and sustain



Today, large parts of the cardamom hills are witnessing ecological stress due to intensive plantation practices

biodiversity.

The consequences are now visible across the Western Ghats. Soil erosion has intensified. Humidity levels inside plantations have fallen. Temperatures have risen. Pest attacks have increased sharply. Farmers who once used only a few rounds of pesticide applications in a year now often resort to fifteen to eighteen rounds. High-yielding varieties with succulent tillers are particularly vulnerable to pests and diseases, pushing cultivators towards excessive chemical dependence. Long-term application of synthetic fertilisers has also altered soil chemistry, reducing soil health and increasing acidity.

Ironically, the traditional agroecology of cardamom already offered solutions that modern agriculture is struggling to rediscover.

One of the most important among them is microclimate management. Traditional growers understood that cardamom survives best under carefully maintained forest shade. Thick canopy cover keeps plantation temperatures several degrees lower than outside areas while preserving atmospheric humidity. Research has repeatedly shown that plantations with higher shade levels maintain healthier moisture conditions and lower disease incidence. In contrast, excessive exposure to sunlight weakens the crop and creates favourable conditions for pests.

Traditional practices also protected soil health through natural recycling. Leaf litter, pruned materials, weeds, and forest biomass acted as mulch that conserved moisture and gradually turned into organic matter. Farmers used cattle manure, compost, neem cake, bone meal, and green manure crops instead

of depending entirely on synthetic fertilisers. Soil disturbance was minimal. In several successful organic plantations, thick mulch cover and zero tillage practices have significantly reduced clump rot and pest outbreaks while improving soil texture.

Modern organic farming methods can strengthen these older ecological principles. Beneficial fungi and biological agents are already proving effective in disease management. *Trichoderma viride* and *Trichoderma harzianum* are now widely recognised for controlling rhizome rot and capsule rot in environmentally safe ways. Entomopathogenic fungi such as *Beauveria bassiana* and *Metarhizium anisopliae* help manage root grub infestations without poisoning the soil. Biofertilizers like *Azospirillum* and *Phosphobacteria* improve nutrient availability naturally. Neem-based formulations and botanical extracts can further reduce chemical dependence.

Equally important is biological pest control through beekeeping. Honey bees are the principal pollinators of cardamom, and healthy bee activity directly improves capsule formation and yield. Organic plantations with diverse shade trees support bee colonies far more effectively than chemically treated plantations. Farmers have repeatedly observed that pesticide-intensive cultivation destroys bee populations through poisoning. Beekeeping therefore serves not only as a pollination strategy but also as an ecological indicator of a healthy plantation ecosystem.

The Western Ghats have also produced remarkable farmer innovators who demonstrated that productivity and ecological thinking can coexist. Sebastian

Joseph of Idukki developed the famous *Njallani* variety through careful farmer selection and controlled pollination using beehives inside mosquito net enclosures. His plants produced dramatically larger and more numerous capsules while reducing the waiting period for yield through shoot propagation techniques. Joy Peter's Panikulangara Green Bold No. 1 (PGB 1) emerged from close observation of naturally vigorous plants and became known for retention of green colour, drought tolerance and lower susceptibility to pests and diseases. Organic farming activist Raju Joseph developed a thrips-tolerant Malabar selection by conserving and improving traditional cultivars instead of abandoning them for chemically dependent hybrids.

These innovations reveal an important lesson. Sustainable cardamom cultivation does not lie in rejecting science or romanticising the past. The future depends on intelligently combining traditional rainforest agroecology with modern organic farming knowledge.

Reforestation of evergreen tree species in cardamom landscapes is therefore no longer optional. It is essential for restoring ecosystem health, biodiversity, water conservation, soil fertility, and climatic stability in the Western Ghats. Shade regulation must shift from ruthless lopping to ecological canopy management. The reintroduction of indigenous rainforest species of the Western Ghats such as *Acrocarpus Fraxinifolius*, *Actinodaphne Malabarica*, *Bischofia Javanica*, *Canarium Strictum*, *Mesopsis Eminii*, *Mesua Ferrea*, *Myristica Attenuata*, *Vateria Indica*, *Vernonia Arborea*, and *Zedrella Toona* is essential for recreating healthier agroforestry conditions, including the ideal microclimate required for cardamom cultivation, while supporting pollinators, soil moisture, and biodiversity. Chemical-intensive farming must give way to integrated organic systems rooted in biological control, mulching, composting, pollinator protection, and microclimate conservation.

Cardamom flourished for centuries because it grew with the forest, not against it. The survival of both the spice and the Western Ghats now depends on remembering that relationship.

Views expressed are personal

PAGE ONE



KM PRASHANTH

THE WRITER IS A FORMER GM (CORPORATE COMMUNICATION), NTPC

While no medium is infallible, printed newspapers generally follow established editorial processes that involve multiple layers of review and fact-checking before publication

Beyond the Endless Scroll

The newspaper may no longer dominate mornings, but it continues to offer perspective, editorial judgment and a rare escape from algorithm-driven distraction

The other day, while travelling on the metro, I happened to look around at my fellow passengers. Almost everyone seemed glued to a mobile phone. Those seated were scrolling through their screens, while many standing passengers were equally engrossed in their devices.

As I watched this familiar scene unfold, a question crossed my mind: does anyone still read a physical newspaper?

For those who grew up before smartphones became an extension of our hands, reading a newspaper was more than a habit—it was a ritual. I still remember the pleasure of unfolding the morning paper with a cup of tea and spending time moving from one page to another, discovering stories from different parts of the world.

What I miss most is the sense of immersion. A newspaper demands our attention in a way that digital platforms rarely do. There are no notifications, pop-up advertisements, or endless links competing for our focus. The experience encourages us to slow down, reflect, and absorb information more deeply.

There is also something uniquely satisfying about the physical act of reading a newspaper. The texture of the paper, the rustle of the pages, and even the familiar smell of fresh newsprint contribute to an experience that screens cannot replicate. A newspaper never runs out of battery and does not depend on an internet connection.

Many readers may not realise how carefully newspapers are designed. The placement of stories, the size of headlines, and the use of photographs are all deliberate editorial choices. These decisions help readers understand which stories deserve attention and why they matter.

Like many sports enthusiasts, I begin reading from the back page. Others head straight to the editorial section, business pages, or crossword puzzle. The beauty of a newspaper is that every reader develops a personal relationship with it.

Equally important is the credibility associated with traditional newspapers. While



The beauty of a newspaper is that every reader develops a personal relationship with it

no medium is infallible, printed newspapers generally follow established editorial processes that involve multiple layers of review and fact-checking before publication. In today's fast-moving digital environment, where speed often takes precedence over accuracy, this remains an important strength.

Newspapers also offer something increasingly rare in the digital age: a broad view of the world. Online algorithms tend to show us more of what we already like and agree with. A newspaper, by contrast, exposes us to a wide range of topics—from local developments and national affairs to international events, science, culture, business, and sports. It often introduces us to issues we may not have actively searched for but are nevertheless important.

Then there are the simple pleasures that accompany newspaper reading. Solving a Sudoku puzzle, tackling a crossword, or enjoying a comic strip offers a welcome break

from the constant stream of digital content. These activities engage the mind while providing a sense of relaxation.

Interestingly, many young people today are rediscovering older technologies. Vinyl records, film cameras, and basic mobile phones are making a comeback among those seeking a respite from constant digital stimulation. Perhaps this reflects a broader desire to reconnect with experiences that feel more tangible and less dictated by algorithms.

The printed newspaper belongs in that conversation. It may no longer dominate our mornings as it once did, but it continues to offer something valuable: depth in an age of distraction, perspective in an age of information overload, and a quiet moment of reflection in an increasingly noisy world.

Perhaps it is time to unfold a newspaper once again and rediscover the simple joy of reading.

Views expressed are personal

EV PENETRATION CROSSES 11% FOR FIRST TIME

Automobile retail sales up 9.55% to record 25,31,067 units in May

OUR CORRESPONDENT

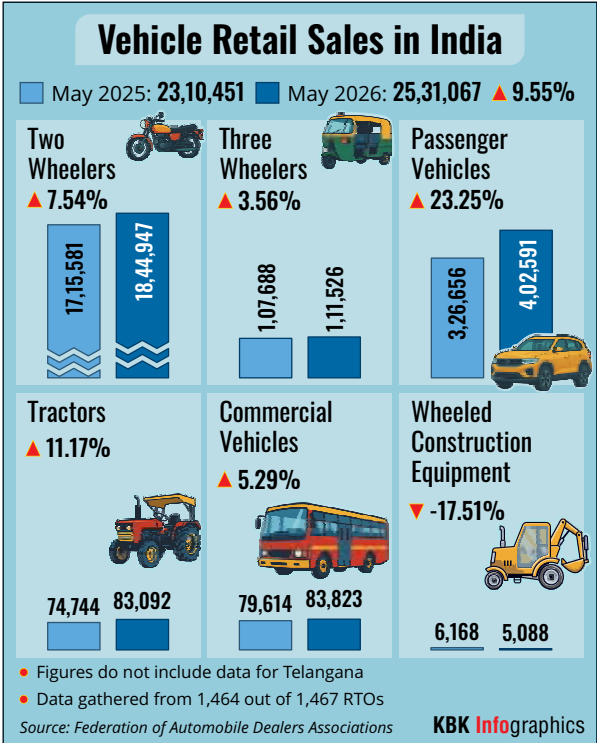
NEW DELHI: India's automobile retail sales grew 9.55 per cent to a record 25,31,067 units in May, while EV penetration crossed 11 per cent for the first time, as dealers saw a surge in enquiries for fuel-efficient and green vehicles after last month's fuel price hikes amid the West Asia crisis, FADA said on Monday.

The cumulative automobile retail sales in India stood at 23,10,451 units in the same month last year.

According to the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA), the figures reflect the best May performance ever recorded across commercial (CV), passenger vehicle (PV) and the overall EV penetration. "A notable feature of the month was the consumer response to May fuel-price revisions: dealers reported a visible rise in enquiries for fuel-efficient and alternative-powertrain options, reflected in the two-wheeler EV share climbing to 9.25 per cent from 6.11 per cent a year ago," FADA stated.

Passenger vehicles retail sales were at a record 4,02,591 units last month as compared to 3,26,656 units in May 2025, a growth of 23.25 per cent, data showed.

Two-wheelers also clocked best-ever monthly numbers at



18,44,947 units in May this year as compared to 17,15,581 units in the same month a year ago, a growth of 7.54 per cent.

FADA further said three-wheeler sales stood at 1,11,526 units last month as compared to 1,07,688 units in May 2025, up 3.56 per cent.

Commercial vehicles also witnessed a growth of 5.29 per cent to a record 83,823 units last

month as compared to 79,614 units in May 2025, it added.

"Overall, the outlook for June 2026 appears measured but cautiously optimistic, with monsoon progress and rural cash flows expected to provide the structural support even as near-term cost pressures persist," FADA stated.

Looking ahead to June 2026, dealer sentiment is measured:

Highlights

» The cumulative automobile retail sales in India stood at 23,10,451 units in the same month last year

» According to the FADA, the figures reflect best May performance ever recorded across CV, PV & overall EV penetration

» Passenger vehicles retail sales were at a record 4,02,591 units last month against 3,26,656 units in May 2025, up 23.25%, data showed

» Commercial vehicles also witnessed a growth of 5.29% to a record 83,823 units last month against 79,614 units in May 2025, it added

50.52 per cent of dealers expect growth, 39.90 per cent anticipate a flat market, and only 9.59 per cent foresee a decline, according to the Association.

Dealers attributed the steady participation from commuters and rural buyers to marriage-season buying and continued affordability under the GST 2.0 framework, even as heat wave conditions dampened

showroom walk-ins in several markets and selective model-wise supply gaps tempered momentum.

FADA President C S Vigneshwar said: "As anticipated in our April 2026 release, the watch-outs we had flagged -- an above-normal heat wave, fuel-price pressure and the evolving West Asia situation -- did come into play during May 2026, and yet Indian auto retail has held its growth trajectory with May'26 registering the best ever May across 3W, PV, tractors and overall registrations."

The industry retailed 25,31,067 units during the month, a 9.55 per cent YoY expansion, with passenger vehicles at 23.25 per cent and tractors at 11.17 per cent leading the way, followed by two-wheelers at 7.54 per cent, commercial vehicles at 5.29 per cent, and three-wheelers at 3.56 per cent, while wheeled construction equipment declined 17.51 per cent on a high base, he shared.

"The sequential softness of 6.75 per cent MoM reflects the customary post-April seasonal moderation and a delayed South-West monsoon, keeping May largely a pre-sowing month across much of rain-fed Bharat. That growth held through this confluence of pressures underlines the resilience of the underlying demand," Vigneshwar said.

SENSEX DECLINES 719 POINTS

Markets tank nearly 1% on weak global cues & rising oil prices

Mcap of BSE-listed cos eroded by Rs 6,31,440.41 crore to Rs 4,55,28,758.96 crore (\$4.76 trillion) in a single day

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty slumped nearly 1 per cent on Monday, following a massive sell-off in global equities and a sharp rise in crude prices amid intensifying tensions in West Asia.

Besides, unabated foreign capital outflows and a weak rupee against the US dollar also weighed on investor sentiment, traders said.

Extending losses for the second straight session, the 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 719.08 points, or 0.97 per cent, to settle at 73,524.26.

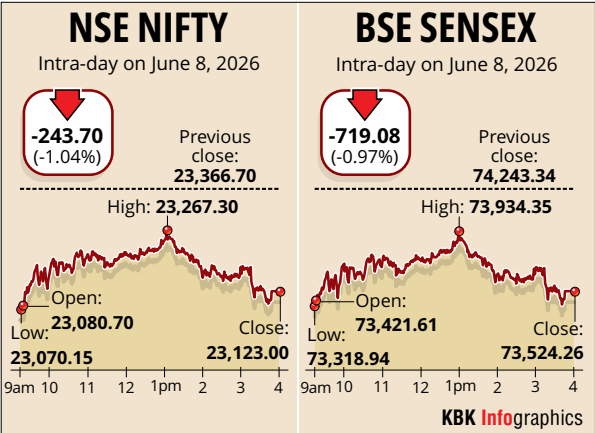
During the day, it dived 924.4 points, or 1.24 per cent, to 73,318.94.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 243.70 points, or 1.04 per cent, to 23,123. In intra-day trade, the benchmark lost 296.55 points, or 1.26 per cent, to 23,070.15.

A total of 3,117 stocks declined, while 1,249 advanced and 171 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies eroded by Rs 6,31,440.41 crore to Rs 4,55,28,758.96 crore (\$4.76 trillion) in a single day.

Among the Sensex constituents, Eternal, Mahindra & Mahindra, Trent, InterGlobe



A total of 3,117 stocks declined, 1,249 advanced & 171 remained unchanged on BSE

Aviation, Reliance Industries and Tata Consultancy Services were among the biggest laggards.

In contrast, Power Grid, Tech Mahindra, Bharat Electronics and Bharti Airtel were among the winners.

The BSE SmallCap Select index tanked 1.61 per cent, and the MidCap Select index dropped 1.51 per cent.

Sectorally, Realty dived 2.57

per cent, metal (2.43 per cent), Telecommunication (2.28 per cent), Commodities (2.09 per cent), Industrials (2.06 per cent), Capital Goods (1.98 per cent) and Auto (1.85 per cent).

BSE Hospitals Index emerged as the only winner.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 4.10 per cent to \$96.91 per barrel.

Meanwhile, Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 8,776.25 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

On Friday, the Sensex declined 116.67 points, or 0.16 per cent, to settle at 74,243.34. The Nifty dipped 49.85 points, or 0.21 per cent, to end at 23,366.70.

Rupee falls 43 paise to 95.61 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 43 paise to settle at 95.61 against the American currency on Monday, pressured by elevated crude oil prices and the strength of the US dollar in the overseas market due to higher risk aversion amid escalating geopolitical tensions.

Forex traders said the USD/INR pair erased the previous trading session's gains on risk aversion in global markets.

Further, a sharp jump in crude oil prices and a rise in the US dollar index dented investor sentiment.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.35, then touched an intraday high of 95.15 and finally ended the session at 95.61, registering a loss of 43 paise from its previous close.

On Friday, the rupee appreciated 56 paise to close at 95.18 against the US dollar, after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced measures to support foreign capital inflows and strengthen forex liquidity.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 100.16, up 0.09 per cent.

India's forex reserve jumped by \$938 million to \$682,321 billion during the week ended May 28, the Reserve Bank said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the kitty dropped \$7.511 billion to \$681.384 billion.

'India, US trade pact can be finalised after conclusion of Sec 301 probes'

NEW DELHI: The first phase of the bilateral trade agreement between India and the US can be finalised after the conclusion of Section 301 investigations by America, an official said on Monday.

In March, the US Trade Representative (USTR) launched two unilateral Section 301 investigations against a number of countries, including India, over excess capacity and failures to eradicate forced labour in global supply chains.

On June 2, the USTR proposed imposing 12.5 per cent tariffs on 54 countries, including India, for allegedly failing to prohibit the import of goods produced with forced labour. The report of the second probe (excess capacity) is awaited.

The conclusion of the probe is important as the temporary 10 per cent additional tariffs

India's exports to US grew by 0.92% to \$87.3 billion during FY26, while imports jumped 15.95% to \$52.9 billion

imposed by the US will end on July 24. After that, only the MFN (most favoured nation) tariffs will apply on the USA's trading partners.

"So if the US want us to pay any additional tax...they have to finish the Section 301 process before that," the official said.

India is seeking lower tariffs than its competitors, like members of Asean, as well as Sri Lanka and Bangladesh.

Last week, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

said that India and the US are moving towards closing all the open ends of the interim trade agreement, and both sides are likely to execute the "very, very vibrant" first phase of the pact by the middle of July.

The US team was here from June 2-4 for finalisation of the deal. They held discussions with the Indian team. A high-level team is expected to visit India towards the end of this month. The team is likely to be led by USTR Jameson Greer. The US was the second-largest trading partner of India in 2025-26.

India's outbound shipments to the US grew marginally by 0.92 per cent to \$87.3 billion during 2025-26, while imports increased 15.95 per cent to \$52.9 billion. The trade surplus declined to \$34.4 billion in 2025-26 from \$40.89 billion in 2024-25.

EU allows India to export eggs, honey & aquaculture products beyond Sept

NEW DELHI: The European Union has included India in the list of countries authorised to continue exporting aquaculture products, eggs, honey and animal casings to the 27-nation bloc beyond September under its revised regulatory framework.

The commerce ministry on Monday said that the European Union has notified an amendment to Regulation (EU) 2021/405 in view of growing concerns over antimicrobial resistance.

The revised regulation will come into effect from September 2026 and lays down additional requirements for countries exporting specified animal-origin products to the

working on that," the official said without disclosing details of the issues.

When asked if Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal will travel to London, the official said: "If things get ironed out, then maybe."

India and the Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO) meeting is expected to be held later this month in Britain.

On June 2, Goyal held talks with UK Secretary of State for



India's inclusion in list of authorised nations ensures continuity of exports of these products to the EU beyond Sept

European Union (EU). India's inclusion in the list of authorised countries ensures

continuity of exports of these products to the European Union market beyond September 2026, the ministry said.

This is particularly significant for the fisheries sector, as exports of fish and fishery products from India to the EU are currently valued at about \$1.59 billion.

The Department of Commerce has been actively engaging with the European Commission to address regulatory requirements and market access issues, while the EIC (Export Inspection Council) has strengthened India's Official Control System through enhanced inspection, testing and certification mechanisms in line with EU regulations.

Gold slips to ₹1.58L/10 gms, silver declines by ₹5,000

NEW DELHI: Gold prices fell Rs 1,100 to Rs 1.58 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Monday, as investors dumped precious metals amid rising crude oil rates following fresh escalating tensions in West Asia.

According to local marketmen, the price of gold of 99.9 per cent purity fell by Rs 1,100 to Rs 1,58,800 per 10 grams from Friday's closing level of Rs 1,59,900 per 10 grams.

Silver also remained under intense selling pressure, plunging Rs 5,000 to Rs 2,55,700 per kg, extending losses for the fourth consecutive session. The white metal has shed Rs 15,300, or nearly 6 per cent, from Rs



2.71 lakh per kg recorded on June 2.

In the global markets, spot gold fell nearly 1 per cent to \$4,291.79 per ounce, while silver declined 1.34 per cent to \$66.93 per ounce. Gold prices tumbled in overseas trade on strong US jobs data and escalating tensions in West Asia, Praveen Singh, Head of Commodities at Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

India records \$7.1 current account surplus in March quarter of FY26

The surplus was \$13.7 billion or 1.4 per cent of GDP in the fourth quarter of financial year 2024-25

MUMBAI: India recorded a current account surplus of \$7.1 billion, or 0.7 per cent of GDP, in the January-March quarter of 2025-26, helped by services exports and higher remittances, according to RBI data released on Monday. The surplus was \$13.7 billion or 1.4 per cent of GDP in Q4 2024-25.

However, for the entire fiscal 2025-26, the current account deficit stood at \$25.2 billion or 0.6 per cent of GDP compared to \$22.9 billion or 0.6 per cent of GDP in 2024-25.

While the merchandise trade deficit at \$83.4 billion in Q4 2025-26 was higher than

\$59.3 billion in the year-ago quarter, net services receipts increased to \$60.4 billion from \$53.3 billion.

Services exports increased on a year-on-year basis in major categories, such as computer services and other business services, said RBI's data on Developments in India's Balance of Payments during the Fourth Quarter of 2025-26.

Personal transfer receipts under the secondary income account, mainly representing remittances by Indians employed overseas, rose to \$43.5 billion in Q4 2025-26 from \$33.9 billion a year ago.

CLOSER LOOK

- » However, for the entire fiscal 2025-26, the current account deficit stood at \$25.2 billion or 0.6% of GDP
- » The current account deficit stood at \$22.9 billion or 0.6 per cent of GDP in entire financial year 2024-25
- » Personal transfer receipts rose to \$43.5 billion in Q4 FY26 from \$33.9 billion a year ago

In the financial account also, FDI recorded a net inflow of \$4.2 billion in Q4 2025-26, higher than \$0.4 billion in the year-ago period. On the other hand, foreign portfolio investment (FPI) invested a net of \$12 billion in the final quarter

of 2025-26 against the outflow of \$5.9 billion a year earlier, the RBI said.

The data also showed that net outgo on the primary income account, mainly reflecting payments of investment income, decreased to \$11.1 billion

in the fourth quarter from \$11.9 billion in Q4 FY25.

The RBI further said that non-resident deposits (NRI deposits) recorded a net inflow of \$3.3 billion against \$2.8 billion in Q4 FY25.

"Foreign exchange reserves increased by \$7.2 billion (on a BoP basis) in Q4 2025-26 as compared to an accretion of \$8.8 billion in Q4 2024-25," it added.

On India's Balance of Payments in 2025-26, the data showed that net invisible receipts at \$312 billion were higher in 2025-26 than \$264.0 billion a year ago, primarily on

account of net services receipts and net personal transfers.

Net invisible receipts comprise services, primary income and secondary income accounts.

In 2025-26, foreign exchange reserves depleted by \$23.6 billion (on a BoP basis) compared to a depletion of \$5 billion a year ago. Net FDI inflows stood at \$6.9 billion in 2025-26.

FPIs recorded net outflows of \$16.4 billion in 2025-26 against net inflows of \$3.6 billion in the year-ago period.

The depletion in foreign exchange reserves was higher at \$23.6 billion against a reduction of \$5 billion a year ago.



INDIRA GANDHI NATIONAL OPEN UNIVERSITY
Maidan Garhi, New Delhi - 110068



Admission for Ph.D July 2026 (Regular Mode)

- Psychology (PHDPC)
- Anthropology (PHDAN)
- Political Science (PHDPS)
- Public Administration (PHDPA)
- Bio-Chemistry (PHDBC)
- Chemistry (PHDCHEM)
- Geography (PHDGEOG)
- Geology (PHDGY)
- Life Sciences (PHDLS)
- Physics (PHDPH)
- Statistics (PHDSTAT)
- Mathematics (PHDMT)
- Sanskrit (PHDSK)
- Hindi (PHDHIN)
- English (PHDENG)

- Computer Science (PHDCS)
- Education (PHDES)
- Distance Education (PHDDE)
- Environmental Science (PHDEV)
- Fine Arts (PHDPVA)
- Theatre Arts (PHDPVA)
- Music (PHDPVA)
- Dance (PHDPVA)
- Social Work (PHDSW)
- Management (PHDMGMT)
- Commerce (PHDCOM)
- Nutritional Sciences (PHDFN)

- Child Development (PHDCD)
- Home Science (PHDHC)
- Vocational Education (PHDVE)
- Development Studies (PHDDV)
- Gender and Development Studies (PHDGDS)
- Translation Studies (PHDTS)
- French (PHDFL)
- Arabic (PHDAL)
- Journalism and Mass Communication (PHDJMC)

(For more details kindly visit official website of IGNOU i.e www.ignou.ac.in)

The above mentioned programmes are being offered in compliance with University Grants Commission (Minimum Standards and Procedure for Award of Ph.D. Degree) Regulations, 2022 and its amendments from time to time.

LAST DATE OF SUBMISSION OF APPLICATION:
21 days from the date of activation of on-line application on IGNOU Website.

Applications to be submitted online at www.ignou.ac.in



ignou.ac.in

IG/PIU/RU-15/2026-27

Director (Research Unit)



**Government of Jammu & Kashmir
Directorate of Tourism Kashmir**
TRC, Srinagar, Kashmir, 190001 Tel/ Fax 0194-2502279, 2502281.
e-mail dirtourism-kashmir@jk.gov.in

Sub:- Engagement of Snow Safety Officer for Ski resort, Gulmarg, Kashmir J&K for the year 2026-27.

Extention Notice

The Department of Tourism J&K invites offers from certified/accredited "Snow Safety Officers" to head the Ski Patrol Team in Gulmarg for the winter season 2026-27 for a period of 03 months w.e.f. 01-01-2027. The Snow Safety Officer must be qualified in Avalanche Snow Studies (Level-2/3) and must have 03 to 04 years of experience of working as Snow Safety Officer/using Explosives for triggering of Avalanches.

The role of the selected Officer would be:-

- To lead the Ski Patrol in a proactive manner.
- To segregate the mountains into marked and unmarked zones.
- To launch avalanche mitigation and controlled use of Explosives for Avalanche triggering.
- To take a weather call and issue advisories/notices accordingly.
- To evacuate injured skiers and administer First Aid.
- To train the local Ski Patrol Team.
- To Develop Strategies pertinent to local conditions.
- To advise J&K State Cable Car Corporation and Tourism Department regarding operation of Ski Lifts.
- To submit an annual report of the resort after the completion of the contract.

Interested persons may send their offers to e-mail ID dirtourism-kashmir@jk.gov.in which should include the following:-

- Full resume including scanned copies of relevant certificates/accredited courses in Snow Safety, Experience certificates, letter of recommendation (if any).
- QUOTE of professional Charges for 03 months in US Dollar.

Note:- The bid for professional charges should be inclusive of all Taxes and other charges including To and Fro Airfare, however boarding and lodging shall be provided by J&K Tourism Department. The department shall not arrange for the insurance of the Selected Snow Safety Officer and shall not be held liable in case of minor/major or fatal injury or death.

Due to poor response to this Office Notice No. DTK/REC/04-C/155, dated 13-05-2026. The date for submission of offers is extended up to **8th of July 2026.**

DIP No:DIPK-1939/26

Sd/
Director Tourism,
Kashmir.



Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Tower, Near Chakki Circle, Old Padra Road, Vadodra, Gujarat, Pin- 390 007.
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra- Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051

PUBLIC NOTICE – E-AUCTION OF ASSIGNMENT OF FINANCIAL ASSETS

In terms of the policy of ICICI Bank Limited ("ICICI Bank") on Sale of Financial Assets and in line with the regulatory guidelines, ICICI Bank hereby invites Expression of Interest ("EOI") from interested Scheduled Commercial Banks/ Small Finance Banks/ ARCs/ NBFCs/ FIs/ Other Transferee ("Permitted Transferee") for purchase of "Twenty Seven (27)" Non-Performing Assets ("Financial Asset") on the terms and conditions indicated herein under "Swiss Challenge Method". It is hereby clarified that confirmation of the name of successful bidder will be subject to the final approval by the competent authority of ICICI Bank.

Base Bid Price	Terms of sale	Minimum Mark up
₹ 337.5 million	100% in Cash	5 % of Base bid

Schedule for E-Auction:

Sr. No.	Activity	Date & Time
1.	Submission of Expression of Interest ("EOI") & Execution of Non-Disclosure Agreement ("NDA") (if not already executed with the Bank)	June 10, 2026, by 5.00 P.M.
2.	Release of Offer Document along with Preliminary Information Memorandum ("PIM") (Post Execution of NDA)	June 10, 2026.
3.	Access To Data Room For Due Diligence	From June 10, 2026 to June 23, 2026.
4.	Submission of Bid Form	June 24, 2026, by 5.00 P.M.
5.	Process of e-bidding (if required)	June 25, 2026 from 10:30 A.M. to 11:30 A.M. with auto extension of 5 mins. till sale is completed
6.	Right to match by the base bidder, if required	June 25, 2026, by 5.00 P.M.
7.	Execution of Assignment Agreement	June 29, 2026

TERMS & CONDITIONS

- The auction for the financial Asset(s) is under "Swiss Challenge Method", based on an existing offer in hand, who will have the right to match the highest bid, in case no bid is received which crosses the minimum markup. Base Bid will be designated as the winning bid if it qualifies as per terms and conditions stipulated.
- The sale of aforesaid Financial Asset(s) is on "As is Where is Basis", "As is What is Basis", and "Without Recourse Basis".
- Bank reserved the right to withdraw the e-auction, sale of financial assets at any point of time or amend any timelines at its sole discretion.
- The e-bidding process, if required, will be conducted through M/s e-Procurement Technologies Ltd (Auction tiger) on the website of auction agency i.e. <https://icicibank.auctiontiger.net> as detailed above. The e-bidding process shall be subject to terms & conditions contained in the offer document which will be made available to Parties post execution of NDA.
- For any further clarifications with regard to data room, terms and conditions of the auction, kindly contact Mr. Kiran Tadge (Mobile no. 9653685873) or Mr. Vijay Kumar (Mobile no. 9820803292). For submission of EOI/Bids, email at kiran.tadge@icici.bank.in and vijay.kumar@icici.bank.in or send by post to Mr. Kiran Tadge at ICICI Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra- Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051.
- ICICI Bank will not be responsible/liable in case of non-receipt of EOI by ICICI Bank for reasons beyond the control of the Bank. Interested Parties are expected to take efforts to find out the status of communication sent by them to ICICI Bank to ensure their participation in the auction process.
- This notice and contents hereof are subject to any prevailing laws, rules and regulations of India.

Date : June 09, 2026
Place : Delhi

Sd/-
Authorised Officer
ICICI Bank Limited



Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rahtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitization, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	M/s. Passerine Wealth Solutions Private Limited/ Manoj Kumar Gupta/ Nitasha Gupta/ Jasdeep Singh Anand/ 165205000103	Address-1: Commercial Property Bearing Unit No. 323, Admeasuring Super Built Up Area of 94.11 Sq. Meters (1013 Sq. Feet) on The Third Floor, In The Said Multi Storied Office Cum Commercial Complex Known As Vipul Trade Center, Sector-48, Fazilpur Jharsa, Tehsil & District Gurugram, Haryana, 122009. Admeasuring An Area- Super Built Up Area of 94.11 Sq. Meters (1013 Sq. Feet) Bounded By: North: As Per Sale Deed South: As Per Sale Deed East: As Per Sale Deed West: As Per Sale Deed/ Date of Symbolic Notice June 05, 2026	December 11, 2025/ Rs. 4,67,12,419.00/-	Gurgaon, Delhi

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: June 09, 2026
Place: Gurgaon & Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.





STATE BANK OF INDIA

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

HOME LOAN CENTRE-CUM-SARC II, CORRENTUM BUILDING, GROUND FLOOR, SECTOR-62, NOIDA, DISTT.- GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR, U.P.-201301

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE ON 16.06.2026 FOR MOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Movable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described movable property hypothecated /charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer State Bank of India : the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is Where is", "As is What is" and "Whatever there is" on 16.06.2026, for recovery of bank due to the secured creditor as under:-

Interested bidder may deposit Pre-Bid EMD with BAANKNET before the close of e-Auction. Credit of Pre-Bid EMD shall be given to the bidder only after receipt of payment in BAANKNET's Bank Account and up-dation of such information in the e-auction website. This may take some time as per banking process and hence bidders, in their own interest, are advised to submit the pre-bid EMD amount well in advance to avoid any last minute problem.

Date / Time of E-Auction on **16.06.2026** for 6 Hours from 10:00 AM to 04:00 PM with unlimited extn. of 10 minute each.

S. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)	Outstanding Dues for Recovery of which Property/ies is/ are being Sold	Vehicle Description	Reserve Price (Rs.) (Below which property could not be sold) Earnest Money (EMD) 10% of the Reserve Price Bid Increment Amount	Name of the Authorised (Signatory)
1.	MRS. NAMITA MEHTA	Rs.4,18,875.00 as on 08.06.2026 plus future interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: MARUTI CELERIO VXI CNG (PETROL / CNG) R.C. No.: UP16CS9334 Engine No.: K10BN8429374 Chassis No.: MA3ETDE1S00728728 Date of Registration: 28.12.2020 Kilometer Run: 68427 Fuel: Petrol / CNG	₹ 3,00,000.00 ₹ 30,000.00 ₹ 1,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Jyoti Priya (Chief Manager) Home Loan Centre-cum-SARC-II, Sector-62, Gautam Buddh Nagar, Noida, U.P.

Last Date of EMD Deposit on or before 15.06.2026 before 16:00 Hrs.
Account/ Wallet in which EMD to be remitted : Bidder's own wallet Registered with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: <https://baanknet.com/eaction-psb/eproc-listing> by means of NEFT/RETS. EMD of Reserve Price to be transferred by bidders by means of challan generated on his/her/bidder account maintained with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: <https://baanknet.com/eaction-psb/eproc-listing> by means of NEFT from his/her/bidder bank. For any assistance, please call BAANKNET HELPPESK: +91 8291220220, support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com and/or Authorized Officer.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE E-AUCTION ARE AS UNDER:

- E-Auction is being held on "As is where is", "as is what is basis" and "whatever there is basis" and will be conducted "On Line". The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider BAANKNET at their web portal: <https://baanknet.com/eaction-psb/eproc-listing>
- Bank shall reserve the right to cancel/postpone the auction.
- The Vehicle are available for inspection during banking hours on 14.06.2026 From 11:00 AM to 04:00 PM., Contact Person: Mr. Rahul Pal, Mob No.: 9810807622, Kuber Consultant (Resolution Agent) Address: G-27, Flat 104, Pankaj Tower 4 DDA Community Center, Vikas Puri, West Delhi, 110018.
- Successful bidder to pay GST as applicable on the successful bid amount, viz sale value.
- To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer there is no encumbrance on the properties/ies. However the intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of the properties/ies put on auction and claims/lights/dues/affecting the property prior to submitting their bid.
The e-Auction Advertisement does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any commitment or any representation of the Bank. The property is being sold with all the existing and future encumbrances whether known or unknown to the bank. The Authorized Officer shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/rights/dues.
- The Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of the successful bidder shall be retained towards part sale consideration and the EMD of the unsuccessful bidders shall be refunded. The Earnest Money Deposit shall not bear any interest. The successful bidder shall have to deposit 25% of the sale price, immediately on acceptance of bid price by the Authorized Officer and the balance of the sale price on or before 15th day of the sale. Default in deposit of amount by the successful bidder would entail forfeiture of the whole money already deposited and property shall be put to the e-auction and the defaulting bidder shall have no claim/right in respect of property / amount.
- For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer to the link at the Bank's Service Provider's web portal: <https://baanknet.com/eaction-psb/eproc-listing> & e-auction website: <https://BAANKNET.com>

Date: 08.06.2026 Place: Noida Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre, RACP 2, Noida



I, Nidhi Singh D/o
Anil Singh R/o 394, Sitapur Road, Keshav Nagar, Nirala Nagar, Lucknow, UP-226020 hereby declare and confirm that Nidhi Singh and Nidhi Singh Rai is a same person. My Legal name is Nidhi Singh. Kindly know me as "NIDHI SINGH".
CHANGE OF NAME

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles.

VEHICLES FOR SALE

- SWR.J. MAZDA SARTAJ XM REG. NO. DL1LAG2940-YOM- 2022
- SWR.J. MAZDA SARTAJ XM REG. NO. DL1LAG2103-YOM- 2022
- TATA MOTORS TATA1916 REG. NO. HR55A27455-YOM- NA
- ASHOK LEYAL U. 5525 REG. NO. HR38AH0114-YOM- NA
- MAH MHMAXXCITY REG. NO. DL1LAN7660-YOM-NA
- TATA MOTORS TATA 1512 REG. NO. DL1GE2483- YOM- NA
- TATA MOTORS T INTRAV20 REG. NO. DL1LAN6842-YOM- NA
- TATA MOTORS LPT2818 REG. NO. HR38AC1345-YOM-2021
- TATA MOTORS TATAACE REG. NO. DL1LAN9920-YOM-2022
- TATA MOTORS TATAACE REG. NO. DL1LAL3987-YOM- 2023
- TATA MOTORS TACEGOLD REG. NO. DL1LAM8833-YOM-2024
- TATA MOTORS TACEGOLCNG REG. NO. DL1LAM4356-YOM - 2024
- TATA LPT909FB REG. NO. DL1MA0755-YOM - 2018

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION"
INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT
BRANCH ADDRESS:
KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK
3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313
OR CONTACT : RAMAN AHUJA
KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD.
CONTACT NO. 8377988238
EMAIL-raman.ahuja@kotak.com

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rahul S/o Maan Singh R/o A-48, Dilip Enclave, Mubarakpur, Dabas, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 265/2016 U/S 380/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Rahul** cannot not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul of FIR No. 265/2016 U/S 380/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 31.07.2026 at 10:00 am.

By Order,

Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North-West, Court No. 109, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7049/RD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURAKSHA SANHITA

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ajay Aggarwal S/o M.L. Aggarwal** Present Address: H. No. A-67, Second Floor, Swasthya Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 24/2009 u/s 420/468/471/120-B IPC at P.S. EOW, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ajay Aggarwal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ajay Aggarwal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ajay Aggarwal** accused of FIR No. 24/2009 u/s 420/468/471/120-B IPC at P.S. EOW, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on 10.07.2026.

By Order: Ms. Harshita Mishra,

Chief Judicial Magistrate (Central)

DP/7651/EOW/2026 Room No. 38, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shamshed Afroz S/o Nizamuddin R/o Gupta Dhaba, Shastri Park, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 160/2016 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Shamshed Afroz** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Shamshed Afroz** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shamshed Afroz of FIR No. 160/2016 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 30.07.2026

By Order,

Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class- 11
Central District, Court No. 138, 1st Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7452/N/2026(Court Matter)



Regional Office: Netaji Marg, Nr. Mithakhali Six Roads, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-6. Phone : +91-79-26421671-75

Demand Notice to Borrowers

The under mentioned account turned into N.P.A and demand notice is issued by Bandhan Bank Ltd. to the following borrower(s), under sec.13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act (The Act), 2002 which was returned unserved. Hence, this notice is issued to you all and public at large through publication.

Name of borrower(s), and Loan Account No.	Description of mortgaged property (Secured Asset)	Date of Demand Notice/Date of NPA	O/S Amount as on Date of Posting of Notice	Date of Posting of Notice
Mr. Amol Bhatia S/O Surendra Kumar Bhatia Mrs. Rinkie Bhatia W/O Sh. Amol Bhatia 90001238115817 90001276153688	All That Piece or Parcel of Admeasuring About 1495.00 Sq. Ft. Bearing Plot No. B-170/A (Part Of The Property B-170 Southern Side), Reg. Doc. No. 2024/15/1/12841 Dated 04.09.2024 In S.R.O-VI A, Pitampura Situated At First Floor, Derawal Nagar, Delhi-110009, Owned By Mrs. Rinkie Bhatia W/O Sh. Amol Bhatia, Amol Bhatia S/O Surendra Kumar Bhatia, - And Same Bounded As Under: North: Remaining Half Portion Of Property No. B-170, East: Property No.B-169, West: Road 30 Ft. Wide, South: Service Lane	April 30, 2026/ April 05, 2026	Rs.1,96,41,855.85	June 06, 2026

Demand made against you through this notice to repay to the Bank dues mentioned against your name with interest, costs and charges within 60 days from the date hereof, failing which the Bank will further proceed to take steps u/s 13(4) of the SARFAESI Act. The borrowers'/mortgagors' attention is invited to the provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Date: June 09, 2026

Authorised Officer
Bandhan Bank Limited



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Aftab Ansari S/o Sef Mohammad R/o H. No. 299, J.J. Camp, Badli Village, Badli North West, Delhi, Sector-19, Rohini, New Dehi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case Regd. No. 2868/2022 u/s 25 Passa Act at P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Aftab Ansari** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Aftab Ansari** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Aftab Ansari** accused of Case Regd. No. 2868/2022 u/s 25 Passa Act at P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on 31.08.2026.

By Order: Sh. Sanyam Jain,

Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (North-West),
Room No. 112, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6806/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu @ Prabhat, S/o. Sh. Mohan Kumar Sharma, R/o.: H.No. 1874, Wazir Singh Gali, Chuna Mandi, Paharganj, Delhi-110055** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 354/2016 U/S 307/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Paharganj, Central District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said **Sonu @ Prabhat** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Sonu @ Prabhat** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sonu @ Prabhat**, accused of **FIR No. 354/2016 U/S 307/34 IPC, P.S. Paharganj, Central District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 08.07.2026 at 10.00 A.M.

By Order, Sh. Virender Kumar Kharta,

Additional Sessions Judge (FC)-2, (Central),
Room No. 266, Second Floor,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/7658/CD/2026 (Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: 07/2026
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

Tender No.: 13265559 E.M.D. (Rs.): ₹ 124200/-

Description: IoT based water level indicator system.

Qty.: 01 Set Tender Opening Date: 29.06.2026

Note:- (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against Above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. (5) Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is Z-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores - 00844517. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 1294/26 (A)

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice 06/2026 dated 05.06.2026
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

Tender no. : 13265297 Qty : 01 Set EMD (Rs.) : 290320/-

Description : Spares of Air Brake System (Make - M/s Knorr Bremse India PVT LTD)

Tender Opening Date : 29.06.2026

Note: (1)The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tender, For this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. (5) Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is Z-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores - 00844517. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 1292/26 (AS)

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010
LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 28-05-2026, one person namely Arjun Singh S/O Banta Singh R/O Village Kuka Chack Tehsil & District Kathua lodged a written report at P/S Kathua stating therein that his daughter namely Baijeet Kour, age 28 years was missing from home on 24-05-2026 at about 1815 hrs. The complainant tried his best to search for his daughter but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No 12 dated 28-05-2026 has been entered at Police Station Kathua.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/ Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

DESCRIPTION ROLL	PHOTOGRAPH
Name Baijeet Kour	
Husband Banta Singh	
Village Kuka Chack	
Present Address Village Kuka Chack Tehsil	
Tehsil Kathua	
Police Station Kathua	
Age 28 years	
Height 5 feet 06 inch	
Complexion Fair	
Built Normal	
Face Oval	
Eyes Black	
Languages known Hindi/ Punjabi	

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

- DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
- dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
- PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
- Police Station Billawar – 01922-234010

Sd/-Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

DIP No:DIP/J-3323/26

Organic manure procurement up 3.5x to 11.17 LT this kharif season

The Centre reiterated that the overall stock position of fertilisers in the country is comfortable and there is no challenge in availability

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government on Monday said farmers have bought 11.17 lakh tonnes of organic manure in the ongoing kharif sowing season, a 3.5 times jump from the year-ago period, indicating a gradual shift from chemical fertilisers.

The Centre also reiterated that the overall stock position of fertilisers in the country is comfortable and there is no challenge in availability. It is also monitoring the situation on a regular basis to ensure adequate domestic supply.

At an inter-ministerial briefing on the recent developments in West Asia, Aparna S Sharma, additional secretary in the Union Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilisers, said, “For kharif 2026, the fertiliser requirement has been reassessed by the Department of Agriculture at 383.9 lakh tonnes and against this, the stock as on today is 197.56 lakh tonnes.”

The stock is more than 51 per cent of the kharif season demand and this is significantly higher than the usual level of 33 per cent, she added.



Total domestic production of fertilizers, including urea, DAP, NPKs, and SSP has increased from 433.29 lakh tonne in 2021 to a record 524.62 lakh tonne in 2025

“The purchase of fertiliser has been about 86.65 lakh tonnes for the ongoing kharif, that is approximately 22.57 per cent of the total requirement,” Sharma said.

The secretary also said the farmers have procured 11.17 lakh tonnes of organic manure in the season, compared to 3.2 lakh tonnes during the corresponding period last year.

“This substantial increase reflects a positive trend towards

greater adoption of the organic nutrient sources and a gradual shift in the farmers’ preference from chemical fertiliser to the organic alternatives,” Sharma said.

The secretary asserted that there is no major challenge in availability of fertilisers currently.

“The domestic production and import continues, and a total of 147.4 lakh tonnes have been imported

Highlights

» In June, over 25 lakh tonnes of imported urea, DAP & PKs have arrived & tender of 17 lakh tonnes of urea is under progress

» In 2025, nearly 73% of the country’s total fertiliser requirement was met through domestic production

» Country’s urea output has jumped from 225 lakh tonne during 2014-15 to 306.67 lakh tonne in 2024-25

as well as domestically manufactured after the crisis situation. In June, more than 25 lakh tonnes of imported urea, DAP, and PKs have arrived at the ports, and a tender of 17 lakh tonnes of urea is under progress,” she said.

Sharma said the government is clearing all subsidy bills as per the budgetary provision.

She said the “situation is being monitored at the highest level in the Empowered Group

of Secretary meetings to ensure adequate availability of fertiliser and raw materials.”

In 2025, nearly 73 per cent of the country’s total fertiliser requirement was met through domestic production.

India imports a large quantity of urea and di-ammonium phosphate (DAP) to meet local demand.

Total domestic production of fertilizers, including urea, DAP, NPKs, and SSP has increased from 433.29 lakh tonne in 2021 to a record 524.62 lakh tonne in 2025.

The country’s urea production has increased from 225 lakh tonne during 2014-15 to 306.67 lakh tonne in 2024-25. The country imported more than 100 lakh tonne of urea last fiscal year to meet local demand.

The budgetary allocation for fertiliser subsidies in 2026-27 stands at Rs 1.71 lakh crore and the import bill is likely to rise as rates in global markets have shot up.

At present, the MRP of neem-coated urea is Rs 242 per bag (45kg), while the DAP is being sold at Rs 1,350 per bag (50kg).

APSEZ bags 10-year contract for Argentina’s 1st LNG export project

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd (APSEZ) on Monday said it has secured a 10-year marine services contract for Argentina’s first LNG export, marking its entry into South America and expanding its international marine services footprint.

The company in a statement said the contract has been awarded to APSEZ’s step-down subsidiary, Adani Harbour International FZCO, through a consortium with Argentina-based Meridian Group, following a global competitive tender process conducted by Southern Energy SA (SESA).

The award strengthens APSEZ’s presence across international energy logistics value chains and underscores its growing capabilities in specialised marine services, it added.

Under the agreement, the consortium will provide end-to-end marine services, including tugboat operations for LNG carriers, offshore logistics and supply support, and crew transfer services. The project will be supported by four high-specification tugboats, one anchor handling tug supply vessel and one crew boat.

Ashwani Gupta, Whole-time Director and CEO, APSEZ, said, “With marine operations in 12 countries and a growing fleet of marine assets supporting ports, LNG terminals, national oil companies, refineries and



‘The contract has been awarded to APSEZ’s step-down subsidiary, Adani Harbour International FZCO, via consortium with Argentina-based Meridian Group’

offshore facilities, we bring deep operational expertise to complex maritime environments.”

“By combining these capabilities with strong local partnerships, we are helping create reliable maritime ecosystems that enable new energy trade corridors and strengthen long-term supply resilience,” he added. APSEZ said Argentina is emerging as a major new LNG supplier, with agreements in place to support exports of up to 10 million tonnes (MT) annually to India from 2027.

The Southern Energy FLNG

project is expected to play an important role in connecting this growing supply base with global demand centres. According to the statement, The Southern Energy FLNG project is being developed by SESA, a joint venture between Golar LNG & Pan American Energy.

Located in the San Matias Gulf in Argentina’s Rio Negro Province, the project will liquefy natural gas from the General San Martin pipeline aboard the Floating Liquefied Natural Gas (FLNG) vessel Hilli Episuyo, with commercial operations expected to begin in September 2027.

In its first phase, APSEZ said the project is expected to produce 2.45 MT of LNG annually, equivalent to approximately 28 cargoes per year, making it Argentina’s first operational LNG export project. The contract will be executed through Meridian Transportes Maritimos SA, a 51:49 joint venture between Adani Harbour International FZCO and Meridian Group, the company added.

Bhavya portal to cut red tape for investors: Goyal

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Monday launched the Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA) portal, positioning it as a major step towards simplifying industrial land acquisition and creating plug-and-play industrial parks across the country.

Recalling his own experience of making more than 90 visits to the Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation office in the 1980s to secure an

industrial plot, Goyal said the portal would provide entrepreneurs and investors transparent, single-window access to industrial land.

The platform will integrate Google Maps and satellite imagery, enabling investors to assess plot size, connectivity and surrounding industrial units before applying. Goyal also suggested a future feature allowing investors to choose neighbouring industries, potentially at a premium, to avoid locating near pollut-

ing units.

The government has earmarked Rs 34,000 crore (about \$4 billion) for developing 100 plug-and-play industrial parks. Goyal said the scheme would attract large investments, generate jobs and strengthen Centre-state cooperation while providing social infrastructure within industrial clusters.

Under the rollout plan, 20 parks will be selected from applications received between June 1 and July 31, followed

by 30 more by September 30. States will be required to establish special purpose vehicles (SPVs) before applying, a move aimed at speeding up project implementation.

For MSMEs, Goyal said the government is open to concepts such as flatted factories if industry associations aggregate demand. He added that private service providers should manage utilities and compliance, allowing manufacturers to focus on production.

AGENCIES

Vedanta renames its copper, nickel businesses

NEW DELHI: Vedanta Ltd on Monday rebranded its copper and nickel businesses as Vedanta Copper and Vedanta Nickel, respectively, as part of its Vedanta 2.0 transformation strategy aimed at creating stronger sector-focused identities.

The company said all copper operations, including Sterlite Copper, Fujairah Gold and Vedanta Copper International, will operate under the Vedanta Copper brand. VCI will serve as the international arm of the



business, covering operations in Fujairah and Saudi Arabia.

Vedanta Nico has been renamed Vedanta Nickel and will focus on building a domestic nickel ecosystem and supporting India’s growing demand

for critical minerals.

The rebranding will be implemented in phases across business operations and stakeholder touch-points, while both businesses will continue to function under Vedanta Ltd. According to the company, the move is intended to improve operational alignment, market visibility and stakeholder engagement, while enabling the businesses to pursue growth under a unified vision.

Vedanta Copper plans to

expand production capacity to 460 kilo tonnes per annum (KTPA) by the end of next year. Vedanta Nickel aims to increase output to 60 KTPA from the current 7 KTPA.

Puneet Khurana, CEO of Vedanta Copper and Vedanta Nickel, said the unified identities would help unlock synergies, meet evolving market needs and support India’s industrial growth and energy transition as demand for critical and transition metals rises.

AGENCIES

Sport

Suthar, a turn of fate for India

India thrash Afghanistan as Manav shines to put Jadeja under pressure

MULLANPUR: Left-arm Manav Suthar’s emergence as the flagbearer of India’s spin attack in the foreseeable future was the biggest gain for the hosts in their expectedly dominant innings and 300 runs victory over Afghanistan in the one-off Test here on Monday.

After being bowled out for 152 in the first innings, courtesy a 6/33 from Suthar, Afghanistan fared much worse in the second essay getting bundled out for 112 in 35.5 overs midway into the third day to hand India their biggest innings win.

Washington Sundar (4/36) did the star turn in the second innings while Kuldeep Yadav (3/30) also helped himself to some easy pickings.

In 2018, India had thrashed the Afghans by an innings and 260 runs but the visitors would take solace that they could stretch this Test into the third day. The match belonged to Suthar, a left-arm orthodox spinner from Rajasthan’s Sri Ganganagar.

He became the 10th Indian bowler to take a five-for on debut with his overall haul of seven wickets (6/33 and 1/29) but more importantly, he answered the lingering question in country’s cricketing ecosystem: “Who will take over the baton from Ravindra Jadeja as



India won by an innings and 300 runs, their biggest innings triumph

PTI

and when he calls time?”

After the match against Afghanistan, Suthar showed all the requisite attributes to succeed at the highest level. The biggest among them being the consistency of landing the ball in the same spot.

Add the speed at which he bowls and the number of revolutions that he imparts while putting his whole body behind each delivery, Suthar is a complete package.

India have had bowlers who were wicket-takers on turners but the 23-year-old has shown that he can be a match-winner on placid surfaces by extracting

both turn and bounce.

With Ravichandran Ashwin already retired and Jadeja in the twilight of his Test career, Suthar’s emergence couldn’t have happened at a better time.

He will face a far bigger Test in Sri Lanka where the quality of batting will be way better but the Indian team management can think of slowly phasing Jadeja out by the end of this World Test Championship cycle. There isn’t much to write about Afghanistan’s batting which lacked skill as well as experience.

Indian spinners benefited from some atrocious shot

selection by the visiting batters throughout the second innings.

After being shot out for 152, they played too many strokes that brought about their downfall in the second innings.

Left-handed opener Sediqullah Atal (42), who was signed by Delhi Capitals in last year, was dismissed off the last ball before tea as he tried to hit Washington against the turn and offered a simple catch to Mohammed Siraj at backward point.

Rahmanullah Gurbaz (24) wanted to hit his way out of the trouble before Shubman Gill placed Siraj at the long-on boundary asking Kuldeep to



lure him for an aerial shot.

The move paid off immediately as Gurbaz was holed out at long-on. A similar thing happened with first innings half-centurion Rahmat Shah (13), who wanted to loft Washington over mid-off but couldn’t clear the man of the moment, Suthar.

It was a pity that barely 500 odd people were present in the stands when the country’s newest spin bowling star completed a rare milestone, becoming the 10th Indian to take five wicket-haul on debut.

AGENCIES



Manav Suthar was named the Player of the Match for his exploits

PTI

After announcing arrival, Suthar says rise built on consistency

MULLANPUR: Debutant left-arm spinner Manav Suthar said on Monday that his maiden Test appearance taught him that consistency and patience are the biggest virtues in the longest format, after starring in India’s comprehensive innings-and-300-run victory over Afghanistan in the one-off match in Mullanpur.

Named Player of the Match for his seven-wicket match haul, Suthar said repeatedly

hitting the same areas was the secret behind his success on a surface that offered plenty of assistance to the spinners.

“The biggest lesson is that consistency is everything. You have to keep bowling in the same area over and over again. I think that’s the most important thing in Test cricket. It’s a format that demands a lot of patience,” Suthar said at the presentation ceremony.

“That’s what I’ve learned,

6/33
Suthar’s figures are the third-best figures for an Indian bowler on a Test debut

keep being patient, stick to your plans and keep hitting the right areas consistently,” he said.

The 23-year-old left-arm spinner said that representing India in Test cricket felt surreal. “It was a very unreal feeling. It has been my dream from the very beginning to play for India and to play Test cricket. So it was an incredible moment for me and honestly felt quite unreal.”

Suthar said batting before

bowling helped him understand the nature of the wicket, which in turn aided his bowling plans. “Even when I went out to bat, I felt quite comfortable. As I settled in and faced a few deliveries, I realised there was a bit of assistance for the spinners on the wicket. Then, when I came on to bowl and delivered my first over, I got the same feeling. After that, my only focus was to keep using the right line, length and pace.”

The spinner said he consciously relied on his stock ball in the initial phase before introducing subtle variations.

“Initially, my focus was on understanding how the wicket was playing. That’s why I wanted to rely on my stock delivery as much as possible. Once I understood that the wicket was a little slow and required some variation in pace, I started making those adjustments,” he said.

AGENCIES

FIFA WORLD CUP SCHEDULE 2026												June 11-July 19																			
FIFA Hosts Canada Mexico USA														Group A Mexico South Africa South Korea Czechia			Group B Canada Bosnia and Herzegovina Switzerland			Group C Brazil Morocco Haiti Scotland			Group D USA Paraguay Australia Turkey			Group E Germany Curacao Côte d'Ivoire Ecuador			Group F Netherlands Japan Sweden Tunisia		
Group G Belgium Egypt Iran New Zealand														Group H Spain Cabo Verde Saudi Arabia Uruguay			Group I France Senegal Iraq Norway			Group J Argentina Algeria Austria Jordan			Group K Portugal DR Congo Uzbekistan Colombia			Group L Chengdu Croatia Ghana Panama					
Group Phase																															
June 11 1 Mexico vs South Africa				June 18 25 Czechia vs South Africa				June 24 49 Switzerland vs Canada																							
June 12 3 South Korea vs Czechia				June 19 26 Switzerland vs BHA1				June 25 50 BHA1 vs Qatar																							
June 13 4 Canada vs Paraguay				June 20 27 Canada vs Qatar				June 26 51 Scotland vs Haiti																							
June 14 5 Qatar vs Switzerland				June 21 28 Mexico vs South Korea				June 27 52 Morocco vs Haiti																							
June 15 6 Brazil vs Morocco				June 22 29 USA vs Australia				June 28 53 Czechia vs Mexico																							
June 16 7 Haiti vs Scotland				June 23 30 Scotland vs Morocco				June 29 54 South Africa vs South Korea																							
June 17 8 Australia vs Turkey				June 24 31 Brazil vs Haiti				June 30 55 Ecuador vs Germany																							
June 18 9 Germany vs Curacao				June 25 32 Turkey vs Paraguay				June 31 56 Curacao vs Côte d'Ivoire																							
June 19 10 Netherlands vs Japan				June 26 33 Netherlands vs Sweden				June 32 57 Japan vs Sweden																							
June 20 11 Côte d'Ivoire vs Ecuador				June 27 34 Germany vs Côte d'Ivoire				June 33 58 Tunisia vs Netherlands																							
June 21 12 Sweden vs Japan				June 28 35 Ecuador vs Curacao				June 34 59 Turkey vs USA																							
June 22 13 Spain vs Cabo Verde				June 29 36 Tunisia vs Japan				June 35 60 Paraguay vs Australia																							
June 23 14 Belgium vs Egypt				June 30 37 Spain vs Saudi Arabia				June 36 61 Norway vs France																							
June 24 15 Saudi Arabia vs Uruguay				June 31 38 Belgium vs Iran				June 37 62 Senegal vs Iraq																							
June 25 16 Iran vs Scotland				June 32 39 Uruguay vs Cabo Verde				June 38 63 Cabo Verde vs Saudi Arabia																							
June 26 17 France vs Senegal				June 33 40 New Zealand vs Egypt				June 39 64 Uruguay vs Spain																							
June 27 18 Iraq vs Norway				June 34 41 Argentina vs Austria				June 40 65 Egypt vs Iran																							
June 28 19 Argentina vs Algeria				June 35 42 France vs Iraq				June 41 66 New Zealand vs Belgium																							
June 29 20 Austria vs Jordan				June 36 43 Norway vs Senegal				June 42 67 Panama vs Ghana																							
June 30 21 Portugal vs DR Congo				June 37 44 Jordan vs Algeria				June 43 68 Croatia vs England																							
June 31 22 England vs Croatia				June 38 45 Portugal vs Uzbekistan				June 44 69 Colombia vs Portugal																							
June 32 23 Ghana vs Panama				June 39 46 England vs Ghana				June 45 70 DR Congo vs Uzbekistan																							
June 33 24 Uzbekistan vs Colombia				June 40 47 Panama vs Croatia				June 46 71 Algeria vs Austria																							
				June 41 48 Colombia vs DR Congo				June 47 72 Jordan vs Argentina																							
Knockout Phase																															
B&B: Bosnia and Herzegovina																															
The top two teams from each group, along with the eight best third-placed teams, will qualify for the knockout stage																															
Round of 32				Round of 16				Quarter-finals				Round of 16				Round of 32															
74 June 29 1E vs 3ABCD 77 June 30 1E vs 3BCDGH				97 July 9 W89 W97 vs W77				101 July 14 W97 vs W89				99 July 9 W97 vs W75 W91 vs W100				96 July 29 1E vs 2F 76 June 30 2E vs 2J															
73 June 28 2A vs 2B 1E vs 2C				96 July 9 W73 vs W75				102 July 15 W97 vs W91				95 July 7 W75 vs W78 W97 vs W90				79 June 30 1A vs 3BEFH 75 June 31 1E vs 3EJHI															
82 July 2 3K vs 2L				93 July 6 W83 vs W84				100 July 11 W99 vs W100				95 July 7 W75 vs W78				86 July 31 1J vs 2H															
81 July 1 10 vs 3BEFJ				94 July 6 W81 vs W82				101 July 11 W95 vs W96				96 July 7 W79 vs W80				85 July 30 1B vs 3BEFG															
82 July 1 16 vs 3AEJH								101 July 11 W95 vs W96				96 July 7 W79 vs W80				87 July 31 1K vs 3DEJH															
Source: FIFA				July 18 - Far Third Place (losers of the two semi-finals)				K&K Sports Graphics																							



RERA : HRERA-PKL-FBD-705-2025



Applications are invited online from General Public for booking of Residential Flats in the “OLIVE HOMES” an Affordable Group Housing Project, to be developed at Sector 98, Faridabad, by M/s. SOHAREALTY PVT. LTD., as per the terms and conditions of the policy prescribed by Town & Country Planning Department, Government of Haryana vide notification No. PF-27/48921 dated 19.08.2013, amended upto date (details available at the website of the department i.e. tcepharyana.gov.in)

Project Details	
1. Project	: “OLIVE HOMES”
2. Project Approvals	: M/s. SOHA REALTY PVT. LTD. Licence No./Year: 125 of 2024 dated 23.10.2024 Building Plan Approved on dated: 22.04.2025 vide Memo No. ZP-2075/PA(DK)/2025/14430
3. Location	: RERA No.- HRERA-PKL-FBD-705-2025 Dated : 27.05.2025 Sector-98, Faridabad, Haryana
4. Provisions	: Project Area: 8.20625 Acres, comprising of a Total 1184 No. of Flats out of which 5% flats are reserved for management quota and balance 95% flats are available for sale to the General Public. Common Facilities: One Community Hall of 2665 Sq.ft. (Approx.) and One Anganwadi-Cum-Creche of 2665 Sq.ft. (approx.) As per rates prescribed under the policy notified vide Memo No. PF-27/48921 dated 19.08.2013, amended upto date Vide Memo No. PF-27-Vol-III/ 2026/11396 Dated: 08.04.2026 issued by the Principal Secretary to the Government of Haryana, Town and Country Planning Department, Chandigarh (details available at the website of the department i.e. tcepharyana.gov.in) Sale Price (On Carpet Area): Rs 5,450/- PSF (additional cost of Balcony @Rs.1300/- PSF subject to maximum of 100 Sq.Ft). PARKING: - Two-wheeler parking with each apartment. Gated Entry, Security post, Open Seating & Kids Play Area, Walking Track, Open GYM & Commercial.
5. Facilities	

Payment Plan	
1. With Application: 5% BSP of Flat, on Booking	
2. On Allotment: 25% of the Total Allotment along with applicable GST, Less Booking Amount.	
3. Balance :75%with applicable GST is as per DTPC Policy for Affordable Group Housing Project i.e., Construction Linked Payment Plan. Any default in payment will attract penal interest as provided in Rule 15 of the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority	

APPLICATION TIMELINES	
1. Application form will be filled online by registering on the website https://edraw.tcepharyana.gov.in/tcp-dms/home w.e.f 10.06.2026	
2. Last Date of submission of the Application: 11.06.2026	

NOTE: 1. If any applicant in response to our earlier publications regarding Project ID 218 (Olive Homes) have applied under management quota (MQ) through an oversight, they may update their applications by updating the correct option failing which all such applications shall be liable to be rejected.

2. If any of the applicant could not finally submit his application due to technical reasons, he may also do so now.

Inventory Details									
Unit Category	Unit Type	Carpet Area in Sqft	Balcony Area in Sqft	Total No. of Flats	BSP of Flat	Balcony Cost	Total BSP of flat with Balcony cost	Booking Amount (5% of BSP of flat)	On Allotment (25% of BSP of the Flat & Balcony Less Booking Amount)
1BHK	TYPE-A	403.46	167.49	24	₹ 21,98,857	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 23,28,857	₹ 1,09,943	₹ 4,72,271
1BHK	TYPE-A	398.27	117.55	16	₹ 21,70,572	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 23,00,572	₹ 1,08,529	₹ 4,66,614
1BHK	TYPE-A	401.09	45.32	56	₹ 21,85,941	₹ 58,916	₹ 22,44,857	₹ 1,09,297	₹ 4,51,917
1BHK	TYPE-B	398.27	117.55	16	₹ 21,70,572	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 23,00,572	₹ 1,08,529	₹ 4,66,614
1BHK	TYPE-B	407.63	66.74	56	₹ 22,21,584	₹ 86,762	₹ 23,08,346	₹ 1,11,079	₹ 4,66,007
2BHK	TYPE-A	573.29	202.58	312	₹ 31,24,431	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 32,54,431	₹ 1,56,222	₹ 6,57,386
2BHK	TYPE-A	556.31	160.17	184	₹ 30,31,890	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 31,61,890	₹ 1,51,594	₹ 6,38,878
2BHK	TYPE-B	573.63	136.28	184	₹ 31,26,284	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 32,56,284	₹ 1,56,314	₹ 6,57,757
2BHK	2BHK-14th Floor	532.54	214.74	24	₹ 29,02,343	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 30,32,343	₹ 1,45,117	₹ 6,12,969
3BHK		644.99	215.28	312	₹ 35,15,196	₹ 1,30,000	₹ 36,45,196	₹ 1,75,760	₹ 7,35,539

Total Units: 1184

- 5% Management Quota Applicable
- GST @1% shall be charged extra.
- Rate mentioned above does not include other charges such as Stamp Duty, Registration Fees of Agreement to Sell as well as Conveyance Deed

BROAD SPECIFICATIONS
Flooring: Rooms- Vitrified Tiles/ Ceramic Tiles, Kitchen- Vitrified Tiles/ Ceramic Tiles, Toilet- Anti Skid Tiles, Balcony- Anti Skid Tiles /I.P.S./ and any other material as decided by the Developer, Door/Window Frame- M.S. Hollow Section any other frame as decided by the developer, Door Shutters-Flush Doors Painted with Enamel Paint or any other shutter as decided by the Developer, Wall Tiles-Bathroom Ceramic Tiles, Kitchen- Vitrified Tiles/ Ceramic Tiles to 2 Feet height above counter, Kitchen Platform - Marble Stone / Granite, Wall Finish-Colour Wash/Dry Distemper, Plumbing Fitting-PPR Pipes/C/PVC Pipes/UPVC Pipes or equivalent, Sanitary Fitting-Chinaware and CP Fittings, Electric Switches / Wiring-ISI Marked or equivalent, Structure-RCC frames Structure designed for SEISMIC forces as per latest IS Code.

ELIGIBILITY:
Any person can apply, however, the PMAY beneficiaries, which include their spouse or dependent children, identified by the Urban Local Bodies Department, Haryana under “Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojna-Housing for All” programme shall be granted preference in allotment. First priority shall be given to the identified beneficiaries of the said town followed by other PMAY beneficiaries of the State of Haryana. Thereafter, for the remaining flats, persons which include their spouse or dependent children who do not own any flat/plot in any HUDA developed colony/sector or any licensed colony in any of the Urban areas in Haryana, UT of Chandigarh and NCT Delhi shall be given next preference in allotment of flats. An applicant in a specific colony shall make only one application. Any successful applicant under this policy shall not be eligible for allotment of any other flat under this policy in any other colony. In case he/she is successful in more than one colony, he/she will have choice to retain only one flat. All such applicants shall submit an affidavit to this effect”. PAN Card & Aadhar Card is compulsory.

ALLOTMENT CRITERIA: (i) The allotment of flats shall be done through draw of lots in the presence of committee consisting of Deputy Commissioner or his representative (at least of the Cadre of Haryana Civil Services), Senior Town Planner, (circle office), DTP of the concerned district and the representative of coloniser concerned. ii) After fixation of the date of draw of lots, an advertisement shall be issued by the Developer, informing the applicants about the details regarding date/time and venue of the draw of lots in the same newspapers in which the original advertisement was issued. iii) For detailed criteria and time frame to be adopted for scrutiny and allotment, the applicants may also refer to the details amendment in the Affordable Housing Policy-2013 dated 19.08.2013 notified vide Memo. PF-27-Vol-III/ 2026/11396 Dated: 08.04.2026, amended upto date (available at the Department website i.e. tcepharyana.gov.in)

Note: The surrendered/withdrawn applicants of successful applicants of earlier draws of any project are to get the status updated in the STP office, Faridabad, before filing the application in the current project within 02 weeks of publication of this Notice.

SOHA REALTY PVT. LTD.
Corp. Address : B-27, Ground Floor, Vipul Plaza,
Sector-81, Faridabad, Haryana-121002

**8585856616**



C.G. Police Housing Corporation, Raipur
Head Office – P.H.Q. Campus, North Block, Sector-19,
Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.) Phone 0771 - 2331800
Tender No./ 415 to 484 /CGPHC/Bldg/2026 Dated 05/06/2206
TENDER NOTICE (Ist, 2nd and 3rd Call)

Online Tenders are invited according to key dates for Construction Of H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) 60 Nos & NGO House G+2 (12 Nos) at 9th Bn. Karli Dist. – Dantewada, H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) 72 Nos & NGO House G+2 (24 Nos) at Dantewada (District Police) Dist. – Dantewada, H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) 96 Nos at 15th Bn. Bijapur Dist. – Bijapur, Proposed Superintendent of Police Office at Surguja Dist. – Surguja, Jashpur Dist. – Jashpur, Balodabazar – Bhatapara Dist. – Balodabazar Bhatapara, Kabirdham Dist. – Kabirdham, Proposed Sub Inspector Trainees Hostel at PTS Mana Raipur Dist. – Raipur, Proposed Central Armed Workshop at 4th Bn. Mana Raipur Dist. – Raipur, Repair Work of Police Head Quarter Building Atal Nagar, Nava Raipur (C.G.), GO’s Mess at Dantewada Dist. – Dantewada, GO’s Mess at Korba Dist. – Korba, Multi Storey Barrack at Raipur, Jashpur, Durg, 4th Bn. Mana Raipur, Balrampur, Kondagaon, and Sarangarh – Bilaiagarh, GO’s Transit Hostel at Durg, Mungeli, Khairagarh – Chhuikhadan – Gandai, Kondagaon, Rajnandgaon, Jashpur, Mohla – Manpur – Ambagarh Chowki and Korba, NGO Transit Hostel at Surajpur, Surguja, PTS Mana Raipur, Mungeli, Manendragarh – Bharatpur – Chirmiri, Jashpur, Korba, Gariyaband and Balrampur, Constable / Head Constable Transit Hostel at Dhamtari, Manendragarh – Bharatpur – Chirmiri, Surguja, Mohla – Manpur – Ambagarh Chowki, Jashpur, Gariyaband, Khairagarh – Chhuikhadan – Gandai and Dantewada, Female Police Station at Dantewada, Kabirdham, Jagdalpur Dist. – Bastar, Raigarh, Jashpur, CSP Office Building at Nava Raipur, DSP Office Building for AIJK DSP Kanker at Kanker, DSP Office Building at Dantewada, CSP Office Building at Rajnandgaon, M.T. Office / Workshop at 2nd Bn. Sakri Dist. – Sakri, 3rd Bn. Amleswar Dist. – Durg, 5th Bn. Jagdalpur Dist. – Bastar, 9th Bn. Dantewada, 13th Bn. Korba, 16th Bn. Narayanpur, 17th Bn. Kabirdham and PTS Jagdalpur Dist. – Bastar, Investigation Officer Residential Barrack at PS Singa Dist. – Balodabazar Bhatapara, PS Sanna Dist. – Jashpur, PS Fingseshwar Dist. – Gariyaband, PS Kansabel Dist. – Jashpur, PS Gurur Dist. – Balod, PS Daundi Dist. – Manendragarh – Bharatpur – Chirmiri, PS Khamariya Dist. – Bemetara, PS Kota Dist. – Bilaspur, PS Pachipedi Dist. – Bilaspur, PS Chando Dist. – Balrampur, PS Lalpur Dist. – Mungeli, PS Chilpi Dist. – Mungeli, PS Pathariya Dist. – Mungeli, PS Pandarai Dist. – Kabirdham, PS Bodla Dist. – Kabirdham, PS Udaypur Dist. – Surguja, PS Darima Dist. – Surguja, PS Lemru Dist. – Korba, PS Kapu Dist. – Raigarh, PS Chal Dist. – Raigarh, PS Raghunathnagar Dist. – Balrampur, PS Ramanujganj Dist. – Surajpur, PS Pusaur Dist. – Raigarh, PS Patna Dist. – Koriya, PS Baloda Dist. – Janjgir Champa, PS Pangarh Dist. – Janjgir Champa, PS Nawagarh Dist. – Janjgir Champa, PS Berla Dist. – Bemetara, PS Nandghat Dist. – Bemetara, PS Saliba Dist. – Sarangarh Bilaiagarh, PS Manpur Dist. – Mohla Manpur Ambagarh Chowki, PS Tilda Neora Dist. – Raipur, PS Gobra Nawapara Dist. – Raipur, PS Singhoda Dist. – Mahasamund, PS Sankara Dist. – Mahasamund, PS Borai Dist. – Dhamtari, PS Chura Dist. – Gariyaband, PS Bortalab Dist. – Rajnandgaon, PS Gidhauri Dist. – Balodabazar, PS Bagbhara Dist. – Jashpur, PS Pakhanpur Dist. – Kanker, PS Mainpur Dist. – Gariyaband, PS Bori Dist. – Durg, PS Ramkola Dist. – Surajpur, PS Anda Dist. –Durg, PS Dondi Lohara Dist. – Balod, PS Komakhn Dist. – Mahasamund, PS Nagri Dist. – Dhamtari, Female Police Station at Rajnandgaon and Raipur, CSP Office at Korba, Darri Dist. – Korba, Manendragarh Bharatpur Chirmiri, DSP Office at Mohla Manpur Ambagarh Chowki, SDOF Office at Bhatapara Balodabazar, 12 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at Balod (District Police), 12 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at 7th Bn. Bhilai Dist. – Durg, 24 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at S.P. Rail Raipur Dist. – Raipur, 24 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at 21st Bn. Balod Dist. – Balod, 24 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at (District Police) Raipur, 24 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at 8th Bn. Rajnandgaon, 36 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at 17th Bn. Kabirdham, 36 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at 14th Bn. Dhanora, Balod, 12 N.G.O. (G+2) & 72 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Gariyaband (District Police), 12 N.G.O. (G+2) & 48 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Dhamtari (District Police), 72 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at V.I.P. Vahini Mana, 156 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Sukma (District Police), 96 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at Bilaspur (District Police), 12 N.G.O. (G+2) & 72 H.C./Constable Flats (G+2) at SP STF Durg, Head Constable / Constable Houses (P+6) (48 Nos.) at 1st Bn. Bhilai, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) & (G+2) (36 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Mungeli (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (48 Nos.) at 12th Bn. Ramanujganj, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (48 Nos.) at 18th Bn. Korla, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (24 Nos.) & N.G.O. Houses (P+6) (24 Nos.) at Jagdalpur (District Police), 48 H.C./Cons. Quarters (G+2) at Balodabazar (District Police), 48 H.C./Cons. Quarters (G+2) at Kabirdham (District Police), 72 H.C./Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Khairagarh–Chhuikhadan–Gandai (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 12 NGO Flats (G+2) at Surajpur (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Cijw Kanker, 60 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Balrampur (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/Flats (P+6) & 8 Ngo Flats (G+1) & 24 Ngo Flats (P+6) At V.I.P. Vahini Mana Raipur, 96 Hc/Flats (G+2) At 16th Bn Narayanpur, 60 Hc/Flats (G+2), at Raigarh (Distt Police), 96 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Mohla–Manpur–Ambagarh Chowki (District Police), 84 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 24 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Sarangarh – Bilaiagarh (District Police), 72 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 08 Hc/Flats (G+1) At 13th Bn. Korba, 24 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2), & 24 Ngo Flats (P+6) At Jashpur (Distt. Police), 16 Hc/Flats (G+1) & 48 Hc/Flats (P+6), & 24 Ngo Flats (P+6) At STJ Durg, 24 Hc/Flats (G+2), 48 Hc/Flats (P+6) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At 6th Bn Raigarh, 16 Hc/Flats (G+1), 132 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo Flats (G+2) At Bijapur (Distt. Police), 96 Hc/Flats (G+2) At Kondagaon (Distt. Police), 48 Hc/Flats (G+2) & 12 Ngo (G+2) At Korba (Distt Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 7th Bn. Bhilai Dist. – Durg, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+1) (08 Nos.) at 17th Bn. Kabirdham, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (36 Nos.) at 19th Bn. Jagdalpur Dist. – Bastar, Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (36 Nos.) at 22nd Bn. Kanker, N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Bilaspur (District Police), N.G.O. Houses (G+2) (12 Nos.) at Sukma (District Police), Head Constable / Constable Houses (G+2) (36 Nos.) at Gaurela Pendra Marwahi (District Police), Additional SP Office at Pathalgao Distt. Jashpur, Maintenance Work of 16 + 32 Quarters Block – H1, H2 (Part 01 & Part 02) & G Block – (Part 01 & Part 02) at Dhanora Camp, Dalli Rajhara, Police Chowki Building at Kolhenjhariya Dist. – Jashpur, Police Chowki Building at Uparkachchhar Dist. – Jashpur, Commandant office Adm Building Armoury & KIT Clothing Magazing & Development work at 6th Bn. Raigarh, Police Chowki Building at Dudhawa Dist. – Kanker, Police Chowki Building at Dindo Dist. – Balrampur, GO’s House (E – Type) S.D.O.P & D.S.P. Quarter at Bilaspur, 24 H.C./Cons. Flats (G+2) at (District Police) Bemetara, GO’s House (E – Type) Additional S.P./S.P. & D.S.P. Head Quarter & D.S.P. Shivrinarayan Quarter at Shivrinarayan Dist. – Janjgir Champa, 04 Nos GO’s House (E – Type) Quarter at 17th Bn. Kabirdham (CAF) Campus Dist. – Kabirdham, 04 Nos GO’s House (E – Type) Quarter at 13th Bn. Korba (CAF) Campus Dist. – Korba, 04 Nos GO’s House (E – Type) Quarter at 2nd Bn. Sakari (CAF) Campus Dist. – Bilaspur, 04 Nos GO’s House (E – Type) Quarter at 8th Bn. Rajnandgaon (CAF) Campus Dist. – Rajnandgaon, 04 Nos GO’s House (E – Type) Quarter at 3rd Bn. Amleswar (CAF) Campus Dist. – Durg online tender invitation Tender System No. - 192626, 192627, 192629, 192168 to 192172, 192253, 192376, 192201 to 192210, 192219 to 192224, 192227 to 192229, 192231 to 192234, 192236, 192238 to 192240, 192242 to 192245, 192247, 192248, 192250, 192098 to 192113; 192116 to 192141, 192144, 192145, 192148, 192149 to 192155, 192157 to 192164, 192166, 192167, 192190, 192192 to 192197, 192199, 192584 to 192588, 187666 to 187673, 192490, 192491, 192493, 192484, 192485, 192488, 192468, 192470 to 192473, 187664, 187665, 192494, 192497, 192498, 192500, 192505 to 192507, 192509, 192511 to 192513, 192515 to 192517, 192519, 192520, 192462, 192463, 192465, 192467, 192539, 192474, 192479, 192084, 192075, 192080, 192089, 192079, 192077, 192083, 192081, 192074, 192082, 192076, 192085 to 192088 Which are available from 10.06.2026 & 12.06.2026 (10:30 am) to 30.06.2026 & 02.07.2026 (17:30pm) in CGPHC Portal https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in along with other details.

samwad 48070/5

Managing Director

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Nitesh, S/o. Bharat Sahani, R/o.: Jhuggi No.A-413, Behind ITI, K Block Jahangir Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide FIR No.02/2025 Dt.03.01.2025 U/S 109(1/3/5) BNS registered at P.S Jahangir Puri, North West District, Delhi and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused Nitesh could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused Nitesh is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Nitesh, accused of FIR No. 02/25 Dt.03.01.2025 U/S 109(1/3/5) BNS, P.S Jahangir Puri, North West District, Delhi is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 29.07.2026.

By Order, Ms. Jyoti Nain,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
DP/7542/NW/2026 North District, Room No.6, First Floor,
(Court Matter) Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Arman Ali, S/o Mohammad Ishak, R/o H.No. F-473, F Block, Khadda Colony, Jaitpur Extn. Part-II, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 27398/22, U/s 379/411/34 IPC Act, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Arman Ali has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Arman Ali accused of FIR No. 27398/22, U/s 379/411/34 IPC Act, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 10.07.2026.

By Order - Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02, South East District
DP/7662/SE/2026 Room No. 513, Saket Courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely: Harkesh, S/o.: Raja Ram, R/o. F-81, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.360/2020 U/S 379/411/34 IPC registered at P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Harkesh cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused Harkesh is absconded (are is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Harkesh, accused of FIR No. 360/2020 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Outer North District, Delhi is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 21.07.2026.

By Order, Ms. Bharti Beniwal,
DP/7526/ON/2026 Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North),
(Court Matter) Room No.114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Kapil Verma S/o Avinash Verma R/o H.No. 1/5252, Gali No. 08, Balbir Nagar, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under FIR No. 256/2018 U/s 506/509/34 IPC., has been registered at P.S. Shahdara, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said,Kapil Verma cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, Kapil Verma has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, Kapil Verma of under FIR No. 256/2018 U/s 506/509/34 IPC., has been registered at P.S. Shahdara, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 17.07.2026.

By Order
Mr. Mohit Sharma
DP/7401/SHD/2026 C.J.M, Room No. 59, 3rd Floor, Shahdara
(Court Notice) Distt., Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Chedi Ram, S/o Ram Kumar, R/o H.No. 5B/288, 3rd Floor, Vishanu Garden, Extension No. 5, Tilak Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 585/24, U/s 223(B) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, P.S. Vikas Puri, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Chedi Ram cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Chedi Ram has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Chedi Ram accused of FIR No. 585/24, U/s 223(B) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, P.S. Vikas Puri, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.07.2026.

By Order - Sh. Vinod Kumar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
South-West District, Room No. 09
DP/7546/WD/2026 Dwarka Courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, Siblu Kunwar, S/o Puran Bahadur Kunwar R/o Gali No 6, Shiv Wazirabad Village, Wazirabad, North, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in Cr. Case/5175/2021, FIR: 388/2020, U/s.283 IPC registered at P.S.: Wazirabad, Delhi, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, Siblu Kunwar, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, Siblu Kunwar, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, Siblu Kunwar, Cr. Case/5175/2021, FIR: 388/2020, U/s.283 IPC registered at P.S.: Wazirabad, Delhi, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.07.2026.

By Order
Sh Akash Mohan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12
(Central) Room No. 264, 2nd Floor,
DP/7565/N/2026 The Hazari Courts, Delhi
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. TMC/CPOH/PRYJ/26-27/02 Date: 08.06.2026

E-Tender Notice

Dy. CE/CPOH/ Workshop / North Central Railway / Prayagraj for and on behalf of the President of India, invites "Open" E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work upto 15:00 hrs on 30.06.2026. The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No. : TMC-CPOH-PRYJ-02-26-27 Approx. Cost (₹) : ₹ 33434097.52

Name of work:Repairing of Track machines by providing and crimping Hydraulic hoses with suitable end fittings duly crimping the hoses for the use of Track machines as per schedule of work at CPOH/WS for 02 years.

Earnest Money (₹) : ₹ 668700.00	Completion Period : 24 Month
Cost of Tender Form (₹) : NIL	Date of Opening of tender : 30.06.2026

Similar Work for Eligibility Criteria : Any Track Machine repair work.

Note: (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form / letter head, if attached by vendors shall be straightway ignored and shall not be considered. (4) The supplier / contractor of goods and/or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. (5) Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. (6) Payment of Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or payment gateway only or as per provision stipulated in applicable GCC. (7) In case of any difficulty, helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. (8) Tender online can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 30.06.2026. 1299/26(DG)

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Yash Srivastav, S/o: Late Gyan Srivastav, R/o: Flat No. 115, SFS Flat, BG-1, Pachim Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in CCNI/CT No. 2656/2019, U/s: 138 NI Act, Police Station Anand Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Yash Srivastav cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Yash Srivastav has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Yash Srivastav of Police Station Anand Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 10.07.2026.

By Order
Ms. Nandini Sharma
JMFC, Evening Court,
Shahdara, Room No. 04,
DP/7568/SHD/2026 Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the Accused No.1 Kaushal Gupta @ Kushal Gupta, S/o. Manik Chand Gupta, R/o. Jhuggi No.211, Thokar No.10, Yamuna Khader, Lalita Park Laxmi Nagar, Delhi Also at: A-1891, Phase-01, Metro Vihar, Holambi Kalan, Delhi Also at: Village Ramghari, P.S. Narki, District-Firozabad,U.P. and Accused No. 2 Anita, W/o. Kaushal Gupta, R/o. Jhuggi No.211, Thokar No.10, Yamuna Khader, Lalita Park Laxmi Nagar, Delhi Also at: A-1891, Phase-01, Metro Vihar, Holambi Kalan, Delhi have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in a Case FIR No.31/2018 U/S 376/363/323/366/368 IPC & 4/06/21 PCOASO ACT registered at P.S. Bawana, Outer North District, Delhi and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said Accused Kaushal Gupta @ Kushal Gupta and Anita could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused Kaushal Gupta @ Kushal Gupta and Anita are absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Kaushal Gupta @ Kushal Gupta and Anita accused of Case FIR No. 31/2018 U/S 376/363/323/366/368 IPC & 4/06/21 PCOASO ACT, P.S. Bawana, Outer North, Delhi are required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.07.2026 at 10.00 A.M.

By Order, Ms. Bharti Beniwal,
DP/7574/ON/2026 Judicial Magistrate First Class, Room No.114,
(Court Matter) North District, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDERS

Delhi Transco Ltd, a Government of NCT of Delhi Undertaking, invites online tender for the work :

Tender No.T25P131642: Renovation of Toilet Blocks and internal / External finishing work at Shakti Sadan and IP Commercial office DTL.

For complete details of the tender please visit following websites:- [https://dlit.gov](https://dlit.gov.in)



'I don't want to compromise'

Shilpa Shetty Kundra talked about being selective with film choices amid OTT boom

Shilpa Shetty Kundra recently offered a candid take on how the business of filmmaking has fundamentally changed. The actress spoke about her selective approach to work, her desire for a theatrical release and why she has no regrets about turning down big films.

In an interview with the 'Hindustan Times', Shilpa said, "The industry is going through a little bit of a lull also because they'd rather not take the onus or the risk and just do OTT. I don't

'The whole mathematics of making a film, the cost, all of that, has changed,' she says

blame them. The whole mathematics of making a film, the cost, all of that, has changed."

Having successfully balanced films, television and entrepreneurship over the years, she said that she has reached a point in her career where she is unwilling to settle. "I don't want to compromise too much on what I want to do because I've been there and done that for a very long time. I want to justify it



when I'm seen on screen."

During the conversation, Shilpa also talked about why she wants a big screen release: "My children haven't seen me in a theatre. That's why I want to do a film that gets a theatrical release. My son watched 'Sukhee' in 2023, but it was in a preview theatre. I hope I get something that's like the films we used to make earlier."

Reflecting on her 2023 film 'Sukhee', the actress expressed disappointment over its limited theatrical run. She elaborated, "'Sukhee' released at a time when we didn't get enough theatres. It was such a disservice to the movie. But OTT is a great platform because people can discover a film on their own time. Now, I'm aiming for a film with a theatrical release so my kids can watch me on screen."

Now hosting the cooking reality show 'Maa Hai Na', Shilpa stated that 2026 is shaping up to be a busy year professionally. She also addressed rumours and questions about projects she has declined, making it clear she stands firmly by every decision she has made. "This year, a lot is happening workwise," she shared. AGENCIES



Ram Gopal Varma compares 'Obsession' with 'Kaun'

The Hollywood horror film 'Obsession' features actress Inde Navarrette

NEW DELHI: Filmmaker Ram Gopal Varma said a scene in the horror film 'Obsession', featuring Inde Navarrette, reminded him of Urmila Matondkar's performance in his directorial 'Kaun'.

Varma recently shared a clip on his 'X' handle, which started with a scene from 'Kaun' followed by a clip of 'Obsession'. "I remembered this shot of Urmila from 'KAUN' after watching 'OBSESSION'," he wrote in the caption.

'Kaun' revolved around a lady, stranded alone at home on a stormy night, who sees a news report on a dangerous serial killer on television

The film is directed by Curry Barker and features Michael Johnston as Bear Bailey and Navarrette as Nikki Freeman. It revolves around a shy, insecure music store employee, Bailey, who is in love with his childhood friend and coworker, Freeman. The film, which released on May 29, has earned over 200 million US dollars at the global box office.

Varma's 'Kaun' released in 1999 and revolved around Matondkar's character, stranded alone at home on a stormy night, who sees a news report on a dangerous serial



killer on television. It also starred Manoj Bajpayee and Sushant Singh in pivotal roles. PTI

Dimple slams trolls criticising her support to Janhvi Kapoor

NEW DELHI: Actress Dimple Hayathi slammed trolls criticising her for supporting Janhvi Kapoor amid 'Peddi' backlash and said several female actors don't receive roles that fully showcase their abilities.

Hayathi recently shared a note for Kapoor on her 'X' handle after a section of the audience criticised the film for objectifying women through its camera work, dialogues and romantic scenes between Ram Charan and Kapoor.

Hayathi said if characters are underwritten, the responsibility lies more with writing and filmmaking and choices and not the actor essaying the role. She herself was later trolled for supporting Kapoor.

In another series of posts on Monday, Hayathi lashed out at trolls and said her

thoughts were shaped by her experience and are not supposed to align with others.

"Guys, relax, take a chill pill. Please concentrate on your lives. I have got my opinion or my experiences don't have to go with you or I come and answer each of you," she wrote.

Hayathi said several female actors don't receive roles that fully showcase their abilities

The actress said some female actors have to spend years working within the limitations of the characters they are offered or written for them.

"Not every female actor is fortunate enough to receive roles that fully showcase their abilities. It's not about who has come from where and who's who big or small or who is less over who, it's only spoken and unfair to place the entire burden on a female lead actor when the shortcomings clearly stem from the writing." PTI



Social media is 'literally destroying' actors' careers: Sanjay

Filmmaker Sanjay Gupta has been quite vocal on social media lately. A few days ago, he sparked a conversation by questioning the Federation of West India Cine Employees' (FWICE) decision to impose a ban on Ranveer Singh regarding the 'Don 3' dispute. This stance earned him a sharp response from FWICE. Since then, Gupta has continued to speak his mind on various happenings within the industry.

His latest comment came in the form of an indirect reaction to the trolling that Janhvi Kapoor has been facing over her controversial scenes in 'Peddi'.

Without naming Janhvi, Gupta took to 'X' to express his concern about how social media has been damaging actors' careers. Sanjay didn't mince his words and said that social media is actively



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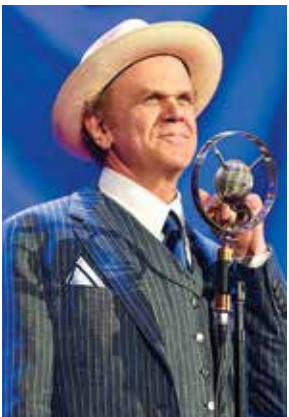
destroying the careers of actors who have barely had a chance to find their footing in the industry. In his view, these young actors are being thrown into a world that is

ruthless and shows absolutely no mercy.

He wrote, "Social media is literally destroying the careers of actors that have hardly taken off. They are facing a ruthless & unforgiving world. They need to realise just how very careful they need to be with their choices. The audience is judge, jury and algorithm."

Over the years, Sanjay has built an impressive body of work that includes films like 'Aatish', 'Ram Shashtra', 'Hame-shaa', 'Jung', 'Kaante', 'Musalifir', 'Zinda', 'Dus Kahaniyaan', 'Jazbaa', 'Kaabil' and others. His most recent project, 'The Miranda Brothers', arrived on 'JioCinema' in 2024. Known for his long-standing partnerships with Sanjay Dutt and John Abraham, Gupta has consistently been one of the more prolific and recognisable names behind the camera in Hindi cinema. AGENCIES

'Told Leonardo to drop Titanic for Boogie Nights'



Actor John C Reilly tried convincing DiCaprio to reject James Cameron's film

ert De Niro in the biographical drama film 'This Boy's Life'. When Anderson approached the actor for his film, DiCaprio had already signed 'Titanic'.

"I met him when he was 17. And I was like, 'Give me the assignment, Paul. I'll get this guy to do your movie. I've known him since he was a kid,'" Reilly recalled on the 'Where Everybody Knows Your Name' podcast.

Reilly kept trying to make the actor turn down the role in 'Titanic'. "Listen, Leo, let me tell you something. That movie 'Titanic' is about a boat that sinks. Everyone knows the boat sinks. No one's going to give a shit about who's on the boat... This guy, this director, is going to be one of the most talented film directors going forward and you should not miss this opportunity," he said.

DiCaprio eventually took Cameron's film and Mark Wahlberg got the role in 'Boogie Nights'. PTI

LOS ANGELES: Actor John C Reilly tried convincing Hollywood star Leonardo DiCaprio to reject James Cameron's 'Titanic' and instead choose 'Boogie Nights'.

The actor described his equation with 'Boogie Nights' filmmaker Paul Thomas Anderson as 'thick as thieves' following their collaboration on his 1996 directorial debut film 'Hard Eight'. Reilly, who has worked with DiCaprio in the 1993 film 'What's Eating Gilbert Grape', said he was confident he would get the actor in 'Boogie Nights'.

DiCaprio was already in the limelight after his breakthrough role alongside Rob-

'HEROINES TODAY don't need to objectify themselves'

Asha Parekh and Jaya Bachchan expressed their disappointment with the increasing objectification of women on screen

At a time when Telugu film 'Peddi' is making headlines over criticism that it objectifies Janhvi Kapoor's character through repeated close-up shots and suggestive framing, several veteran actresses reflected on an era when glamour and sensuality didn't rely on excessive skin show.

In a recent interview, veteran actresses Asha Parekh and Jaya Bachchan expressed their disappointment with the increasing objectification of women on screen.

Asha told 'Deccan Chronicle', "I remember once a director asked me to wear a revealing costume for a dance number. I looked him in the eye and asked, 'Would you be happy if your daughter wore this costume?' The dress was quietly dropped. The heroines today are so beautiful that they don't need to objectify themselves. Look at how aesthetically Sanjay Leela Bhansali presents his heroines. They look so beautiful in his films. The same heroines are used differently, exploitatively, by other directors."

Jaya Bachchan also spoke about maintaining boundaries through-



out her career. "Nobody ever dared to cross the line with me," she told the publication. Recalling a rare, unpleasant experience, she added, "I had only one unpleasant experience of being objectified by a director. I never worked with him again." Jaya was reportedly referring to her experience while shooting for 'Shor', directed by Manoj Kumar, in which she played a streetwalker.

The discussion has also reignited conversations around whether actresses today should take a stronger stand against scenes they find uncomfortable or objectifying.

Responding to the debate, actress Taapsee Pannu told the publication, "As long as there is a camera, there will be awkward angles. One just needs to be self-aware."

Since its release on June 4, 'Peddi' has found itself at the centre of controversy. Critics and viewers have objected to what they describe as the unnecessary sexualisation of Janhvi Kapoor's character, along with certain dialogues and scenes involving Ram Charan's character. A particular sequence, which some viewers felt portrayed a forced kiss as an expression of love, also drew criticism on social media.

The backlash eventually reached director Buchi Babu Sana, who took to 'X' to announce that changes would be made to the contentious sequences. He also apologised to viewers whose sentiments were hurt, while maintaining that there was no intention to objectify Janhvi. AGENCIES



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